The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality

Guhyagarbhatattvaviniścaya · Toh 834 · Derge Kangyur
གསང་བའ་སྙིང་པ་དོ་ཁོ་ནོ་ཉིད་དས་པ

The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, known in Sanskrit as the Guhyagarbha Tattvaviniścaya and in Tibetan as Sangwé Nyingpo De Kho Na Nyi Ngepa, is a tantra of the Net of Illusion (Māyājāla) cycle, the class of scriptures at the heart of the Ancient, or Nyingma, tradition's Mahāyoga teachings. It opens with homage to the glorious Samantabhadra and sets its scene in the boundless realm of Akaniṣṭha, where the Buddha in his enjoyment form, embodying the body, speech and mind of all the tathāgatas of the ten directions and four times, abides in a jewelled celestial palace of wisdom. Across a long series of chapters, this extended version of the tantra presents the view that all phenomena are primordially pure and equal, the maṇḍalas of peaceful and wrathful deities, mantra and mudrā, the commitments of practice, and the realization of mind as awakening itself. It is Toh 834 in the Kangyur, where it is placed among the Ancient Tantras, the section of the canon that preserves the tantras of the early Nyingma translation period.

In the language of Tibet: The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Homage to the Blessed One, glorious Samantabhadra.

At the very time this was explained, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, the Blessed One, the Great Enjoyment, whose nature is the vajra of the body, speech and mind of all the tathāgatas of the ten directions and the four times, without remainder, with none left out, with nothing remaining, a nature not separate, not different, indivisible from them all, was present in this way.

In Akaniṣṭha, the abode without limit or center, upon the wheel of wisdom of immeasurable ground, pervasively luminous, stands a celestial palace blazing with various wisdom jewels. Its breadth is unbroken in the ten directions. It is square, because it is rich in immeasurable qualities. It is beautified by projecting bays of the jewels of superior wisdom. Its pinnacle is the wisdom of a single essential nature, swirling everywhere, of all the maṇḍalas of the buddhas of the ten directions and the four times without exception, not separate from one another. Its inconceivable wisdom jewels are immeasurable in their kinds and particulars of different aspects, of shape, color and the like. It is covered with inconceivable ornaments, self-arisen and billowing through

the ten directions, clear and unobscured: garlands of various wisdom jewels, tassels and half-tassel ornaments, various forms, various sounds, various scents, various tastes and various tangibles. It has courtyards and gateways entered through the four doors of liberation, and porticoes of the eight liberations.

Within it, which is everywhere within, since it has no outside or inside, upon the lion throne of fearlessness, the elephant throne of power, the horse throne of miraculous power, the peacock throne of mastery, the garuḍa throne of unobstructedness, upon disks of sun and moon, naturally luminous, and upon seats of unsullied jewel lotuses, are those whose bodies have no front or back, whose faces shine forth openly in every direction, who are endowed with the major and minor marks, and who appear everywhere, throughout all that is inconceivable, with various bodies, speech and minds. From the great spontaneously present body, speech and mind, they sit in the cross-legged posture of discipline in which the two feet of method and wisdom are equal. They have six hands, the six wisdoms, blazing hands of wisdom jewels, and three heads, the inconceivable body, speech and mind. They are namely these: the Blessed One, the Tathāgata King of Consciousness, the Tathāgata King of Form, the Tathāgata King of Feeling, the Tathāgata King of Perception, and the Tathāgata King of Formations, all of them gleaming in the colors blue, white, yellow, vermilion and green. Nondual with the hosts of consorts, the supreme consorts the Expanse of Appearance, the Expanse of Solidity, the Expanse of Softness, the Expanse of Warmth, the Expanse of Movement and the rest, they pervade the whole expanse of reality without end. They dwell pervading it, filling it, like a pod full of sesame seeds.

Then there dwell, nondual, hosts of this kind beyond telling: Great Awakening Vajra Seeing, Great Awakening Vajra Hearing, Great Awakening Vajra Smelling, and Great Awakening Vajra Tasting; the host of consorts, What Is To Be Seen, What Is To Be Heard, What Is To Be Smelled, and What Is To Be Tasted; Great Awakening Vajra the Seer, Great Awakening Vajra the Hearer, Great Awakening Vajra the Smeller, and Great Awakening Vajra the Taster; the host of consorts, the Past, the Present, and the Not Yet Come; the Great Destroyer Touch, the Great Destroyer the Toucher, and the Great Destroyer the Knower of Touch; and the consorts, Not as Permanence, Not as Annihilation, Not as Self, Not as Sign, and so on.

Then the Tathāgata brought forth this very secret of those maṇḍalas themselves, nondual with the hosts of consorts, from the vajra of body,

speech, mind, qualities and activity:

"Oh! Oh! How wonderful!
The expanse of suchness itself, and the maṇḍala of the wisdom of mastery, the mind, and self-appearance itself, the reflection of samādhi, illusion pure and clear, is the inexhaustible precious wish-fulfilling jewel of body, speech, mind, qualities and activity that excludes nothing: it is the very abode of the wheel of ornaments, the supreme vajra."
So it was said, in secret vajra words.

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the first chapter, the setting.

Then the Blessed One, the agent, Vajra Mind Samantabhadra, by the vajra of the way of the nature of all without exception, came to enter the consort, the Dharma, she who is the action, Samantabhadrī, and spoke this inspired utterance:

"oṃ The nature of reality of phenomena, the expanse of the knowable,
Samantabhadrī, mother of bliss:
the unmoving natural maṇḍala
is I, and my field of activity,
the various mudrās, shines clear each in its own place.
In the western quarter, in supreme Akaniṣṭha,
is spread a seat of the unattached lotus,
the abode where the Victors of the three times dwell.
At the four doors of liberation
it is perfectly endowed with the four mudrās.
To make clear who is empowered and who is without fortune,
it has inner and outer tiers of iron walls.
That which all the Victors keep hidden,
whose depth is hard for anyone to fathom,
Samantabhadra himself beholds."

When he had said this, he came to enter the consort, she who is the action, the Dharma, Samantabhadrī. Having been entered, the consort, she who is the action, the Dharma, Samantabhadrī, abiding in equipoise with the Blessed One, Mind Samantabhadra, in the bliss of nondual enjoyment, spoke this inspired utterance:

"Mind's very nature of mind, the chief who acts,
Samantabhadra, vajra mind,
nature of the six wisdoms:

in the east, in the inconceivable palace of Abhirati,
he who brings forth treasure like sapphire,
with the magic key of the secret assembly,
opens the doors of liberation
and bolts them within with supreme awakening.
Seated on the lotus seat of union,
he gives rise to the mind of awakening for the sake of beings,
gathers under his power the five destinies and the four kinds of birth,
and confers empowerment on the seats of body, speech and mind."

When she had said this, all became clear as the very vajra of the way of great equality.

Through that entering, all the tathāgatas of the ten directions without exception, being indivisible in a single nature, the tathāgatas themselves spoke this inspired utterance to the tathāgatas themselves:

"How wonderful! The limbs of the vajra aggregates
are known as the five perfect buddhas.
The sense sources and elements, all the many,
are the very maṇḍala of the bodhisattvas.
Earth and water are Locanā and Māmakī,
fire and wind are Pāṇḍaravāsinī and Tārā,
and space is Dhātvīśvarī, Lady of the Expanse.
The three realms of existence are awakened from the very beginning.
All phenomena without exception, every one,
are nothing other than buddhahood itself.
A phenomenon other than buddhahood itself
is not found by buddhahood itself."

When this was said, all the tathāgatas were pleased. Then the consort, she who is the action, the Dharma, Samantabhadrī, having become nondual with the Blessed One, Mind Samantabhadra, spoke this inspired utterance:

"How wonderful! The thousandfold world realms of the ten directions are the solitude of wisdom;
the three realms of existence themselves are pure fields;
the five degenerations themselves are blissful;
the five aggregates themselves are manifestly awakened.
Since all is the essence of the supreme,

the Victors seek no Dharma elsewhere.
A dharma said to be other than this,
even if sought, the Victors do not find."

When this was said, the tathāgatas themselves knew all to be awakened from the very beginning.

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the second chapter, raising the topic.

Then the great being of nonduality spoke this, generating as wisdom the mind awakened in wisdom:

"How wonderful, this marvelous, amazing Dharma,
the secret of all the perfect buddhas!
From the unborn, all is born;
yet in being born itself, there is no birth.
How wonderful, this marvelous, amazing Dharma,
the secret of all the perfect buddhas!
From the unceasing, all ceases;
yet in ceasing itself, there is no cessation.
How wonderful, this marvelous, amazing Dharma,
the secret of all the perfect buddhas!
From the nonabiding, all abides;
yet in abiding itself, there is no abiding.
How wonderful, this marvelous, amazing Dharma,
the secret of all the perfect buddhas!
From what is beyond reference, all is referred to;
yet in reference itself, there is no reference.
How wonderful, this marvelous, amazing Dharma,
the secret of all the perfect buddhas!
From no going and coming, there is going and coming;
yet in going and coming itself, there is no going and coming."

When this was said, all the tathāgatas and all the hosts of consorts became pervaded with delight. Then all the tathāgatas, together with the hosts of consorts, spoke this inspired utterance:

"How wonderful! The Dharma secret from the very beginning:
though it appears in various ways, it is secret by nature;
by its essential nature it is utterly secret;

though it is not otherwise, it is supremely secret."

When this was said, since all the tathāgatas are indivisible, being of a single characteristic in the essential nature of primordial awakening, the great wisdom of the buddha of great compassion arose toward the ignorance that is the conceptual thought of beings, ripening inconceivably into the classes of the five kinds of beings, and they spoke this inspired utterance:

"How wonderful! From the essence of the sugatas,
by the karma of their own conceptual thought, are emanated
various bodies, enjoyments,
abodes, sufferings and so on;
they grasp separately at I and mine.
No one binds them; there is no bond;
there is nothing to be bound.
It is conceptual thought, grasping at a self.
Insistently they tie knots in space.
To show the Dharma of the buddhas,
spontaneously complete from the very beginning,
without bondage and without liberation,
they make various emanations."

Thus they declared to the tathāgatas themselves.

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the third chapter, generating as wisdom the ultimate and relative mind of awakening.

Then from all the tathāgatas, the six sages, beings of knowledge called Blessed by Great Compassion, were brought forth from the vajra of the body, speech and mind of the tathāgatas. Once brought forth, by the force of karma, in each and every great trichiliocosm of the ten directions, endless and limitless, in the six worlds that lie crosswise, above and below, each great sage, a blessed one, acted for the welfare of the five kinds of beings by the four modes of training. These sages, displaying birth, going forth, the practice of austerities, awakening, the subjugation of Māra, the turning of the wheel of Dharma, the showing of great miracles, passing into nirvāṇa and so on, know all four times, know everything in the mind streams of all, see everything with the miraculous eye, hear everything with the miraculous ear, act everywhere for others' benefit by miraculous means, and, being undefiled, possess the six higher knowledges that complete the conduct of Samantabhadra. They are

endowed with inconceivable bodies everywhere, inconceivable minds everywhere, inconceivable faces everywhere, and inconceivable speech everywhere, and they came to appear in the ten directions, inconceivable and countless.

Having appeared in this way, all the great sages, however many, in the great state of compassion, namely, according to those to be trained, through the vehicle of gods and humans, the vehicle of the śrāvakas, the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, the vehicle of the bodhisattvas and the unsurpassed vehicle, taught the eighty-four thousand collections of Dharma as the remedy for the eighty-four thousand afflictions, the conceptual thoughts of ignorance. They teach them, and they will teach them. All of these culminate in teaching what is needed for the delusion that grasps at the outer and inner dependent arising of the grasped and the grasper; that karma and its result are not wasted; that one is not stained and does not become stained by karma and its result; and the unstained.

Then all the tathāgatas, in order to show the faults of saṃsāra and the qualities of nirvāṇa, spoke this inspired utterance to the tathāgatas themselves:

"How wonderful! In the inconceivable maṇḍala,
however many the unsurpassed essences,
the Victor by nature, whom no other can rob,
being free of extremes, is without self."

Then all the tathāgatas spoke this inspired utterance:

"How wonderful! However many deluded phenomena of the world there are,
through the grasped and grasper of ignorant conceptual thought,
in the inconceivable thousandfold worlds
they circle in the two, outer and inner dependent arising.
The habitual tendencies of conceptual thought are dense,
and one comes to experience discordant pleasure and pain.
Reality just as it is, the expanse itself,
and the selfless nature are of a single mode;
in the nature itself there is no decline.
In the two modes, the genuine and illusion,
there is no self, no mine, no other;
since reality is the expanse of essential nature,
the pure expanse itself is of a single mode.

Self, mine and others
are nothing more than false conceptions;
there is nothing subtle and profound in them.
False conception acts only upon itself;
it does not stir elsewhere at all.
Even the stream of cause and result of false conception
is without ground or root, momentary.
Because it is the mode of the pure expanse itself,
having mastery over itself and acting on itself,
the stream of self, other and conceptual thought
is the pure, unsurpassed, supreme vehicle.
Through four vehicles there is deliverance;
they abide in the result of the one vehicle.
When it is examined well with genuine realization,
though it has no intrinsic nature, anything at all is accomplished.
The Buddha never passes into nirvāṇa,
and the Dharma will not decline;
to ripen and to train the ignorant,
the source is shown passing into nirvāṇa.
The Vinaya, the Sūtras, the Abhidharma,
commitment, practice and accomplishment,
and the tantras of body, speech and mind,
however many, in the boundless worlds,
widely renowned throughout the ten directions,
have emanated from the Secret Essence.
This Secret Essence by nature
definitively establishes the source
of all the piṭakas and all the tantras
and of the inconceivable sages who teach them.
Phenomena are mere designations by name.
In keeping with the meaning to be taught,
names are designated as words and taught;
in the teaching, the names and the words, there is no real thing."

When this was said, all phenomena became clear as great spontaneous presence by their essential nature. Then the tathāgatas brought forth this very secret of those spontaneously present nondual maṇḍalas from the vajra of

body, speech, mind, qualities and activity:

"Oh! The faults up to the peak of existence arise from conceiving a self.
The six classes, birth and cessation, bodies and enjoyments,
abodes, sufferings, deluded wandering and so on
are nothing other than false conception itself.
Emptiness, selflessness, primordial knowing, the self-aware mind,
beyond both object of reference and no reference, is mastery of mindfulness.
The wondrous body, speech, qualities and realms
are nowhere else: reality is just so."
So it was said, in secret vajra words.

The tathāgatas themselves knew that the countless emanations of the six sages, and what all the tathāgatas have spoken, are gathered into these.

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the fourth chapter, establishing all phenomena.

Then the Tathāgata, the Blessed One, with great delight, showed that all beings possess the maṇḍala of their nature, and he also explained it as six classes of family lineage. Among these, the family of the nature of reality exists in all of them. Space too abides pervading all. Yet although the expanse of reality and space thus pervade all, if the meaning of liberation is not realized, it is like a mirror covered with rust, which cannot perform the function of showing reflections. Having said this, Vajradhara further spoke thus:

"The self-aware king who realizes the meaning of equality:
as rivers flow into the great ocean,
into these great means that realize the unsurpassed meaning
all the inconceivable vehicles of every kind are gathered without remainder.
Aho!
Realizing the two kinds of selflessness, perfecting the perfections,
the yogin who has meditated on the ten grounds in sequence
on the path that attains the state of going to the ground of a buddha
fully attains it through the two truths.
One who knows outer and inner dependent arising as illusion and mirage
enters unobstructed into substantial forms;
without a spiritual friend, beyond training, he realizes by his own awareness,
going to the ground of awakening, the supreme wish-fulfilling bliss.
Realizing the meaning of the four truths, fully abandoning,

purifying the portions of the sixteen wisdoms, utterly at peace,
having purified in sequence stream-entry and the rest,
one goes to the ground where the foes, the afflictions, are fully pacified.
Not fixed as to which vehicle it is taught in,
or else, conforming to all, entering into them widely,
or else, indefinite, not to be examined as 'this':
this, the indefinite, Vajradhara has taught.
Practicing the ten virtues and abandoning nonvirtue
is the cause of birth as gods and humans in the desire realm.
Practicing the four immeasurables and meditating on the unmoving
is the cause of birth as gods of the Brahmā abodes and so on.
Although the expanse of reality pervades all,
if one lacks the fortune to realize self-awareness,
it is like showing colors to one blind from birth:
this is the ground of the unfortunate, whose family lineage is severed.
Because the expanse of reality pervades all,
even the inconceivable unsurpassed vehicles that are taught
are merely appearances to each one's own self-aware mind.
Wandering variously in the lower realms and the six destinies
is likewise the appearance of the deluded mind, false conception;
in the expanse of suchness there is no change.
Familiarity with nonreferential self-awareness is the unsurpassed supreme.
If, through false conception, one grasps at I and mine,
various unpleasant things without reality come to appear.
If one lacks the self-aware mind of genuine knowledge,
even a sugata's field is seen as a place of the lower realms.
For one who realizes the very meaning of equality, the supreme vehicle,
the places of the lower realms themselves are the abodes of Akaniṣṭha and Tuṣita.
In the expanse of space, inconceivable,
though sun, moon, planets, stars, signs, flashing lightning,
rainbows and many clouds stir in all their variety,
the expanse of space neither changes nor declines.
In the nonreferential expanse of reality, inconceivable,
though there are the wondrous body, speech, qualities and activity,
all the chief and supreme ones of the world without exception,
and the many and varied sufferings of deluded wandering,

in suchness there is neither increase nor decrease."
So it was said, in secret vajra words.

From the King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, the fifth chapter, the brief explanation that all possess the cause that is the nature of reality, of the severing of family lineage, and of the distinctions of the eight families.

Then all the tathāgatas became of a single intent, and without moving from the samādhi in which all phenomena are awakened from the very beginning in the vajra expanse of the mode of great equality, brought forth from the vajra of body, speech and mind this, called the Wheel of the Garland of Letters, in which all phenomena abide as mere names:

"a becomes utterly stable; from the white a
extremely subtle a letters stream forth.
Having filled all directions with their clarity,
even when gathered back they remain stable, without increase or decrease.
From that all the hosts of names, clear and blazing,
stream forth and are gathered back in just the same way.
This is the cause of the wisdom of dependent arising
for vajra accomplishment."

a ka kha ga gha ṅa ca cha ja jha ña ṭa ṭha ḍa ḍha ṇa ta tha da dha na pa pha ba bha ma ya va ra la śa ṣa sa ha kṣa i ī u ā e ai o au

When these were brought forth, the endless ten directions of the six worlds quaked in six ways. They quaked, quaked strongly and quaked everywhere, and all phenomena came to have the character of names. Then all the tathāgatas spoke this inspired utterance:

"a is neither empty nor not empty;
there is no middle as an object of reference.
All are mere names; all the buddhas
abide in the very garland of letters.
a itself, appearing in variety
as the forty-two, ka and the rest,
gathers everything through the names of sound;
it is ascertained as the king of manifest perfection.
How wonderful! The names of the forty-five
great marvelous, amazing emanations
are the place that holds all words without exception;

they speak and teach all the various meanings.
Insubstantial, letters are the nature of mind;
though selfless, free of extremes and beyond reference,
through shapes, colors and hosts of names
they emanate and display play of every kind.
The body, speech and mind of the wisdom beings
of the thus-gone ones of the ten directions and four times,
the forty-five maṇḍalas themselves,
are complete from the first letter to kṣa.
Mind by nature is letters,
and letters have no real substance.
That nonreferential reality itself is the great wheel
of the various bodies, speech and minds.
Body, speech and mind are the marvelous,
amazing great emanation, fully summoned:
they are the expanse written by the expanse,
and therefore they are called letters.
The head of a letter is the unerring path;
the syllable dot is named wisdom;
the stroke, great means, divides it into sections.
a is unborn suchness.
ṭha is the very vajra of illusion.
ṭa is the very illusion of appearance.
ḍa is the wish-fulfilling illusion itself.
ḍha is pure illusion itself.
ṇa is illusion everywhere.
tha is manifest perfection through the net.
ta is stability through the net.
da is vividness through the net.
dha is swirling through the net.
na transforms everything through the net.
ka is the supreme mind of the eye.
kha is the supreme mind of the ear.
ga is the supreme mind of the nose.
gha is the supreme mind of the tongue.
ṅa destroys even the mind.
ca is the supreme body of the eye.

cha is the supreme body of the ear.
ja is the supreme body of the nose.
jha is the supreme body of the tongue.
ña destroys even the body.
pa is the supreme speech of the eye.
pha is the supreme speech of the ear.
ba is the supreme speech of the nose.
bha is the supreme speech of the tongue.
ma destroys even speech.
ya is arising made pure.
va is abiding made pure.
ra is destruction made pure.
la is emptiness made pure.
ṣa is impermanence made pure.
ṣa is that annihilation too does not exist.
sa is selflessness free of extremes.
ha is signlessness itself.
kṣa is the mind of the mind of wisdom.
ī is among gods as many as atoms.
ī is asuras as many as atoms.
ū is among humans as many as atoms.
ū is animals as many as atoms.
e is among hungry ghosts as many as atoms.
ai is hell-beings as many as atoms.
o destroys all.
au is all destroyed.
By this great host, the wheel of letters,
the garland of body, speech and mind is gathered.
Aho!"

Then the Tathāgata brought forth this very secret of those maṇḍalas themselves, nondual with the hosts of consorts, from the vajra of body, speech, mind, qualities and activity:

"Aho!
Method and wisdom, clouds of delight, hosts of the mind of awakening, are the wheel of the cause;
the result, the ripened accomplishment of the Victors, is the forty-two

marvelous hosts of names.
The unconditioned itself is the commitment that brings forth the conditioned vajra maṇḍala;
it does not transgress it: it is the great power of the gathering of causes and conditions, beyond choice.
Aho!"
So it was said, in secret vajra words, and when this was said, all the tathāgatas became the wheel of letters.

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the sixth chapter, the arrangement of the Wheel of the Garland of Letters.

Then the Tathāgata, from the King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, because it is extremely secret, taught this: in the outer tantras of secret mantra and in the other inner tantras of method, it is taught as eighteen elements, and in all the treatises too it is taught as eighteen elements. Because this general scripture is extremely profound, it is taught as twenty-one elements; and the general scripture is the source from which all tantras and scriptures arise. Both the secret faculty and the secret object are declared to be extremely secret, because they are the basis from which all the sense sources and elements arise. In order to show those maṇḍalas very clearly, he spoke this inspired utterance to himself:

"How wonderful! The Dharma secret from the very beginning:
in each and every thing its nature abides.
Because its natural purity and equality are not realized,
though it is present in all, its nature is secret.
It is not elsewhere, yet it is utterly secret;
its very meaning is the cause of its secrecy.
So the One Who Possesses the Vajra of Equality has spoken:
this is the supreme essence of awakening.
Aho!"
So it was said, in secret vajra words.

All that appears as the sense faculties and their objects
is itself the maṇḍala of the bodhisattvas.
The five aggregates and the five elements
are perfected as the ten fathers and mothers of the five families.
The sense sources and the eighteen elements
are themselves the maṇḍala of male and female sattvas.

All of them, through the female bodhisattvas,
are gathered into the secret vajra faculty.
The vajra faculty is the secret skillful means;
the object of the faculty is the expanse of wisdom;
the mind of the faculty is Vajrasattva.
It is the very treasure from which all arises
and the very place to which all goes;
there is nothing that it does not produce.
It is the cause of saṃsāra and nirvāṇa:
from it everything is born and arises.
It is the cause of the mudrās of all,
the substance for accomplishing bliss and awakening.
From it they are produced, from it they are emanated;
it is the place where all accomplishments are achieved.
When the vajra faculty is joined with the lotus
and nondual bodhicitta radiates,
nonreferential bliss and enjoyments radiate:
body, speech and mind, and the five wisdoms,
the four secret goddesses,
the four perfect offering goddesses,
and the bodhicitta of entering, rising, abiding and aspiring.
Moving, stirring, rising and abiding,
summoning, holding, and likewise,
to accomplish the aim of gathering and embracing,
binding, not releasing, bringing under power:
the sweet sound of bliss resounds through the ten directions.
Supremely graceful splendor blazes;
garlands of wish-fulfilling jewels blaze;
sweet, captivating melody blazes with splendor;
beautiful forms move and stir the ten directions;
all-satisfying flavors and fragrances suffuse;
heaps of lovely divine jewels radiate;
radiating luminosity, everything blazes:
the expanse of nectar, cool, warm and soft.
a la la ho
When the secret faculty has joined the lotus,
in the manner of non-attachment

the ten perfections, cause and result, are perfected;
the ten grounds are perfected without gradual arrangement;
Universal Light and Lotus Eye are perfected as well;
the inconceivable Wheel of the Garland of Letters,
endowed with the skillful means of the genuine Great Perfection,
the unsurpassed ground of means and wisdom, is perfected too;
the great accumulations of merit and wisdom are perfected in play.
a la la ho
From the supreme secret of suchness,
the elements are twenty-one:
the eighteen are as in other tantras,
and the three are likewise the very self of all.
They are the source from which the eighteen arise,
they are also the field where awakening is accomplished,
and they are also the cause that brings forth bliss.
To state their secret characteristics:
the faculty is the vajra, king of secrets;
the object is the lotus, the expanse of supreme bliss;
the mind is the treasure from which awakening arises.
When faculty, object and mind are joined,
the great magical display of the supreme secret is emanated.
Countless maṇḍalas, as many as there are atoms,
and spontaneously present excellences
are brought forth by the supreme secret.
This is declared to be the single point.
If these supreme secret meanings
are explained to those of inferior view,
life will be exhausted before its time,
the head will split and the heart will burn.
As a magnet draws iron,
against one's will and without power,
one will pass for eons through the lower realms and states without leisure.
Therefore this should be kept utterly secret.
One of vast wisdom, whose mind is profound and spacious,
should give it to those of stable mind, great compassion and faith, firm in good conduct;
otherwise it must never be given.

Thus he spoke to himself.

This is the seventh chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the chapter on gathering into the twenty-one elements and arranging all, without exception, within the expanse.

Then, from the array of clouds of the maṇḍala of letters, he spoke this inspired utterance, this unfolding of magical display:

Mind itself, which has no root,
is the root of all phenomena.
Mind itself is the nature of letters;
letters are clouds of wish-fulfilling jewels.
Through the full manifestation of the forty-two maṇḍalas of illusion,
the maṇḍalas of the net,
all the maṇḍalas complete throughout the ten directions and four times
are accomplished.
Things turn into nectar and come forth,
the four hundred and four diseases are dispelled,
enjoyments arise and the lower realms are purified;
anything at all can be turned into something else.
Space arises as solid vajra,
blazing, fire burns,
and likewise things turn into water and pour down;
world-systems are scattered,
and all are emptied and fall.
Summoning and dismissing, binding and freeing,
healing and killing, defeat and victory:
all these are done through this samādhi.
By the wish-fulfilling names, words and forms
that are the self-appearance of the wisdom of reality,
just as light appears in darkness,
there is transformation, in the manner of the elixir that turns things to gold.
One who is diligent in honoring the Teacher, clear in realization,
who knows the samayas, mantras and mudrās without impairment
and possesses the requisites, will succeed;
one who lacks these will be ruined to no purpose.
The essence of the supreme accomplishment,
realized by the Victors of the three times,

is a wish-fulfilling treasury that is never exhausted,
arising without increase or decrease.
From non-entity, clouds of entities
arise and transform in every variety.
To realize that entities themselves are without entity
is the samādhi of mastery.
Whoever does not know the nonreferential
does not know the dharmadhātu.
Therefore, wary of entity and non-entity,
come to know the nonreferential.
Mind itself, which has no ground or root,
is not male, not female, not neuter,
not sexless, not of any caste or lineage,
not a color, not a shape,
not located anywhere, not anything at all.
It is the wisdom of the expanse of suchness,
the cause of all the mudrās of skillful means.
From means, means arise; the means are inconceivable.
Not different, yet appearing as different,
the inner and the outer:
inconceivable maṇḍalas, the play of wisdom,
the fearless supreme mudrā of Samantabhadra.
Whoever tames the mind, which is like a maddened elephant,
by resting in meditative equipoise,
and is firmly stable through mantra and mudrā,
will gain great and marvelous accomplishment.

When this had been spoken, the Tathāgatas themselves were delighted by the spectacle. Then from the vajra of the body, speech and mind of the Tathāgatas came forth these secret words:

"How wonderful! Because the path is included in the essence,
the fearless expanse itself is the supreme mudrā of Samantabhadra.
Its nature is the great body, speech and mind,
the state in which awakening is spontaneously present and all-pervading.
The essence itself, with everything included in the essence, abides everywhere.
From the state in which that is perfected, all accomplishments dawn and abide

everywhere.
Aho!"
So it was said, in secret vajra words.

This is the eighth chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the chapter on accomplishing the magical display.

Then, in order to make fruitful this maṇḍala through which mantra holders accomplish themselves as deities, by means of the maṇḍala that surpasses the natural maṇḍala of the King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, the Tathāgatas spoke this inspired utterance:

How wonderful! Utterly pure from the very beginning,
skillful means and wisdom abide in union.
In supreme awakening the sun and moon have risen;
that itself is declared to be the seat where they dwell.
Clear rays of light dissolve
into the expanse where all phenomena are without self.
There is no one, and no elaboration at all;
the maṇḍala is unelaborated, round in form.
The Dharma that is nirvāṇa from the very beginning
possesses wisdom as both cause and result.
The wisdom body of omniscience
is encircled all around by the wheel of Dharma.
By the radiating blessing of compassion,
the maṇḍala of the four wisdoms is emanated.
The five wisdoms and body, speech and mind,
blessings wondrous and inconceivable,
arise from the skillful means of self-appearance.
The celestial palace of vast compassion,
in which the accumulations of merit and wisdom are complete,
extends without center or edge.
Emptiness, wishlessness, signlessness and luminosity are the entrances;
therefore they are explained as the four doors of wisdom.
The way that leads there has eight steps.
Because nature is luminous from the very beginning,
thrones blaze with seats of sun and moon stacked one upon the other.
Because it is utterly pure from the very beginning,
there are seats of blazing lotuses, free of attachment.
Because it has become an inexhaustible treasure of wisdom,

there are seats of blazing wish-fulfilling jewels.
Because it never departs from equality from the very beginning,
palm trees stand there by their very nature.
Because hopes are fulfilled just as wished,
jeweled wish-granting trees blaze,
encircled with ornaments of wish-fulfilling jewels.
Because of mastery over all,
it is encircled by the great gods of the world.
From the secret ascertainment of reality,
by the forty-two great magical manifestations,
all are always joined as deities:
all without exception is the supreme maṇḍala.
This is the natural maṇḍala,
and the three maṇḍalas that surpass it as images:
the maṇḍala surpassing in samādhi,
and those that rely on bodhicitta and on the supreme gathering.
Thus they declared to themselves.

This is the ninth chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the chapter that gathers the utterly secret maṇḍala and teaches the surpassing images.

Then all the Tathāgatas, whose nature is neither one nor many, the very self of all, wishing their own great maṇḍala to arise in all the ten directions of the six worlds, spoke this inspired utterance:

Wisdom is discerned as the four directions and the center.
The inconceivable, spontaneously present maṇḍala
is enjoyed by the yogin who realizes the Great Perfection
as the great maṇḍala from which all arises.
It is a wheel of four spokes with its rim,
adorned with four corner sections and an intermediate courtyard,
square all around, with porches at the doors.
Like massing clouds of varied music,
it is adorned with the forty-two maṇḍalas.
On great thrones of lion, elephant, horse, garuḍa,
and the sky-soaring bird,
upon seats of sun, moon, lotus and jewel,
are those in the manner of perfected buddhas and of sattvas:

the kings of the wheel with their queens,
and, starting from the right, those of seeing, hearing, smelling
and tasting, together with their hosts of consorts.
In the corner sections abide the agents of seeing,
of hearing, of smelling and of tasting,
together with their consorts.
In the intermediate courtyard, the six sages are shown to abide,
and in front and behind, the doer
and the lord of deeds.
At the four porches the destroyers
abide with their hosts of consorts.
Vajra, wheel, jewel,
lotus, sword, blazing bell,
utpala flower, nāga tree and other emblems
they hold as pleasing implements in a beautiful manner.
Blue, white, golden yellow,
green and other various colors,
supple, entwined, swaying, youthful,
clear and gleaming, majestic and splendid,
great masses of radiating light,
swirling with blazing garlands:
pervading without center or edge,
the inconceivable maṇḍala is spontaneously present.
The supreme great mudrā of body,
though it never moves from the expanse of suchness,
in order to tame all beings without exception
shows the form body of genuine liberation
and various bodies in keeping with them.
The showing itself is like an illusion or a mirage;
that very manner has no movement from the expanse.
While unmoving, it appears in variety:
then, to the various discordant beings,
it appears in a form like each of them.
Though it is not contrived by suchness,
it appears individually through the force of residual karma,
like, for example, a mirror or the moon in water.
Then, to all the six classes of beings,

it appears in forms that renounce wrongdoing:
to novices, in the form of an arhat;
to pratyekabuddhas, in the manner of the rhinoceros;
and further, according to the stages of the supreme vehicle.
In the unsurpassed supreme abode of Akaniṣṭha
the body is in the form of Vairocana.
To the retinues of bodhisattvas,
likewise, without uttering supreme speech,
he teaches through the body so that they comprehend all phenomena.
Just as when a mirror is shown,
all the blemishes on the actual face are removed,
so when the retinue gazes upon the body,
the obscurations to awakening, of unfathomable depth,
appear in the body as in a mirror.
Then the ten grounds arise in sequence,
and they attain unsurpassed, perfect awakening:
the dharmakāya, immeasurable and inexpressible;
the enjoyment body, an inexhaustible treasure of jewels;
emanations by inconceivable tens of millions;
all the major and minor marks complete;
the domain everywhere a maṇḍala;
the two great accumulations perfected in play;
the supreme ground of means and wisdom;
these and others, inconceivable and supreme.
The svastika body, without birth or death,
abides in the field of all afflictions
and has become an inexhaustible treasure.
The body of the vajra knowledge holder,
the body of equality in which all is indivisible,
the wisdom body of omniscience:
then all five bodies are complete.

When this had been spoken, in all the endless and boundless ten directions of the six worlds, maṇḍalas beyond telling, as many as the atoms of the buddha fields, became clearly manifest.

Then this very secret of those maṇḍalas of great qualities of the Tathāgatas, inseparable from their hosts of consorts, came forth from the vajra of body,

speech, mind, qualities and activity:

"Aho!
Object of focus, without focus, unobservable, immeasurable, inconceivable:
the various maṇḍalas of self-aware wisdom are beyond all telling.
Equal and unequal, all-pervading, the expanse that pervades without pervading;
clear to all from the very beginning, the maṇḍalas are emanated, yet without elaboration.
All-pervading from the very beginning, inconceivable maṇḍalas as many as the atoms of the fields;
fully emanated from the very beginning, the essence abides in all, yet has no abiding."
So it was said, in secret vajra words.
"ao," so it was said, in secret words.

This is the tenth chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the chapter on the emanation of maṇḍalas.

Then all the Tathāgatas abided in equality, and the whole inconceivable retinue as well made offerings to themselves with delight. Samantabhadra was pleased, and, dwelling in the self-arisen celestial palace that is the dwelling place of all the Tathāgatas of the ten directions and four times without exception, made of various precious jewels, inconceivable, immeasurable and vast, pervading without edge or center, its rays of light unobstructed, they spoke this inspired utterance:

Their own expanse itself radiates beyond all measure.
The maṇḍala, unbroken on every side,
is the domain of the perfect union of the three realms of existence,
arisen from the supreme cause that transcends grasping at characteristics.
The Tathāgata of utterly pure mastery,
dwelling in the abode of Akaniṣṭha,
the unsurpassed delight free of apprehended and apprehender,
the Lord honored by the chiefs of the worldly retinue,
and the others who dwell in the world-realms of the ten directions,
through the taste of nectar accomplish joy and great bliss.
Those of the past and those yet to come,
free of the stain of the three poisons, who have vanquished the hosts of Māra,
are joined in suchness.

Drawing forth the definitive meaning that unites wisdom and means,
meditate on the great means of awareness as mastery itself.
One will be adorned with inexhaustible accumulations of merit,
emptiness, wishlessness and signlessness, luminous by nature.
bhruṃ
Dwelling upon a self-arisen sun, moon, lotus and vast jewel,
those who have realized vajra equality
play spontaneously in the great perfection of equality.
The expanse of the Sugatas, abiding as suchness,
is gathered in equality with all the Victors of the four times.
It arises from Vajradhara of body, speech and mind,
who has realized all as the maṇḍala of luminosity.
Listen to the definitive meaning of the equality of the four times,
a domain that cannot be stolen, beyond all telling.
Through the power of compassion they dwell in the places and times of the six classes of beings.
Knowing the expanse in which "I" and selflessness are equal,
the aim of equality is accomplished by the Vajra Holder.
The nonconceptual body of the Vajra Holder of awakening,
by supreme wisdom, encompasses all without exception:
the Sugatas come into the state of nonabiding equality.
Through great means, unmixed and wholly concealed,
the Sugatas realize the nonreferential expanse itself,
the expanse of means and wisdom, most sublime of all.
Reaching to the very limits of the abodes of the expanse of the ten directions and four times,
holding the clear state endowed with supreme wisdom,
radiating the various blessings of compassion,
the source from which all Sugatas without exception arise,
possessing and radiating inexhaustibly like a wish-fulfilling jewel,
it will be realized by the great king of self-awareness.

Thus they spoke this inspired utterance to themselves, in secret vajra words.

This is the eleventh chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the chapter on erecting the celestial palace, the net of skillful means.

Then from the vajra of the body, speech and mind of all the Tathāgatas together with their hosts of consorts, these came forth:

bhruṃ viśva viśuddhe hūṃ vajra bhṝk oṃ jīna jīka svā ratna ṅhṝk āṃ ārolīka hāṃ brajñā ṅhṝk māṃ dhātvāśvari lāṃ dveṣarati māṃ moharati pāṃ rāgarati tāṃ vajrarati kṣīṃ hirājāya traṃ ākaśagarbhāya hrī ha hūṃ vadama jri kurupāṇa hrī hūṃ lāsye samaya stvaṃ traṃ mālye samaya hoḥ hrī gīti rāgo'haṃ a nṛdya rāgayamī mai dhāraṇi svāhā blhīṃ nissarama vāya svāhā hūṃ svarājāya svāhā muṃ śrī araṃgāya svāhā jaḥ dhūpa praviśa hūṃ puṣpa aviśa vaṃ dīpa sukhini ho gandhe cittaṃ hūṃ yamānta krit phaṭ prajñānta krit phaṭ hūṃ vighnānta krit phaṭ hūṃ padmānta krit phaṭ oṃ mahā vajradtara mahā krodheśvari jvalanī phaṭ oṃ mahā ratnadhara mahā krodteśvari jvalani phaṭ oṃ mahā rantadhara mahā krodteśvari jvalanī phaṭ oṃ mahā padmadhara mahā krodheśvari jvalanī phaṭ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ vajra citta hūṃ a a a vajra vtadra samanta a oṃ mune krīṃ svāhā oṃ mune truṃ svāhā oṃ mune spuṃ svāhā oṃ mune vraṃ svāhā oṃ mune kṣa svāhā oṃ mune ye svāhā ehyehi bhagavāna mahākārunika triśya ho samaya staṃ jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥ oṃ āḥ hūṃ svāhā va va va va va jra jra jra jra jra sa sa sa sa sa ma ma ma ma ma ya ya ya ya ya oṃ āḥ hūṃ svāhā

oṃ King of wisdom, body, speech and mind,
great marvel of qualities and activity:
in reality itself, may I become
the great mudrā of union!

oṃ vajra samaya hūṃ oṃ vajra samaya stvaṃ oṃ vajra samaya ho

When these were spoken, these maṇḍalas of speech resounded, pervading all the ten directions of the six worlds.

This is the twelfth chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the chapter on secret mantra.

Then the Blessed One, the male Vajra Agent and the female Vajra Action, dissolved into the nondual maṇḍala. Then, from the vajra Net of Illusion of body, speech and mind, there came forth this, called "Gathering the Wisdom and Blessings of the Great Self of the Tathāgatas of the Ten Directions and Three Times":

oṃ śūnyatā jñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ oṃ mahā ādarśa śūnyatā jñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ oṃ mahā pratyavekṣeṇā śūnyatā jñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ oṃ mahā samanta śūnyatā jñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ oṃ mahra kṛtya anuṣṭhāna śūnyatā jñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ oṃ sarva tathāgata mahā kāya vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ oṃ

sarva tathāgata mahā vāka vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ oṃ sarva tathāgata mahā citta vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ oṃ sarva tathāgata mahā anurāgaṇa vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ oṃ sarva tathāgata mahā pūja vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ

When these were spoken, they dissolved; they became clear; they blazed.

How wonderful! The marvelous and amazing Dharma,
the secret of all the perfect buddhas,
transcends all sounds, names and words,
yet various sounds arise clearly from it.
The single speech, the limbs of the maṇḍala,
inconceivable, pervades everywhere.
Sounds, names and words resound each in their own way;
all of them are the supreme mudrā of speech.
From the supreme tantra, the great tantra of the Net,
the meaning of blissful speech arises as well.
When all has become the state of the lotus,
the sounds of the path of liberation and of saṃsāra,
whatever is said, are supreme speech.
All the vehicles, high and low,
and the languages of all who go astray, without exception,
are gathered into the vajra speech of awakening.
Gathered, it resounds through the ten directions.
Sound itself is spoken in the state of non-attachment;
in the very speaking there is nothing expressed.
That inexpressible itself is various sounds,
resounding to all and understood by each in their own way.
For example, it is like the clearing of a sneeze:
by the sound of a single speech all understand.
This is the king of supreme speech.
Though the vehicles, high and low, are inconceivable,
they are not spoken apart from suchness;
as means of taming they are heard each in its own way.
However all the scriptures may be uttered,
suchness has spoken nothing.
Speech without letters, the speech of awareness,
though never brought forth on the tip of the tongue,
through the blessing of compassionate speech

makes clear the various aims of beings, each in its own way.
That clarity is the supreme vajra of speech.
Thus through speech the aims of beings are fulfilled,
though it never moves from the state of suchness,
like, for example, the sound of an echo.

This is the thirteenth chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the chapter on gathering the maṇḍala and on secret mantra.

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, spoke this inspired utterance, called "The Essence That Shows His Own Mudrās":

oṃ hūṃ vajrasatva hūṃ vajra prabhāna hūṃ mūṃ vajra gandha hūṃ oṃ cakra maṇḍala hūṃ āṃ lāṃ vajra ganbhāṣa lāṃ svā ratna prabhāna svāṃ oṃ vajra gandha bhāṣa āṃ oṃ padma prabhāna āṃ paṃ vajra gandha prabhāna pāṃ hāṃ vajra ga tīkṣṇa prabhāna haṃ taṃ vajra ganadha bhāṣa prabhāna taṃ śī ratna prabhāna śī hūṃ vajra gandha prabhāna ghoṣa hūṃ trāṃ khaḍga prabhāna trāṃ trāṃ vajra gandha bhāṣa prabhāna tri hrīḥ padma prabhāna hrīḥ vajra gandha bhāṣa prabhāna hrīḥ ha vajra gandha bhāṣa prabhāna haṃ a vajra gandha bhāṣa prabhāna āḥ me kāla prabhāna me hūṃ vajra gandha prabhāna bhāṣa hūṃ thāṃ prabhāna maṇḍala thāṃ svāṃ vajra gandha bhāṣa haṃ prabhāna svāṃ hūṃ ratna svaṃ sādha bhadra prabhāna svā hrīḥ vajra gandha bhāṣa prabhāna hrīḥ mu utpala nīla vrabhāna mu ā vajra gandha bhāṣa prabhāna āḥ phaṭ vajra amaḥ mutgara prabhāna phaṭ phaṭ oṃ vajra gandha bhāṣa prabhāna oṃ oṃ phaṭ mahā vajra prabhāna phaṭ phaṭ hūṃ mahā ratna vajra ganadha bhāṣa prabhāna hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ hriḥ padma mutgara prabhāna hrī hrīḥ oṃ mahā vajra padma vajra gandha bhāṣa prabhāna hrīḥ hrīḥ a karma mutgara vajra prabhāna phaṭ phaṭ a karma vajra gandha bhāṣa prabhāna hūṃ a a a

When these were spoken, the maṇḍala of mudrā and speech became clear everywhere; it blazed.

This is the fourteenth chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the chapter on perfecting the maṇḍala of mudrā and speech from ultimate and relative bodhicitta.

Then the Tathāgata, from the teaching of the King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, showed that all phenomena are gathered into the expanse of space and of the Mother, and spoke this inspired utterance:

The supreme secret of the genuine meaning:
in the maṇḍala of the mind of bliss,
the forty-two of great definitive meaning,
wish-fulfilling jewels, clear and blazing, dissolve.
All without exception is the expanse of the bindu.
All the many rays of light of the five bodies,
all of them, dissolve into the expanse that has become the Mother,
and it becomes the lord of clouds, clear and blazing.
The drop of bodhicitta
pervades all and yet does not abide;
it is not color, location or shape.
The essence of supreme qualities
is never the domain of logicians.
It is the domain of those clear and steadfast
who are thoroughly trained in the profound and vast;
it is not to be sought or examined elsewhere.
All has the character of space.
The various worlds, stable and moving,
and all the manifest appearances of the Victors:
there is nowhere in the four times and ten directions
that has not become the expanse of space.
It is the domain of the Sugatas of the three times.
Into the expanse of space realized by the Sugatas of old
all things dissolve.
All is the very expanse of wisdom;
expanse is wholly joined with expanse.
Through the richness of the expanse of wisdom
it is the vajra bindu of awakening.
With the spontaneously present maṇḍala palace
and the inconceivable that is free of limits,
pervading all and yet not abiding,
it is the abode of supreme qualities.
The uncontrived moment of continuity:
there is nothing that it does not hold.
It is not one's own conceptual thought.
Those who have rightly gone, wrong conceptions,
and other hosts of many emanations,
all of them throughout the ten directions without exception:

in it there is nothing to destroy and nothing to grasp.
It is not color, shape or location.
Noble beings who desire the supreme,
always strive diligently to make it clear!
Its final result
is the single time that has no cause and result.
All, as the characteristic of name,
has been perfected in three syllables.
Gathered by the wheel of inexhaustible ornament,
the two great accumulations too are perfected in play.
One enters the expanse without arising or perishing.
All the endless, inconceivable worlds,
both transcendent and mundane,
dissolve into the expanse of the Mother of the Victors.
All without exception is gathered into the dharmakāya.
Ho! All phenomena have the character of names.

This is the fifteenth chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the utterly secret chapter on all things being gathered into the expanse of the Mother.

Then all the Tathāgatas spoke this inspired utterance, called "Blessing All the Limbs as Spontaneously Present as the Maṇḍala":

Because all is fully perfected by the Net of Illusion,
all things are seals of supreme awakening.
The essential mudrā of the secret ascertainment of reality
is hard to transgress.
The letters of the unshakable sun disk
and the letters of the precious moon disk,
the two fives emanated as a pair:
joining them is the cause from which the mudrās arise.
Joining the tips of the two, oṃ and mūṃ,
crossing the eight syllables and bringing them together at the tips,
is the seal that bestows great bliss
in union with all the Victors.
Concealing four syllables, press the hand to the heart;
raise hūṃ, and at its tip a vajra blazes.
The moon, bending and concealing its syllables, rings the bell,

and in an embracing manner is steadfast in the Dharma.
Concealing four syllables, press the hand to the heart;
at the tip of mūṃ the ringing bell blazes.
The five syllables of the sun entwine in activity;
bowing, she gazes with a smiling radiance.
Concealing four syllables, press the hand to the heart;
raise oṃ, and at its tip a wheel blazes.
The moon, bending and concealing its syllables, rings the bell,
and in an embracing manner is steadfast in the Dharma.
Concealing four syllables, press the hand to the heart;
at the tip of lāṃ the ringing bell blazes.
The five syllables of the sun entwine in activity;
bowing, she gazes with a smiling radiance.
Concealing four syllables, press the hand to the heart;
at the tip of svāṃ a jewel blazes.
The moon, bending and concealing its syllables, rings the bell,
and in an embracing manner is steadfast in the Dharma.
Concealing four syllables, press the hand to the heart;
at the tip of māṃ the ringing bell blazes.
With the five syllables of the sun she entwines in activity;
bowing, she gazes with a smiling radiance.
Concealing four syllables, press the hand to the heart;
at the tip of āṃḥ a lotus blazes.
The moon, bending and concealing its syllables, rings the bell,
and in an embracing manner is steadfast in the Dharma.
Concealing four syllables, press the hand to the heart;
raise pāṃ, and at its tip the ringing bell blazes.
The five syllables of the sun entwine in activity;
bowing, she gazes with a smiling radiance.
Concealing four syllables, press the hand to the heart;
at the tip of hāṃ a sword blazes.
The moon, bending and concealing its syllables, rings the bell,
and in an embracing manner is steadfast in the Dharma.
Concealing four syllables, press the hand to the heart;
raise tāṃ, and at its tip the ringing bell blazes.
With the five syllables of the sun she entwines in activity;
bowing, she gazes with a smiling radiance.

The utpala and the other emblems, the nāga tree,
the jewel sprout, the blazing sword,
the white lotus, the blazing vajra,
the wheel of Dharma, the jewel,
beautiful form and the jewel garland,
the lute and the supreme dancer herself,
the flower garland, the lady of incense offering,
the lamp, the perfume and the rest:
they entwine in activity and are steadfast in the Dharma.
Their heads come forward in a bowing manner,
and like the great mudrās above
they dissolve into the state of the nondual expanse.
The great mudrās of the four gates:
raising a human head and pressing down with a vajra,
pressing down with a great garland of skulls,
and pressing down with the activity of the crossed vajra;
the hook, the noose, sphoṭa hoḥ.
Those who abide at the four gates also
bow and embrace as above.
The mudrās of the six sages are various;
in brief, there are six mudrās:
the ringing staff and the lute,
armor, the book, the jewel casket,
and they are shown as fire and water.
The Mother is the nondual dharmadhātu.
Samantabhadra, in meditative equipoise, radiates wisdom,
having become the Mother, equally perfect, the center of the lotus.
There are also various other mudrās:
either that of the Tathāgata himself,
or else the joined vajra palms.
As for the supreme assembly of great mudrās:
when means and wisdom are joined in union,
all things, unmoved and unstirred,
abide in the state of the great mudrā.
It has forty-two limbs;
it is the very self that emanates the limbs,
and blazes as the forty-two without radiating out.

By the supreme chief who is so endowed,
likewise the supreme seals of the Victors
blaze with radiating light, twelve and six,
and so on, inconceivably.
Throughout the inconceivable ten directions and four times,
they show the aims of taming, each in its own way.
To all the vehicles, high and low,
to the inconceivable ones who are perverted,
and to all the great assemblies of the peaceful and wrathful,
they appear everywhere, conforming to each.
It is like, for example, a dancer,
who shows many forms without departing from his own body.
In brief, of all the mudrās
it cannot be said, "It is this one."
They radiate as two and as three;
moving and emanating are suchness itself.
In brief, all movement and stirring
abides in the state of the great mudrā.
The abiding itself is nonabiding, and not abiding either.
Thus it was explained by the supreme pure one himself.

Thumb and index finger: the Vajra Holder.
Thumb and middle finger: the Victor Holder.
Ring finger and thumb: great passion.
Little finger and thumb: supreme goodness.
hūṃ hoḥ
The two index fingers joined: the supreme jewel.
The two middle fingers joined: the aim of splendor.
The two ring fingers joined: the crest banner of the Victors.
With the sound of laughter, join the little fingers.
traṃ te ru ha
Index fingers above and below: supreme Dharma.
Middle fingers above and below: supreme Mañjuśrī.
Ring fingers above and below: the supreme wheel.
Little fingers above and below: the speech that speaks.
hrīḥ phaṃ ṭāṃ haṃ
Index fingers crossed: supreme activity.

Middle fingers crossed: "Protect!"
Ring fingers crossed: the supreme yakṣa.
Little fingers crossed are explained as abiding.
ha truṃ a bhaṃ
Through this great symbolic language of mudrā
the maṇḍala of the buddhas appears in beauty,
the natural maṇḍala, perfect in every excellence.
With both song and mudrā
the vividly clear maṇḍala is called down.
Through the great emanation of mudrā,
the two, the apprehended and the apprehender,
are made clear as pure; therefore it is mudrā.
Through the clarity of each syllable,
transforming them into dance is nirvāṇa.
With jaḥ, hoḥ and the rest,
transforming them into dance binds one in the vajra.

This is the sixteenth chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the chapter on the emanation of mudrās.

Then the Blessed One, glorious Samantabhadra, sang this song called "The Samaya of the Weapon":

hūṃ The vajra of the three, body, speech and mind,
is the wisdom of enlightened body, speech and mind.
The wisdom of enlightened body, speech and mind,
because Vajrasattva abides in it himself,
brandishes and emanates the wisdom vajra.
How wonderful! The supreme great vajra
is given as his name
because it cannot be destroyed or divided by anything,
because it is not moved or mixed by anything,
and because it has become supreme great bliss.
All, too, are sealed with the four mudrās.
In the very mind of the Victors,
in order to show it as the own sign
of all the Vajradhara kings,
it is called the Indivisible Vajradhara.
hūṃ Just as a king with his own seal

seals a royal decree,
so, abiding in the heart of great bliss
and diligent at the time of great power,
one seals all things in that way.
Because, as it is hard to transgress, it is indestructible,
it is the abode of the king's supreme seal,
the great being, the form of the sign.
hūṃ It is proclaimed "mudrā"
because one's own body is stable.

Vajra, vajra, the greatly fierce one,
and the great self that is itself,
by the king of the means of taming,
split, demolished, vanquished, and so forth,
churned up like ashes and atoms:
by this mighty, blazing radiating and gathering,
since all things are vajra itself,
the whole element of space is filled.
From that the vajra speech arises:
oṃ vajra jvalānalārka hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ The wheel of body, speech, and mind, the three,
is the wisdom of enlightened body, speech, and mind;
the wheel of Vairocana is the hero.
Because Vairocana's wheel abides by itself,
it brandishes and sends forth the wheel of wisdom.
How wonderful! The name bestowed
upon the great and supreme wheel:
because it is in no way destructible or divisible,
because it is in no way moved or mixed,
because it has become supreme great bliss,
all, too, are sealed with the four mudrās.
From the very mind of the Victors,
in order to show it as the own sign
of all the Cakradhara kings,
it is called the Indivisible Cakradhara.
hūṃ Just as a king with his own seal
seals a royal decree,

so, abiding in the heart of great bliss
and diligent at the time of great power,
one seals all things in that way.
Because, as it is hard to transgress, it is indestructible,
it is the abode of the king's supreme seal,
the great being, the form of the sign.
It is proclaimed "mudrā"
because one's own body is stable.
oṃ Wheel, wheel, the greatly fierce one,
and the great self that is itself,
by the king of the means of taming,
split, destroyed, vanquished, and so forth,
churned up like ashes and atoms.
hūṃ By this mighty, blazing radiating and gathering,
since all things are the wheel itself,
the whole element of space is filled.
From that the wheel speech arises:
oṃ cakra jvalānalārka hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ The lotus of body, speech, and mind, the three,
is the wisdom of enlightened body, speech, and mind;
the wisdom of enlightened body, speech, and mind
is the Lotus Being (Padmasattva), the hero.
Because it abides by itself as the Lotus Being,
it brandishes and sends forth the lotus axe.
How wonderful! The name bestowed
upon the great and supreme lotus:
it is in no way destructible or divisible,
and because it is in no way moved or mixed,
because it has become supreme great bliss,
all, too, are sealed with the four mudrās.
From the very mind of the Victors,
by all the Padmadhara kings,
in order to show it as their own sign,
it is called the Indivisible Padmadhara.
oṃ Just as a king with his own seal
seals a royal decree,
so, abiding in the heart of great bliss

and diligent at the time of great power,
one sets the seal upon all things in that way.
As it is hard to transgress, it is indestructible,
the abode of the king's supreme seal.
hūṃ The great being, the form of the sign,
is proclaimed "mudrā"
because one's own body is stable.
Lotus axe, the greatly fierce one,
and the great self that is itself,
by the king of the means of taming,
split, demolished, vanquished, and so forth,
churned up like ashes and atoms:
by mighty, blazing radiating and gathering,
since all things are the lotus itself,
the whole element of space is filled.
From that the lotus speech was brought forth:
oṃ padma jvalānalārka hūṃ phaṭ
svāṃ The jewel of body, speech, and mind, the three,
is the wisdom of enlightened body, speech, and mind;
the wisdom of enlightened body, speech, and mind
is the great quality, the hero.
The Jewel Being (Ratnasattva), abiding by itself,
brandishes and sends forth the staff of wisdom.
How wonderful! The name bestowed
upon the great and supreme vajra jewel:
it is in no way destructible or divisible,
and because it is in no way moved or mixed,
because it has become supreme great bliss,
all, too, are sealed with the four mudrās.
svāṃ In the very mind of the Victors,
in order to show it as the own sign
of all the Ratnadhara kings,
it is called the Indivisible Ratnadhara.
svāṃ Just as a king with his own seal
seals a royal decree,
so, abiding in the heart of great bliss
and diligent at the time of great power,

one seals all things in that way.
Because, as it is hard to transgress, it is indestructible,
it is the abode of the king's supreme seal,
the great being, the form of the sign.
It is proclaimed "mudrā"
because one's own body is stable.
Jewel staff, the greatly fierce one,
and the great self that is itself,
by the king of the means of taming,
split, demolished, vanquished, and so forth,
churned up like ashes and atoms:
by mighty, blazing radiating and gathering,
since all things are the jewel itself,
the whole element of space is filled.
From that the jewel speech arises:
svāṃ ratna jvalānalārka svāṃ phaṭ
hūṃ The enlightened activity of body, speech, and mind, the three,
is the wisdom of enlightened body, speech, and mind;
the wisdom of enlightened body, speech, and mind
is the Karma Being (Karmasattva), the hero.
Because it abides by itself as the Karma Being,
it wields and sends forth the sword of wisdom.
How wonderful! The name bestowed
upon the great and supreme karma:
it is in no way destructible or divisible,
and because it is in no way moved or mixed,
because it has become supreme great bliss,
all, too, are sealed with the four mudrās.
hūṃ From the very mind of the Victors,
in order to show it as the own sign
of all the Khaḍgadhara kings,
it is called the Indivisible Khaḍgadhara.
hāṃ Just as a king with his own seal
seals a royal decree,
so, abiding in the heart of great bliss
and diligent at the time of great power,
one seals all things in that way.

Because, as it is hard to transgress, it is indestructible,
it is the abode of the king's supreme seal,
the form of the sign of the great being.
It is proclaimed "mudrā"
because one's own body is stable.
haṃ Sword, sword, the greatly fierce one,
and the great self that is itself,
by the king of the means of taming,
split, demolished, vanquished, and so forth,
churned up like ashes and atoms:
by this mighty, blazing gathering and radiating,
since all things are the sword itself,
the whole element of space is filled.
From that the speech of enlightened activity arose.

hāṃ karma jvalānalārka hūṃ phaṭ
mūṃ From the bell of body, speech, and mind, the three,
enlightened body, speech, and mind themselves become fierce.
In the supreme manner of the great method of ringing,
by brandishing the vajra three times,
goddesses, nāginīs, low-born women,
oath-bound ones, and yogins come under control.
All the yogins and yoginīs that appear
gather into one
and appear manifestly before one's senses.
With the immovable vajra endowed with method,
not passing beyond oṃ and haṃ,
brandish it grandly three times and meditate on a white tent:
it becomes the supreme, vividly present maṇḍala.
Just passing beyond oṃ and haṃ,
oneself abiding as a square on every side,
whoever is diligent in brandishing it three times
will increase in life and fortune,
and enjoyments, whatever is desired, will be accomplished.
Then, with a crescent, red in color and low,
three times, with an even connection,
whoever is diligent in brandishing it wrathfully,

for him whatever the mind is set on, and all activities,
become the very maṇḍala of great power.
Then, abiding in the color of the fierce one,
by fiercely uttering phaṭ,
oneself abiding as black in color,
abiding in the midst of the blazing at the eon's end,
wrathfully, as an act of summoning,
when one hurls it far into the distance,
the activities, whatever is desired, are surely accomplished.
oṃ vajra daha jvala hana vajra paca jvala vajra hūṃ phaṭ
Holding in the hand that which is stable in the Dharma,
its hollow is the bell, the dharma-element,
to be regarded as the assembly of the mother, Prajñā.
Its sound is melodious speech, the blissful woman;
its tongue is the dancer, nirvāṇa.
From the very heart of the dharmakāya mind,
whoever is diligent in ringing it forth
should meditate on the syllables beginning with mūṃ:
vajra, wheel, and lotus blaze.
The maṇḍala of the assembly of muṃ,
all-powerful and delightful,
is accomplished in harmony, just as wished.
oṃ vajra ghaṇḍa pāśa dharma dhāra

When they said hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ, the tathāgatas themselves were delighted with the tathāgatas themselves.

This was the seventeenth chapter, the chapter of homage, the arising of the great magical display as method and wisdom, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then the Tathāgata entered into the absorption of the array of the vajra secret samaya of great delight, and uttered this inspired utterance:

The supreme, most subtle samaya:
on the palm of the hand of the great mudrā,
that sacred maṇḍala of the mind
should be made four finger-widths in size.
With the five grains, the five incenses, the five jewels,

the five essences and the five medicines,
and the five nectars, mixed thoroughly and evenly,
the lines should be laid out by awareness.
With hub and spokes,
the four-pointed wheel with its rim,
with four cut corners and the square,
it should be furnished with the interspace, the courtyards, and the door-frames.
On sun and moon the size of a round fingernail,
a lotus seat the size of a chickpea;
from syllables the size of a mustard seed,
draw the mudrās the size of a sesame seed.
Surround it with various fashioned cloths,
garlands of ornaments, conches, and flavors,
and offer abundantly with massed clouds
of song, dance, and music.
With the consorts, the bestowing goddesses, and the attendant goddesses,
make offerings according to the activity desired.
Having invoked the fire that has become the mouth,
endowed with the proper shape, color, and marks,
with hosts of foods, drinks, and flavors,
give abundantly the offerings of the four activities.
The maṇḍala of the wrathful ones is likewise:
by training in what is extremely subtle,
do likewise for inconceivable ones,
just to the measure that awareness can gauge.
As for the great mudrā of offering:
with the wish-fulfilling cloud masses of the mind,
the buddha fields in all the ten directions,
grounds of various jewels, soft and smooth, blissful to touch,
beautifully drawn and adorned,
blazing heaps of all-producing jewels,
well-shaped ponds, cool and of the finest fragrance,
various houses of jewels,
ornaments and groves of wish-fulfilling trees,
the sound of songs and verses,
canopies, victory banners, garments, parasols,

necklaces, armlets, and bracelets,
the finest foods and drinks,
and gods and goddesses as numerous as atoms,
adorned with their own beauty,
with inconceivable dances and the like,
fill the element of space in the ten directions,
and offer them extensively to all the maṇḍalas.
Through the clear pervasion of the fortunate one,
gradually or else all at once,
uniting evenly with the dharma-expanse,
meditate on the great mudrā of offering.
In the radiant one or in what is blessed,
in the way the trichiliocosm enters a mustard seed,
invite the maṇḍala from the expanse and make offerings.
When they are pleased, this is the supreme samaya of accomplishment.
Through the offering of the great being,
all the buddha maṇḍalas without exception are pleased,
and all beings of the three existences without exception
are pervaded by great joy.
Through stability in the Net of Illusion,
all the buddha maṇḍalas without exception
of those gone in the ten directions and the four times,
and the beings of the three realms, become manifest.
Body, speech, mind, and all phenomena
abide nowhere and are unobservable;
by joining, like an optical illusion,
with the nature of reality, equal in intrinsic nature,
meditate on space within space.
Into the great maṇḍala thus made familiar,
the all-creating lord enters by awareness.
Then the disciples should be brought in.
Then that supreme child of good family
should offer his kingdom and his own body,
his children and wife, his wealth and riches,
what is most cherished and pleasing.
Having offered the five sovereign enjoyments,
one has made offering to all the maṇḍalas;

what need to mention the nearby maṇḍala?
All faults become purified.
Having thoroughly ascertained their faith, diligence, and discipline,
the beneficial empowerments and the empowerments of capacity
should be conferred in their proper order.
Hold them with compassion, so they are not wasted.
Or else, having crossed the palms,
within the span of the great hand
make the maṇḍala one finger in size.
The wise should do it according to the rite.
Or else, on level ground,
make the maṇḍala one cubit in size,
or else the size of one body,
or else the measure of three bodies.
Pegs, measuring cords, and colored powders,
clothes, ornaments, a beautiful and pleasing companion,
and the excellent rite of laying out the lines:
one great in learning should do this with care.
Or else make it sixteen cubits,
twenty, or twenty-five.
Meditate on the maṇḍalas of the five families,
and set out the forms endowed with body, speech, and mind.
Or else, over an earshot, a league,
or the inconceivable expanse of space,
meditate on the various buddha maṇḍalas.
To show it to the deluded who have not seen,
it should be drawn with colors,
with twenty-five colors or with five.
Open it according to the rite of taming,
with the supreme, infinite music of samādhi.
Whether with syllables, seats, or essences,
or with mudrās, or endowed with body, speech, and mind,
the wondrous and marvelous blessing,
the samaya of all buddhas, will be accomplished.
Making the grounds and so forth into mudrās,
one attains liberation stage by stage.
What need to mention what is done by pure wisdom?

It is that very thing.
The maṇḍala of the directions and times, the great being,

From the unobservable maṇḍala of the mind,
all the maṇḍalas are invited.
Into the maṇḍala indivisible from self-appearance,
the characteristic of entering is union in equality.
The wisdom of the body, speech, and mind
of those gone from all directions and times
is the undaunted Samantabhadrī.
Because Samantabhadrī abides by herself,
she rings and sends forth the bell of wisdom.
How wonderful! The name bestowed
upon the great mother of the buddhas:
she is in no way destructible or divisible,
and because she is in no way moved or mixed,
because she has become the mother of great bliss,
all, too, are sealed with the five mother mudrās.
mūṃ From the very mind of Samantabhadrī,
in order to show it as the own sign
of all the great vajra mothers,
she is called the Indivisible Bell-Holder.
mūṃ Just as, having arranged the royal seat,
a king issues a great decree,
so, abiding as the mother of great bliss
and diligent at the time of great power,
one seals all things in that way.
Because, as it is hard to transgress, it is indestructible,
it is the abode of the king's supreme seal,
the great mother herself, the form of the sign.
It is proclaimed "mudrā"
because one's own body is stable.
mūṃ Bell, bell, of melodious renown,
and the great self that is the mother herself,
by the queen of the means of taming,
split, demolished, vanquished, and so forth,
churned up like ashes and atoms:

by this mighty, blazing radiating and gathering,
since all things are the bell itself,
the whole element of space is filled.
From that the speech of the dharmakāya arises.

When mūṃ gha jvalānalārka mūṃ was said, it appeared as an assembly of mudrās.

This was the eighteenth chapter, the song of the mudrās of the weapons and samayas, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then the Blessed One, the glorious Samantabhadra, uttered this inspired utterance called "The Arising of Method and Wisdom":

Then, in harmony with mind and Dharma,
the mudrā of the mind is Vajradhara,
the bell of wisdom is stable in the Dharma,
and the essences of hūṃ and mūṃ blaze.
From that a ten-pointed vajra blazes:
regard it as supreme with oṃ and mūṃ.
Wisdom is the sun's rays, method the full moon;
with a blazing mass it relies on the Dharma.
From that, by the two ways of holding,
the five grains become the very mudrās.
From that, holding a vajra in the hand, one brandishes it;
from that, holding a wheel in the hand, one brandishes it;
from that, one holds a jewel in the hand;
from that, holding a lotus in the hand, one grasps;
from that, holding a sword in the hand, one cuts.
That very one, holding the vajra in the hand,
brandishes it properly in the six great methods.
From that come the two ways of holding the vajra:
as the symbols of oṃ and mūṃ,
the ten-pointed vajra, the great method,
blazes in the manner of being stable at the heart.
The buddha Vajrasattva
holds the fearless one in his hand at his heart.
From mūṃ comes the great mudrā:
with the blazing ring of the bell, the mother of the buddhas

holds it as relying on the Dharma, the object of offering.
All, in every way, belongs to the mudrā:
method and wisdom are Vajradhara;
body, speech, and mind, all of them,
and qualities and activities are wholly complete.
Visualize the buddha Vajradhara,
awakened through the Net of Illusion.
From that comes the one holding the supreme vajra;
from that, the path of the immovable sun.
From the qualities of body, speech, and mind,
holding at the tip the oṃ hūṃ svāṃ,
in the manner of being truly generated from itself,
examine it closely as the mother, Prajñā.
Firmly supported by the blazing vajra,
the mind of great method is the father of the buddhas.
It is not at all one or many;
from that dawns the activity for the welfare of beings.
From the great manner of the king Vajradhara,
thoroughly examined as mind and Dharma,
brandishing the vajra fiercely three times,
by reciting the fierce mantra and generating it,
the maṇḍala of approach is fully completed.
This is the supreme samaya of drawing near.
Wish-fulfilling trees and wish-fulfilling
jewels, riches, and all the elements
do not exist as substances;
they are the stability of the merit of one's own mind.
Wondrous, miraculous, and marvelous dharmas
do not come into being from elsewhere;
wisdom itself, relying on method,
arises in such a state.
Because the suchness of the expanse of wisdom
has become the mudrā of method,
wisdom plays within wisdom.
Whatever amasses that very play of wisdom,
the manifest arising of the Victors, the protectors,
and the teachers of blessing are likewise:

by the splendor of the power to accomplish acts,
it is the supreme, mighty illusory vajra.
Having completed the five rites,
endowed in full with the five requisites,
through the completion of the five limbs of mantra,
one who strives to engage without lapse
will, in six times thirty days,
or in twelve, fourteen, or sixteen,
accomplish the sacred one of the family of mastery.
Then, within sixteen lifetimes at most,
the five kāyas are spontaneously complete:
in that very bindu of wisdom
the bindu of wisdom itself appears,
inconceivable, infinite, supreme.
The inconceivable pure realms
fully manifest in the ten directions and the four times,
the immeasurable palaces free of limits,
the wheels, ornaments, and hosts of music,
all the inconceivable maṇḍalas without exception:
having seen these, one is intimately pleased,
and from the vast speech the meaning arises.
The harmonious wisdom is self-appearing.
Suchness, free of one and many,
without edge or center,
is not seen even by the buddhas themselves;
self-arisen wisdom appears without location.
Wrong conceptions and imputations are purified,
and because it is not other than the expanse of wisdom,
because it is connected through great compassion,
the six classes of beings, their times and abodes, all appear.
The maṇḍala of great bliss:
having made two or else five consort pairs,
if one with faith thoroughly enters,
desire becomes delightful and equal.
That wisdom of equal fortune,
if one pursues it, the great wonder
of intimate equality will surely arise;

if one without faith lapses, one will come to ruin.

Thus was the inspired utterance.

This was the nineteenth chapter, the secret samaya of the vajra array.

Then the Tathāgata spoke this method for receiving the accomplishment of the maṇḍala of the image, the special teaching from the King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion.

In the maṇḍala of primordial equality,
having joined method and wisdom,
by the king of self-aware wisdom,
all without exception, the maṇḍala,
in the immeasurable palace of suchness,
through that which has arisen as awareness,
meditate on the great mudrā of the dharmakāya,
which is equal yet does not abide in equality.
Although the maṇḍala of intrinsic nature abides
in all the world, the stable and the moving,
through the noose of the concepts of apprehended and apprehender,
self-awareness is obscured and bound as a self.
So that all may truly realize it,
the image of the dharmakāya is shown in this way.
For the sake of concepts purified, nonconceptual self-awareness,
and the complete meaning of the true great method,
various jewels and the like,
and all things made from the four elements,
all of them are causes of supreme awakening.
Forms and the like drawn as pictures:
the great wisdom, in its all-pervading reach,
has never said they do not become meaningful.
Likewise, through the maṇḍala of samādhi,
having gathered everything into the expanse
and dissolved it into one's own heart,
all is the great mudrā of the dharmakāya.
By purifying the three kinds of maṇḍala,
in the maṇḍala of the expanse of space,
through the gathering and radiating of self-aware wisdom,

all is the great mudrā of the dharmakāya.
Through the distinction of true realization,
having meditated clearly on the objects of samādhi,
in the continuous flow of Māmakī
is the true great mudrā of the dharmakāya.
Having meditated clearly on samādhi in this way,
so as to complete the supreme aim without exception,
in the maṇḍala radiating through the sky
the stainless mudrā of the dharmakāya is clear.
With the expanse and suchness not two,
having gained mastery through samādhi,
transform it into colors, shapes, and forms,
and various activities are fully displayed.
The supreme essences of meaning, too,
the factors of awakening, are fully completed,
surrounded by the supreme lords of the world.
ahoḥ From those mudrās of the dharmakāya,
accomplish the maṇḍala of the five activities.
If one gains mastery through samādhi,
it is accomplished just as one focuses on it.
In order to tame the violent and fierce,
having meditated on oneself as wrathful,
with the black dharmakāya blazing with light,
one should press down the liṅga of the obstructors.
Even the fierce and ferocious will be destroyed,
and the adverse side, too, is crushed to dust.
In this life and in all destinies,
one comes to possess exceedingly great and fierce power.
In order to gather all into the nondual expanse,
meditate on oneself as Hayagrīva.
Having meditated clearly on the red dharmakāya,
spread out the adverse ones as a seat.
If one blesses it through clarity of samādhi,
all without exception are brought under control.
Even the mighty follow behind
and will perform whatever acts are desired.
In order to increase all qualities,

oneself as the supreme bull among the Victors,
meditate on the mudrā the color of gold,
and set whatever is to increase as the seat of the dharmakāya.
If one blesses it through such purity,
qualities equal to the limits of space,
life and enjoyments, will increase,
and it is accomplished just as one focuses on it.
Through the blessing of great compassion,
in order to pacify all the fierce and wrathful without exception,
meditate on the white and shining dharmakāya,
with whatever is fierce and wrathful as the seat of the peaceful one.
If one blesses it with samādhi in this way,
even the fierce and ferocious will be pacified.
Others, too, just as one focuses on them,
become peaceful and tamed.
Through the wisdom of omniscience,
gathering the fourfold maṇḍala into the expanse,
engage in the maṇḍala without act or agent:
the spontaneously present maṇḍala is complete from the beginning.
ahoḥ The great mudrā of the dharmakāya
surely bestows whatever accomplishment is wished.
Whatever close deity one practices,
if one writes its mudrā essence and places it inside,
whatever one meditates on is accomplished without doubt.
That is equal to all the Victors;
without doubt it will surely be accomplished.
If one practices a worldly deity,
whatever deity's essence it may be,
if one writes it and places it inside the maṇḍala,
that deity will be intimately accomplished.
If one writes the dharmatā of dependent origination,
one will realize the meanings of the Dharma,
and having realized the specific and general meanings,
one realizes that there is no birth, aging, sickness, or death.
On those great mudrās,
if one writes without error the meaning of the essence
that purifies afflictions and karmas,

the suffering of the lower realms will cease to be.
Moreover, inconceivable maṇḍalas,
immeasurable great mudrās,
body, speech, and mind without interruption,
and pure realms equal to koṭis of atoms.
aho So it is, in the words of the vajra secret.

This was the twentieth chapter, the method of taking accomplishment through the image, the special teaching from the Net of Illusion: the chapter on establishing the stūpa.

Then the Blessed One entered into the samādhi called "Great Delight, the King Who Bestows Empowerment," and uttered this inspired utterance:

From the mudrā of wisdom and method,
the clear stream of the mass of seeds of bliss,
from the vajra path into the center of the lotus,
dissolving from the tip, transforms the maṇḍala.
In the immeasurable palace of the wheel of hearing,
the very essence of the clear bindu,
from the supreme assembly of the mudrās of traṃ,
the jewel maṇḍala clearly radiates and dissolves.
traṃ The great secret of the secret, the supreme secret,
and all the secrets are to be kept alike.
Apart from realizing the very meaning of the secret,
it is not to be spoken of otherwise.
In the immeasurable palace of the wheel of clarity,
the very essence of the clear bindu,
from the supreme assembly of the garland of letters,
the maṇḍala of the family clearly radiates and dissolves.
oṃ Great heir of the Victors of the three times,
pair of vajras of body, speech, and mind,
pleasing and making offerings to all the Victors,
unite equally with all the Victors.
In the immeasurable palace of the wheel of the hands,
the very essence of the clear bindu,
from the supreme assembly of the mudrās of hūṃ,
the karma maṇḍala clearly radiates and dissolves.
oṃ Since you are vajra karma,

perform all actions without exception!
All the many messengers gathering and radiating
are doing whatever you need.
In the immeasurable palace of the wheel of speech,
the very essence of the secret bindu,
from the supreme assembly of the mudrās of hrīḥ,
the wheel of Dharma clearly radiates and dissolves.
oṃ With the unsurpassed nectar of Dharma,
satisfy persons who have faith!
To those of superior, middling, and lesser minds,
proclaim the secret in harmony with them, and not otherwise.
In the immeasurable palace of the wheel of great movement,
the very essence of the clear bindu,
from hūṃ oṃ svaṃ aṃ haṃ,
meditate on the five maṇḍalas and the garland of wrathful ones.
By all of the ten directions and four times,
the great vajra of body, speech, and mind,
the maker of all the maṇḍalas,

enjoys the bestowal of all the maṇḍalas.
Without having pleased the master,
and without having obtained the empowerments,
those who undertake listening and the rest
will be without result and come to ruin.
If one confers empowerment with the crown ornament, the diadem, the garland,
the armor, the victory banner, the mudrā,
the parasol, the vase, food and drink,
and the five essences,
from this time on that heir of the Victors,
being free of all the lower realms
and holding the skill that has become their antidote,
has long life and perfect happiness.
Named Samantabhadra and so forth,
he becomes lord of the higher realms and of liberation.
The ground together with body and aggregates
is to abide on the ground of the vidyādharas.

The ground that abides on the ground of the vidyādharas
becomes the unsurpassed Samantabhadra.
Upon consorts, charming goddesses, and the rest,
that very one bestows blessing.
The many messengers, gathering and radiating,
do not transgress the command of the buddhas
and perform whatever he needs.
Superimposition, denigration, and the like
will swiftly be destroyed.
He has long life and perfect happiness,
and becomes the lord of the higher realms and of liberation.

Thus was the inspired utterance.

This was the twenty-first chapter, the conferral of empowerment, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then the Tathāgata, abiding in great delight, in equality, spoke this method for swiftly taking accomplishment through the special samādhi:

In order to unite with suchness,
one should meditate by means of the ultimate meaning.
Abide holding to the side of awakening.
Abiding in the field of supreme bliss,
meditate spontaneously on the Great Perfection of equality,
and hold it firmly as the mind of awakening.
From non-action, perform act and agent.
Meditate on abiding in the abode of non-abiding.
In the center of the bhaga, the liṅga and a:
having meditated on them as exceedingly shining and clear,
with radiating, blazing light pervading everything,
and having burned the abodes of the lower realms of the three times,
the radiated light dissolves into the center of the bhaga.
Having dissolved, light radiates and blazes from the expanse.
From the mother the moon and sun blaze,
dispelling the darkness of confusion in the ten directions,
the medicine that cools affliction and suffering.
The blessing of compassion is inconceivable;
the mudrās of display are inconceivable.

Though there are many rainbow clouds in the sky,
all are gathered into the expanse of space.
Though omniscience itself is inconceivable,
all gather into the dharmadhātu.
All becomes the syllable hūṃ.
That very hūṃ is the center of secret compassion.
By radiating light rays it becomes three syllables,
or else light rays of five syllables,
the fivefold meaning elaborated into forty-five,
and other supreme, inconceivable maṇḍalas as well.
Abiding in the uncontrived state,
meditate on the maṇḍala of superior wisdom.
A full moon the size of a round fingernail
should be placed in the center of the heart.
In the full disk of the sun,
an immeasurable palace, a house blazing with light rays,
a lotus seat and a jewel;
in its center abides the syllable hūṃ,
exceedingly subtle, a blazing mustard seed.
Meditate on it thoroughly in one place,
in three places, and in five places.
Becoming familiar with the eye of wisdom,
so that it could be seen even with the eye of a man (nṛ),
meditate on it as exceedingly subtle and clear.
Having become very clear-minded and familiar,
into the world systems of the ten directions, as numerous as atoms,
radiate the inconceivable blessings of compassion.
Though they are radiated, nothing is lost from the hūṃ;
though they are gathered, the ten directions do not diminish.
From suchness, without radiating or gathering,
it dissolves into the syllable muṃ.
Having dissolved, the mudrā blazes from the expanse:
exceedingly clear and blended,
meditate clearly on the very body of the mudrā.
That body, full of color and blazing with light,
the seal endowed with method and wisdom:
meditate on it radiating and blazing with light and acting for beings' welfare.

Or else, as the great mudrā,
imagine oneself with one face and two arms,
or meditate always with three faces and six arms.
The immeasurable palaces and the thrones
are in the subtle manner, as before.
Endowed with all the major and minor marks,
with a crown ornament of five letters,
the vajra, wheel, and sword blaze,
and the jewel, lotus, and bell blaze.
From those great mudrās,
the immeasurable palaces of all ten directions without exception,
sun, moon, planets, stars, maṇḍalas, seats, and ornaments:
meditate on all the maṇḍalas of the sugatas without exception.
The blessings of compassion act for the welfare of beings.
It should be known that the peaceful ones radiate in one direction.
It purifies the ten grounds equally
and perfects the retinue of the sugatas.
That supreme one of the family who practices in this way,
even though the result has not manifestly ripened,
will never meet with any suffering,
will fully attain the complete marks of gods and humans,
will never be born into the Lesser Vehicle,
and will not be parted from the arising of the sugatas:
he has entered the dhāraṇī of awakening.

Thus he spoke to himself, in the words of the vajra secret.

This was the twenty-second chapter, the accomplishment of Vajrasattva, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then the Tathāgata entered into the absorption called "Great Delight, Transforming the King of the Net of Illusion," and uttered this inspired utterance:

The single cause, the mode of the syllables,
blessing, and direct perception:
through these four kinds of realization,
all is manifestly perfected as the great king.
Limbs, sense faculties, and all the consciousnesses

should be known as ripened into oṃ.
Meditate on them as the perfect maṇḍala itself,
or else meditate on the wrathful maṇḍala.
Form, sound, smell, taste, touch, and the rest
should be known as ripened into muṃ.
Meditate on them as the maṇḍala of the consorts,
or else meditate on the maṇḍala of the wrathful goddesses.
Clothing, ornaments, food and drink, songs and words,
the massed clouds of dance and gesture:
if one enjoys them fully, knowing them as hūṃ,
the wondrous and marvelous
maṇḍalas will all, without exception, be pleased.
Goddesses, nāginīs, women of low caste,
whether they are distinguished or not distinguished,
in approach and close approach,
in accomplishment and great accomplishment,
into the lotus maṇḍala of the consort
emanate the maṇḍala of blissful mind.
Into all the cloud-masses of buddhas without exception
absorb it through the supreme gift of equal delight.
That accomplished essence of sun and moon,
those very beings of the six destinies, the times and the places,
are joined in delight as a great offering;
take it up with the vajra tip of the maṇḍala.
Traveling in the sky, radiant blazing, long life, and the rest:
one becomes the lord of wish-fulfilling clouds.
Those who have become fields, the chief ones and the lesser,
the skilled one places in the center of sun and moon.
With the hand of pride, meditate on their formations;
by turning into hūṃ they are completely purified.
Dissolving into the expanse, they blaze as the mudrā,
become the body, majestic with radiating light.
Meditate on Uṣṇīṣavijaya.
How wonderful, the means of liberation from the lower realms!
Primordially unborn suchness,
illusory appearance, in the manner of a mirage:
although all the acts of union and liberation are performed,

not even an atom's worth has been done.
Realizing the vessel, its contents, and the continua as pure,
through equality and superior equality,
the maṇḍala, the field of Samantabhadra,
becomes the two great accumulations in deed and conduct.
Then, with limbs undiminished and requisites complete,
through the maṇḍala of the gathering of yogins
who know the rite in its entirety,
the aim of definitive good is accomplished.
Arranging the deities in five clusters,
five combined with five,
ten wrathful males and ten wrathful females,
meditate on them in the manner of a wheel.
The tathāgata and vajra families,
the lotus family, and body, speech, and mind,
together with the host of wrathful ones:
meditate on the deities of three clusters.
The family of families, chief of the families,
the mind of minds, supreme among minds,
together with the host of wrathful ones:
meditate on the deities of a single cluster.
The great host of wrathful males and wrathful females,
and the hosts of messengers, servants, and attendants,
those who ask, "What shall we do?" and the rest,
bring the activities of accomplishment to completion.
The accomplishment of the yogin, the mantra holder,
abides in the state of equal perfection, spontaneously present,
unobstructed in any conduct whatsoever,
all primordially indivisible.
In the vajra family, meditate intensely on all
as the maṇḍala of radiating, blazing light.
Absorb it in a manner free of attachment.
Having become nondual, it is the great mudrā.
Or else, as body, speech, and mind themselves:
all without exception is body, speech, and mind.
In clear samādhi light rays radiate
and dissolve into the state of the nondual expanse.

One will attain the supreme accomplishment of a vidyādhara.
All maṇḍalas without exception are accomplished, blazing.
It dispels afflictions and suffering.
It is the state of birth into the vajra family.
For the genuine accomplishment of the mantra holder,
through all skillful means and wisdom,
meditate on the five maṇḍalas and the garland of wrathful ones.
In a manner free of attachment
emanate light rays of many kinds,
and absorb them nondually.
The essence of supreme accomplishment is achieved.
Through the yoga of skillful means and wisdom,
meditate on oneself as the tathāgatas and the consorts;
meditate on oneself as the male and female sattvas,
each mantra, each mudrā,
and each genuine samādhi individually clear.
With dwelling and enjoyments as one finds comfortable,
fully endowed with an undiminished intellect,
act in accordance with the pledges first received.
Without laziness or apathy,
if one practices without doubt,
all maṇḍalas will be accomplished,
and one attains the sublime, supreme vajra secret.
The days and dates of practice
should be as stated in the tantras.
So it is, in the words of the vajra secret.

Thus the Tathāgata himself uttered this inspired utterance to the Tathāgata himself.

This was the twenty-third chapter, the gathering maṇḍala, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then the Tathāgata, in great delight, sent forth clouds of music and entered into the absorption of the array of ornaments, and uttered this inspired utterance:

The samādhi that rests on the maṇḍala
manifestly perfected through the Net of Illusion:

through the gathering and radiating of the mudrās of dance,
one comes to travel the magical path through the sky.
Through the mudrā of the sounds of songs and words,
one attains the accomplishment of the Dharma.
Through the mudrā of ornaments and clothing,
one unobstructedly accomplishes the blazing king.
Through the mudrā of food and drink,
one accomplishes the wish-fulfilling body and nectar.
Through the mudrā of the vowels and consonants,
being endowed with supreme body, speech, and mind,
all, all is accomplished.
The dhāraṇī of knowing, entering, and attaining the characteristics,
the cause and conditions that ripen the result:
whoever has become endowed with this potency
is renowned as a vidyādhara in the field of the Victors.
Although such a one takes pure births
as a human, a god, or Brahmā,
he abides on a distinguished ground.
The perfections are completed in every respect.
The thirteen distinguished grounds,
supreme among the supreme of skillful means and wisdom,
cause and result distinctively, are spontaneously perfected.
The expanse of space, the clear expanse, sun and moon:
meditate on the king of wisdom in union,
and all the maṇḍalas of the Victors, every one,
will have been meditated upon without exception.
Nowhere in the four times and ten directions
will a perfect buddha be found.
Mind itself is the perfect buddha;
do not seek the buddha elsewhere.
By applying oneself fully to all maṇḍalas,
all maṇḍalas are accomplished.
If the rite has something extra or is incomplete,
the fault itself is pure, and there is no wrongdoing.

When this inspired utterance had been spoken, there was delight through the clouds of music.

Delighted by the clouds of music, he brought forth these words of the vajra secret from the vajra of body, speech, mind, qualities, and activity:

a hoḥ
Through attachment to the delusion that does not see,
phenomena are merely designated by names.
The six destinies, the times and places, the distinct groupings of names that clearly appear,
the domain of the profound and vast, wrongly understood, are mere designated names.
The vowels and consonants and the rest are the very essence of desire.
Mudrās, songs and words, body, speech, and mind:
the buddha perfect in qualities, the great mind of minds,
is itself vividly clear in the mind of equality.
Union pervading equality is the supreme quality, and the activities of mantra are complete.
So it is, in the words of the vajra secret.

This was the twenty-fourth chapter, accomplishing the gathering, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then all the maṇḍalas of the vajra body, speech, and mind of the tathāgatas of the ten directions and four times gathered into one, and in great delight entered into the absorption of the array of clouds of the extremely secret essence of the pledge, in which all phenomena are spontaneously present as primordially the Great Perfection, and uttered this inspired utterance:

Not realizing, realizing wrongly,
realizing in part, and not realizing the genuine itself:
the meanings of what is secret for the sake of discipline, secret in intent, concealed,
and secret by its nature
are fully indicated by words that rest on letters,
on superimposed groupings of names.
Drawing out the hidden, concealed meaning from within,
the Teacher abides in the vajra mind.
By the maṇḍala that possesses the maṇḍala,
meditate on the maṇḍala within the maṇḍala.
The maṇḍala arisen from the maṇḍala,
the maṇḍala of mind, is the supreme maṇḍala.

The secret bindu, the expanse of the maṇḍala,
possessing all of body, speech, mind, and awareness,
is the complete essence of all the sugatas.
The elements are the consorts of the wisdom family;
the great ones are the tathāgatas of the families;
the bodhicitta is the vajra host.
The faculties, objects, times, and awareness:
on this maṇḍala of Samantabhadra
one gazes with the five wisdoms
of the superior mind of the great self.
Through the union of essence and bindu,
with the music of blissful wisdom,
offer delight to wisdom that rejoices.
Through undefiled merit,
wisdom, illusion, appearing of itself,
is the infinite, supreme maṇḍala of music.
The expanse of the secret bindu itself
is the very substance of all buddhas.
To see the face of the very self, without exception,
of the body, speech, qualities, activity, and mind
manifestly perfected in the ten directions and four times
is the sublime, supreme mastery.
Abiding in the maṇḍala, the maṇḍala itself,
the perfect maṇḍala, is spontaneously present.
Continually one holds all maṇḍalas without exception.
From union with the perfect maṇḍala
the maṇḍala of mind arises completely.
The protectors who tame through the maṇḍalas of the directions and times,
by liberating the illusory maṇḍala,
enact the maṇḍala without act or agent.
In the maṇḍala of perfect wisdom,
through the union of hearing, reflection, and meditation,
the self-arisen is spontaneously present in every way.
This is the supreme pledge
that all the buddhas do not transgress.
Whoever has devotion to this,
all the maṇḍalas of the buddhas

throughout all directions and times
will regard as a close heir,
as one who has approached all maṇḍalas without exception.
Thoroughly trained and firmly established
for as many eons as there are atoms in the realms,
the result of approaching all maṇḍalas without exception
is this great secret.
All the maṇḍalas of the Victors, without exception,
who have appeared in the past and present
in the ten directions of the six worlds,
having obtained it, spontaneously perfected the five bodies.
All who are to come in the future
will be spontaneously accomplished through this.
This is the result of the definitive great secret
become the path.
In all the maṇḍalas of the Victors without exception,
there is no definitive secret meaning other than this;
even if the Victors searched, they would not find one.
It is the supreme great mudrā of all.
It is to be held by those endowed with the eye of wisdom,
thoroughly trained in hearing, reflection, and meditation.
Give it to a worthy vessel, steadfast in good character,
who offers up body and wealth.
Otherwise, never give it.
If one gives it to the deluded out of display,
one's life will be exhausted untimely,
and one will dwell long in burning and starvation.

Thus he uttered this inspired utterance to the Tathāgata himself:

By the maṇḍala that possesses the maṇḍala,
meditate on the maṇḍala within the maṇḍala.
The maṇḍala arisen from the maṇḍala,
the maṇḍala of mind, is the supreme maṇḍala.

This was the twenty-fifth chapter, the extremely secret essence of the oral instructions, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then, from the state of great delight, the Blessed One, the glorious Samantabhadra, uttered this inspired utterance, called "The Emergence of the Secret":

How wonderful! All the supreme sugatas of the three times without exception
are the pure bodhicitta, unborn from the very beginning.
Their nature is indivisible, not separating beginning from end;
being primordially equal, they are an ocean of Victors.
Without going or coming, the three times are perfected all at once.
Because there is no dividing or removing, there is no good or bad, nothing to adopt or reject.
Within conceptual thought itself is the nature of wisdom;
not producing concepts, wisdom is inexpressible.
Supreme beings without self, trained in the past,
may perhaps arise, a few in ten thousand.
Those supreme beings, manifest buddhas,
indivisible from those of former generations and those to come:
how could a few faithful ones, whose wisdom and minds have been trained for a few eons, be able to match them?
Not seeing themselves, their mental continua untrained,
deluded sentient beings who search elsewhere
do not hear it though it is taught, and do not see it though it is pointed out.
We do not awaken by searching elsewhere.
Never parted from it, they do not see the Teacher;
wishing to travel there, they cannot arrive.
What the mental continuum is, by what it is recognized,
and the acting that simply rests, exalted beyond act and agent:
whoever investigates this with the intellect attains awakening.
Unabandoned, free of all signs, through existence and nonexistence,
one does not reject what brings recollection and does not cut the stream of the cycle.
Undegenerate and undivided, in the manifest buddha,
investigating with the awareness of the intellect, and through diligence,
through offering and reliance, awakening is clearly attained.
By grasping at space, it comes to be covered by clouds.
When one knows that there is no space,
it is impossible for a cloud to arise and cover it.

In the buddha, the indestructible swastika of conceptual thought,
all things primordially abide in equality and are pure.
Abiding vividly without conception, it conceives;
being beyond description, variety arises.
The great self without self is the treasury from which all arises;
moving from the unobstructed, yet not arising,
all is the state of mind, yet it cannot be designated "mind."
Unfabricated, spontaneously abiding, primordially awakened,
since there is nothing to attain, it is primordially the Sugata.

When this had been said, the Tathāgata himself knew all the elements of phenomena and of wisdom to be naturally awakened. Having known this, from the Net of Illusion of the vajra body, speech, and mind of all the tathāgatas, the great self of things just as they are, he brought forth these words of the vajra secret:

How wonderful! The great accomplishment not accomplished,
the great accomplishment, the great wisdom,
the great ground with nothing to adopt or reject,
the dhāraṇī, unmoving, without meeting or parting,
the wisdom of conception, the wish-fulfilling treasure:
it is like a mirror for all things,
yet though one looks, no reflection appears.
Wherever this great secret may be,
though across a pit of smoldering embers
packed with the edges of razors,
climb over, children, and go to it!
Within the innermost of what lies within,
seal it in an iron casket.
In order to practice the expanse itself within itself,
practice in the supreme place of the expanse itself.
That itself is nirvāṇa without abiding.
So it is, in the words of the vajra secret.

This was the twenty-sixth chapter, establishing the oral instructions of the great secret, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then the Tathāgata, in great delight, dwelling in the maṇḍala of equality, displayed everything without exception in his own body, and uttered this inspired utterance:

Past, present, future,
and the time whose arising is not certain:
that these times are equal, without before or after,
was genuinely taught as having no fixed nature.
The transcendent and the worldly,
taught as particular and general,
and all that is stable and moving and the rest,
are in the manner of illusion and mirage.
A person fully endowed with keen intellect
continually unites with this,
and those among all sentient beings who have become fields
he unites into the nondual expanse.
All is the characteristic of skillful means;
means are applied to means.
That which arises from means and means
is the supreme vajra of awakening.
However many oral transmissions are spoken,
the essence of the genuine meaning
is not found wherever one seeks it:
it is self-awareness, unobscured and pure.
Continual, diligent familiarization with it
is the sublime approach.
That this is the unerring path
is fully gathered by a into bhodhi.
The expanse of suchness itself
cannot be expressed as "one" or as "this."
As three, it arises and radiates in variety:
supreme blessing, inconceivable and infinite.
The meaning is summed up, like the twelve branches of scripture.
To speak of a meaning beyond this
is not the pure path;
it is the delusion of thinking with one's own intellect.
All is the self-aware bodhicitta;
this is explained as the authority of scripture.
It is the meaning set down according to its measure.
Meditating in the manner of the three purities,
gathered into five syllables, is the great means.
Self-awareness abides in all beings.

Where there is no doing, nothing has been done.
The wish-fulfilling treasure with no time of exhaustion,
the excellent vase, the wish-fulfilling store,
the casket, and the wish-fulfilling king of jewels
do not come from somewhere else.

This was the twenty-seventh chapter, on approach, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then the lord of the vajra body, speech, and mind of all the tathāgatas, by the essential nature of all the buddhas, manifested as the maṇḍala of the wrathful ones. Why was this? There were those who were fixated on what is imagined by an understanding deluded about a self, who were parted from the genuine path, who did not realize the concealed secret and clung to the hidden secret, and who were deluded about cause and result. Propelled by the rough seeds of existence, they were born in the uninterrupted hell of Extreme Heat. Tormented there by the intense suffering of extreme heat, and tormented by longing, the moment they thought, "Even somewhere far colder than this, how could it be worse?" they were racked by the intense sufferings of freezing and of cracking open like lotuses. They experienced such sufferings in the eight hells beginning with Extreme Heat and the eight beginning with Extreme Cold, passing from one world system to another, for twelve thousand great eons.

Then, when that ripening was exhausted, they were born for six great eons as hungry ghosts, racked by the sufferings of hunger and thirst. The things they desired became repugnant to them and turned into all kinds of harmful and harsh things; they became destitute, extremely emaciated and parched, and their bodies, limbs, and faculties became misshapen.

Then, when that ripening of rough karmic obscuration had gradually thinned, they took birth through the link of their former existence as great preta-rākṣasas, extremely vicious and fierce. Some had a hundred heads on one body, some various heads, some a hundred bodies with one head, some various bodies, many limbs, or various limbs. They carried all kinds of vicious weapons and had immense retinues. They had all kinds of terrifying forms and roared all kinds of terrifying roars. Their form, taste, smell, and breath made everyone bristle with horror. With terrifying cold winds and hot breath they threw the elements into turmoil in every direction. They struck beings with the four hundred and four diseases. Through a power that intoxicates and brings

ruin, they brought under their control the realms of the nāgas, the realms of the asuras, the realms of the gods, the realms of Brahmā, Ābhāsvara, Śubhakṛtsna, and everything up to Bṛhatphala.

Seeing them through the power of their former connection and through omniscience, he set about taming them with compassion, and all sang this song that shows the characteristics:

How wonderful! All beings are not apart from the sugatas;
it appears as illusory emanations that burn away suffering.
This nature of great and marvelous qualities
is the friend and protector of all who suffer.
Fully dispelling delusion and confusion, crushing aversion,
it is the origin, bliss, the supreme vajra body.
Through inconceivable activities that bring the age of perfection,
by the power of great compassion it crushes the māras.
With bodies of various colors and inconceivable skillful means,
in playful sport it acts for the benefit of beings,
and through bodhicitta it establishes them on the path.
The one bliss above all beings,
a hoḥ it establishes them in the very joy of delight.
Through every blessing, bliss itself appears.

When this had been said, the Tathāgata himself was known to be utterly victorious over all, and there was delight.

Then, from the Net of Illusion that is the great vajra array of the Tathāgata, in order to display the great pride and splendor that tames the lords of the three realms of existence in the ten directions of the six worlds, the Blessed One, Great Delight, lord of the vajra body, speech, and mind of all the tathāgatas, entered into the absorption of the king of the Net of Illusion, in which great clouds of the maṇḍala of the king of wrathful ones radiate. From the expanse of suchness he brought forth the great Krodheśvarī, and with the radiant splendor of delight, crying "hi hi," he made the lotus blossom. Dissolving in the delight of nondual embrace, from the clouds of bodhicitta he uttered:

hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ viśva vajra krodha jvalana maṇḍala phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ hala hala hala hūṃ

When he had uttered this, hosts of the wrathful maṇḍala, each the size of a trichiliocosm and as many as the atoms of the ten directions, came forth, pervading all the infinite ten directions of the six worlds. Then all the ten

directions of the six worlds moved, moved strongly, and moved strongly everywhere; they rumbled, rumbled strongly, and rumbled strongly everywhere; they quaked, quaked strongly, and quaked strongly everywhere; they shook, shook strongly, and shook everywhere; they scattered, scattered strongly, and scattered everywhere. All the beings of great power and great might who dwell in the thousandfold realms of the ten directions of the six worlds, the great Maheśvara (Śiva) and the rest, fainted and utterly fainted.

Then the Blessed One, Great Delight himself, became the great terrifier, exceedingly fierce, who makes the flesh crawl: the great blazing Heruka, the blood drinker, dark maroon in body, able to turn into anything, with heads, arms, and legs as many as the atoms of a thousandfold realm, holding all kinds of weapons. He then took the form of three heads, six arms, and four legs. Delighting in the great charnel ground, in the middle of an ocean of blood, upon a Mount Meru of great skeletons, in the center of a wheel within a vast expanse of great blaze, he sat with one leg extended and one bent, on a seat formed of Maheśvara and the great haughty lord of the charnel grounds, each together with his consort.

Of those cloud-masses of the wrathful maṇḍala, some became the glorious great Vajra Heruka and sat in the east. Some became the glorious great Ratna Heruka and sat in the south. Some became the glorious great Padma Heruka and sat in the west. Some became the glorious great Karma Heruka and sat in the north. All of them, in the garb of the great terrifier, with fierce roars, in the expanse of blaze, with three heads, six arms, and four legs, sat on seats made of gandharvas, yakṣas, Yama, and others, together with their consorts. The great blood-drinking queens also sat, each embracing the body of her own lord.

Gathering the Herukas of the five families by absorbing them into one, they displayed the wonder of one taming many. Then the great haughty one and the others, with savage minds, displayed all kinds of vicious miracles, and with roars as from a single throat they spoke in coarse, savage words: "Hey, hey, lord of compassion, why do you act like this?" Taunting him, they menaced him with utterly savage minds and raged.

Then the Blessed One, Great Delight, the self of all, abiding with nine heads, eighteen arms, and eight legs, with a fierce voice, became utterly wrathful through the means of taming with compassion, and uttered:

hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ ha ha ha khāhi khāhi

Then he tore out the hearts and sense organs of that host of great vicious ones, Maheśvara and the rest. He pulled out all their entrails. He cut and chopped all their limbs and drank all their blood. He fashioned all their bones into ornaments.

Then, when he uttered "hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ e ārali jaḥ jaḥ," he gathered the world systems of the ten directions, together with space, so that they fit into the size of a single mustard seed.

Then he gathered also the wives of the great haughty king, the king of all bhūtas without exception, and the rest; the wives of all the bhūtas; and the sovereigns of the sovereigns of all the female bhūtas: the great rākṣasī Manurākṣasī, Brahmāṇī, Raudrī, Indrāṇī, Vaiṣṇavī, Kaumārī, the Red One, Amṛtā, Śāntī, Daṇḍī, Rākṣasī, Bhakṣasī, Ratī, Rudhiramadī, the intoxicated blood drinker, Ekacāriṇī, Manohārikā, Siddhikarī, Vāyudevī, the Slayer, Agnāyī, Vārāhī, Cāmuṇḍī, the Noseless One, Varuṇānī, Mahākālī, the great red-yellow Goat-Headed One, the great blue-black Kumbhakarṇī, the great yellow-black Belly-Holder, and the rest, together with their servants and the servants of their servants, their attendants and the attendants of their attendants, retinues as numerous as the atoms of the realms.

Then the Blessed One, Great Delight, the glorious great Heruka, through his means of taming, again made the terrifiers of the five families appear. All of them entered into the absorption called "The Arising of Clouds of the Maṇḍala of Joyous Play," and brought forth these words from the vajra body, speech, and mind:

oṃ hūṃ aṃ vajra praveśa alala hoḥ

When this was uttered, the minds of the bhūta queens were stirred with intense passion, and their lotus maṇḍalas contracted and expanded. Then, just as iron gathers to a magnet, the great rākṣasī Manurākṣasī, the Red One, Ratī, the Slayer, the great Mahākālī, the great Red-Yellow One, the great Blue-Black One, and the great Yellow-Black One embraced the body of the Blessed One, Great Delight, the glorious Vajra Heruka. Brahmāṇī, Raudrī, Indrāṇī, Vaiṣṇavī, and Kaumārī embraced the body of the Blessed One, the glorious great Heruka. Amṛtā, Śāntī, Daṇḍī, Bhakṣasī, and Rākṣasī embraced the body of the Blessed One, the glorious Ratna Heruka. Rudhiramadī, Ekacāriṇī, Manohārikā, Siddhikarī, and Vāyudevī embraced the body of the Blessed One, the glorious great Padma Heruka. Agnāyī, Vārāhī, Cāmuṇḍī, the Noseless One, and Varuṇānī embraced the body of the Blessed One, the glorious great Karma

Heruka.

Then, when those wrathful maṇḍalas of the Blessed One, Great Delight, uttered "hūṃ hūṃ," the hosts of the lotus maṇḍala were drawn in and became utterly contracted. Then, delighted, they uttered "he," and from the clouds of bodhicitta the hosts of Gaurīs, the hosts of Caurīs, the hosts of Pramohās, the hosts of Vetālīs, the hosts of Pukkasīs, the hosts of Caṇḍālīs, the hosts of Ghasmarīs, and the hosts of mātṛkās came forth, wondrously equipped with their own implements. Having come forth, they took their places, starting from the east, around the great blazing wheel, in terrifying forms and holding their own implements.

Then, in great delight, they uttered "he," and the hosts of great lion-faced goddesses, the hosts of great tiger-faced goddesses, the hosts of great fox-faced goddesses, the hosts of great dog-faced goddesses, the hosts of great vulture-faced goddesses, the hosts of great kaṅka-faced goddesses, the hosts of great crow-faced goddesses, and the hosts of great owl-faced goddesses came forth, wondrously equipped with their own implements. Having come forth, they took their places with fierce radiance, starting from the east, around the outside of the great blazing wheel.

Then, in great delight, pervading all the realms of the ten directions without exception, they uttered "phaṭ," and the hosts of vajra long-striding goddesses, the hosts of vajra-faced goddesses, the hosts of vajra world goddesses, and the hosts of vajra vetālīs came forth, wondrously equipped with their own implements. Having come forth, they stood at the gates of the blazing maṇḍala in exceedingly fierce forms.

Then, when "phaṭ" was proclaimed from the clouds of great delight in the ten directions, all became wrathful, and all the mātṛkās too, each in an instant, took up her own place.

Then all those glorious great Herukas of the Blessed One, Great Delight, entered into the absorption called "The Arising of the Nectar of Great Compassion," and brought forth these words from the vajra body, speech, and mind:

oṃ vajra mahā amṛta mahā krodhe aṃ aṃ aṃ

When this was uttered, Maheśvara and all the others came out through the noses of those great wrathful Blessed Ones. They had been thrust into an ocean of filthy muck, and from the sky Ucchuṣma Krodha was sent forth, who

drank up all the muck. Regaining their memory, they saw all those hosts of the wrathful maṇḍala, with nine hundred heads, one thousand eight hundred arms, and eight hundred legs, sitting in the midst of great blazing bodies.

At that time all the lords of arrogance throughout all existence in the ten directions of the six worlds were tamed at once by the inconceivable variety of means of taming, each appearing in its own way. Then, trembling violently and in terror, with utterly cowed voices, they said: "We become your servants! We become your servants! If we do not earnestly serve you,
may our heads and bodies split into a hundred pieces,
may our hearts too split and be hacked apart,
may we rot and decay and burn and perish,
and fall into hell and cry out!"
Thus they swore an oath to become servants, and were placed as seats of the maṇḍala.

All of them spoke again with one voice:
"Our wives,
and our mothers, sisters, and daughters,
please accept into the great maṇḍala;
heroic lord, please accept them.
We, with each of our retinues,
will take up even the bare name
of this great maṇḍala of the gathering
like a blazing jewel at the crown,
receiving it with minds free of deceit and full of devotion,
placing it on the crowns of our heads, and honoring it.
Whatever the purpose of that may be,
we will accomplish it completely, without exception.
If here, in the presence of the hero,
we do not accomplish it as we have said,
may our heads, bodies, and hearts
split, be hacked, and be torn into pieces."
So they spoke.

Then all the hosts of their wives and the hosts of their sisters and daughters came in an instant, and all spoke with one voice:
"We, with all our retinues,
become the servants of the great hero.
Great hero, please bestow on us

the accomplishments of activity."
So they spoke.

Then the Blessed One, Great Delight, placed a vajra in their hands, conferred on them the empowerment of a name, and set them outside the maṇḍala.

This was the twenty-eighth chapter, the emanation of clouds of the maṇḍala of variegated nature, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then, so that these great assemblies of the maṇḍala would be accomplished through the samaya commitments, the Blessed One, Great Delight, drew forth these maṇḍalas of speech from the awesome vajra body, speech and mind of those hosts of tathāgata wrathful ones, the great Herukas, together with their consorts:
oṃ tathāgata mahāśrī heruka mahācaṇḍa sarva duṣṭāṃ taka hana daha paca hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ vajra mahāśrī heruka mahācaṇḍa sarva duṣṭāṃ taka hana daha paca hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ ratna mahāśrī heruka mahācaṇḍa carva duṣṭāṃ taka hana daha paca hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ padma mahāśrī heruka mahācaṇḍa sarva duṣṭāṃ taka hana daha paca hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ karma mahāśrī heruka mahācaṇḍa sarva duṣṭāṃ taka hana daha paca hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ tathāgata mahākrodheśvari jvalanī sarva duṣṭāṃ hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ mahāvajradhāra mahākrodheśvari jvalanī hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ mahāsūryaratna mahākrodheśvari vidhama hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ hriḥ mehā sārasvata mahāpadma krodheśvari khāhi hūṃ phaṭ
oṃ sarva amogha mahākrodheśvari viśva hūṃ phaṭ
vajra gaurī haḥ vajra caurī haḥ vajra pramohe haḥ vajra vetālī haḥ vajra caṇḍalī haḥ vajra pukkasī haḥ vajra ghasmarī haḥ vajra smaśānī haḥ
vajra siṃhamukhī he vajra vyāghramukhī he vajra sṛglamukhī he vajra śvanāmukhī he vajra ghṛḍhamukhī he vajra kādhamukhī he vajra khagamukhī he vajra ulūkamukhī he
vajra āryatejatedā jaṃḥ vajra amaka hūṃ vajra lokā vaṃ vajra bhaśmi palaya vato hoḥ
bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo bhyo
rulu rulu hūṃ ehyehi ānaya jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥ rāṃ

oṃ vajra krodha samaya hūṃ oṃ vajra krodha samaya phaṭ

oṃ You who pacify the wrathful through wrath,
assembly of awesome glorious ones, wrathful out of compassion,
grant me, right here in that very state,
your marvelous blazing blessings.

oṃ vajra krodha samaya stvaṃ oṃ vajra krodha samaya ho ali ule tali tapati daṃṣṭaṃ gonāro trikharaṃ yoginī khāhi hoḥ hūṃ ha he phaṭ

When this was spoken, all the ten directions of the six worlds were scorched, utterly scorched, utterly scorched, scorched everywhere. They blazed, blazed intensely, blazed everywhere. They became filled, completely filled, filled through and through with hosts of maṇḍalas blazing in every way.

This was the twenty-ninth chapter, the emanation of the speech maṇḍala of the great host of wrathful ones, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then the Tathāgata entered into the meditative absorption called "the arising of the mudrās of the blessing of the great wrathful one," and spoke this inspired utterance:

"Those who know the objects of the senses,
being endowed with skillful means and wisdom,
if they clearly realize the very state of sameness,
everything is the seal of great bliss.

In the celestial palace of the wheel of great movement,
if one meditates on all the wrathful ones, male and female,
as clear and radiating rays of light,
every motion and movement is a mudrā."

So spoke the Great Peerless One.

"The limbs and the heart as five-pronged, nine-pronged and eleven-pronged,
meditate thoroughly on the activities, each one individually.
The feet endowed with skillful means and wisdom
will always become blazing vajras.
If one sustains each great means,
for each there arises a lotus free of attachment.
When that vajra and lotus are joined,
all sentient beings
will be born in the field of unsurpassed awakening.

Meditating even the deities of the maṇḍala of intrinsic nature
as the maṇḍala of the wrathful ones,
if one moves and stirs the circle of the head,
all the maṇḍalas of the buddhas quake.
If one sets the formations of the hands in motion,
all the realms of the vidyādharas quake.
If one stamps and leaps in the great stance of the feet,
all unbearable sufferings
and all the Māras and vināyakas are crushed.
If one shakes and quivers all the limbs,
from each and every pore of the body hair
countless wrathful ones, as numerous as atoms, stream forth.
Through their countless emanations,
in the many realms of the ten directions, as numerous as atoms,
the deeds of the wrathful ones, as many as particles of dust,
tame through compassion and dissolve all into the expanse.
Everything gathers completely
into the maṇḍala of the wrathful ones and the maṇḍala of the wrathful goddesses.
Everything blazes intensely as vajra rock plateaus
and as maṇḍalas of fire mountains.
This is the great general seal.

To tame the obstructors above:
the vajra wheel, with a human head held aloft.
To tame the obstructors of the world below:
the vajra plough, with a human head raised,
the great vajra pestle, and the bell.
Taming the obstructors of the east:
the intensely blazing vajra
and the great staff of stira.
Taming the obstructors of the south:
the jewel staff topped with a human head,
and seizing the great Yama by the leg.
Taming the obstructors of the west:
the staff of serpents and stira,
and the great garuḍa beats with its wings,
cutting the great oceans through at the waist.

Taming the obstructors of the north:
the jewel cudgel
and the cudgel bearing three human heads,
annihilating the yakṣas and grahas.
Taming the obstructors of the four intermediate directions:
they will be tamed by those of the four directions.
If they are not tamed by that,
taming the obstructors of the northeast:
the vajra trident, with a human head held aloft,
and Īśa himself held in the hand,
all those bhūtas are utterly subdued.
Taming the obstructors of the southeast:
the vajra blazing with flames of wisdom,
which burns even fire itself,
and the sage himself held in a mudrā,
Agni, the fire god, with his retinue of grahas, is brought under control.
Taming the obstructors of the southwest:
the vajra and the head of a rākṣasa,
the blazing, razor-sharp sword,
and Nairṛti himself held in the hand,
the hosts of rākṣasas are brought under control.
Taming the obstructors of the northwest:
the banner of the wind, with a human head held aloft,
the splendor of a most fierce elephant,
and the Guardian of Words himself held in the hand,
all distractions are brought under control.
To tame the obstructors of the world below,
there is the mudrā of great Mount Meru,
and the great boar held in the hand:
this tames the obstructors below."

"Furthermore, by the maṇḍalas of sun and moon
the sufferings of heat and cold are dispelled.
By the great maṇḍala of fire
all without exception is burned.
By the great maṇḍala of water
all without exception is washed away.

By the great maṇḍala of wind
all without exception is scattered.

Furthermore, the sword together with the wheel,
the bow and arrow, the great hammer, the great knife,
the vajra, the great spear, and the battle-axe,
bared fangs, the razor, and teeth,
the arrow, the spear, and the stira,
and various other mudrās besides.

The mudrā of Heruka in the center:
the great stira cudgel
and the great, intensely blazing wheel;
from a great conch filled with red blood,
stirred with a vajra, he drinks deeply.
The mudrā of the wrathful one of the east:
the great stira staff
and the great, intensely blazing vajra;
he drinks from a human skull filled with much red blood.
The great mudrā of the south:
the great stira staff,
and in a celestial mansion of wish-fulfilling jewel
he drinks deeply the red argha offering.
The mudrā of the wrathful one of the west:
the great stira staff
and the intensely blazing lotus free of attachment;
he drinks from a great conch filled with red blood.
The mudrā of the wrathful one of the north:
the great stira staff
and the intensely blazing crossed vajra;
he drinks from a great conch filled with red blood.
The wrathful goddesses too accord with the wrathful ones.
The mudrās of the sacred places and lands
are explained in accord with the other tantras.
The mudrās of the mātṛkās
are explained in the great transcendent sūtra."

This was the thirtieth chapter, the emanation of mudrās, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the Net of Illusion.

Then, to reveal their maṇḍala, the Blessed One, Great Delight, spoke this inspired utterance:

"The blazing maṇḍala with four spokes
is adorned with four beveled corners.
Square, with four gateways,
it is beautified by two blazing intermediate courtyards.
Resplendent with suns and various emanated skulls,
many blazing radiances swirl.
Bull, buffalo, leopard and tiger,
and the fierce bear, gripping with their paws,
hold down Īśvara, the Great God (Śiva), and the others.
Maroon-black, blue-black, yellow-black,
red-black and green-black, their bodies terrifying,
with three heads and six arms, four legs spread wide,
wearing fresh hides and various garments,
roaring great awesome sounds terrifyingly,
with snakes and garlands of skulls, with sun and moon,
with the world above and its encircling rim,
the vajra and the great conch filled,
the sword, the axe, the plough and so forth,
holding their own various implements,
they are embraced by the hosts of consorts who hold them.
With the mudrās of the sacred places and lands,
the four gates beautiful with their mudrās,
the chiefs of the hosts of handmaidens and serving women,
beautified by twelve and by eight,
with their own seats and implements,
remain ready, saying, 'What shall we do?'"

When this was spoken, the blazing maṇḍala became clearly visible everywhere, throughout all the ten directions of the six worlds.

Then the Blessed One, Great Delight, drew forth these vajra secret words from the vajra Net of Illusion of his own body, speech and mind:

a ho
Arising together with the eon, blazing with the hosts of poisons,
the maṇḍala wheel of all-stirring afflictions, hard to express,
inconceivable as atoms, adorned with as many worlds as there are,

having sent forth all allies, the hosts of corpses greedy for blood,
the venomous women of attachment, exceedingly hard to make clear:
from the invisible expanse, through inconceivable miracles of form,
arising together with the degenerate age, they overpower all rebirth-linkings with awesome splendor.
The terrifying ones who utterly overpower are beyond conception.
Likewise, that very thing, as the antidote, arises everywhere and is clear everywhere.
ho
However many phenomena ripen the six classes of beings is beyond telling.
Those who dwell in delusion at the end of time are beyond telling.
And however many and as long as there are actions clinging with desire,
the great fierce and raging wind is beyond conception.
That they come with bliss and are nothing other is beyond telling.
The great poisons gathered over eons, conceptualizing and wholly conceptualizing:
to overpower them, the Heruka's body and speech become terrifying.
Taking them as conditions, as fruit ripens and fully ripens from the husk,
the Blessed One, Great Delight, with his many hosts,
immeasurable, inconceivable, spontaneously present,
is exceedingly clear in taming them thoroughly.
ho
The nature of the wrathful one is not cruel and frightening,
nor do the peaceful and beautiful merely abide in a way that pleases everyone's mind.
That very thing, nondual, pervades everything with inconceivable miracles.
Displaying the terrifying play of the Herukas of the five families, numerous as atoms,
it is the expanse of pure, supreme awakening, taught in the Secret Essence; it is the very ascertainment, clearly and perfectly abiding.
ho
So it is, in vajra secret words.

This was the thirty-first chapter, the revelation of the maṇḍala of the wrathful ones, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then the Blessed One, Great Delight, spoke this inspired utterance called "Revealing His Own Blessings and Qualities":

oṃ The great yoga of the buddhas
is the very supreme essence of the wisdom
of all the buddhas of the three times:
it is the Buddha Samantabhadra himself.
It is this, and is found nowhere else.
Having gained mastery over all play,
all existence and all the worlds
are buddhahood itself throughout the three times,
the essence, unmoving and spontaneously present.
From the qualities of the greatness of intrinsic nature,
for beings deluded through not realizing it,
he is fully perfected through the Net of Illusion,
and through the samaya of compassionate attachment
he displays the great body of pride itself.
In the three realms, cruel and fierce,
he thoroughly engages the fields to be tamed
and perfects the four kinds of enlightened activity.
Through the wondrous fierce majesty of wisdom,
the great view of the four pure dharmas,
the wisdom body is especially great.
Its sign being the hosts of passion,
it is the body of great attachment itself.
Because it is marked by fierceness, awe and cruelty,
it is the body of great aversion itself.
Because it thoroughly purifies the fields of those to be tamed
and rises from the sameness of the nature of reality,
it is the body of great delusion itself.
Because it is the domain of the pure world and its inhabitants,
radiating from mind, body and speech,
and is marked by me, the Victor,
it is the body of great pride itself.
The forty-two of the secret essence
are the bindu, the seminal sphere, gathered into the mind itself;
because it is marked by not giving to others,
that itself is the perfect body of jealousy.

The great thousand of the thousand of the three thousand,
the many and various world realms,

marked as passing beyond reckoning
in atoms, koṭis and the like:
that itself, appearing and existing,
is the expanse of the body, speech and mind of the terrifying one.
In the nature of dharmakāya wisdom,
the supreme bindu of the Net of Illusion,
the essence, the bindu, inconceivable itself,
the terrifying one with nine heads and eighteen arms,
is the net marked by illusion.
That itself is assembly, maṇḍala and mantra,
supreme mantra, three in one;
it is the sense objects and the elements themselves.
Self-awareness and the benefit of others are the essence itself,
with the hand emblems of skillful means and wisdom,
the great wisdom of nondual awareness.
Name and form, becoming heads,
are imagined as arms and legs.
The body that radiates from imagining
appears as anything at all out of nothing whatsoever.
The supremely fortunate illusion,
the maṇḍala of the net, is fully perfected.

The eyes of the nature of reality that overpower imagining:
the eyes are the sameness of the nature of reality,
engaging the domain of the expanse just as it is.
With eyes of anger in the sport of play,
they look at nothing other; they look at the object.
The coiled lotus itself is body and speech;
it destroys things grasped as signs.
From the wide-open eyes of great wisdom,
the wrathful frown turning into a thousand lightnings,
the lightning of masses of fire that pierces others:
because it is applied to the field of amṛta,
he is the wrathful one of supreme amṛta.
From the perfection of the sameness of the body itself,
fully displaying the arising of variety,
is the great power of wisdom's illusion.

From the gathering and radiating of the supreme unmoving one,
the wings filled with vajras
work their magic upon the hosts of wisdom,
and through the blessing of the net of compassion,
the surrounding worlds, however many, without limit,
move into the bliss of the expanse itself.
Radiating out for the purpose of bringing under control,
through the miraculous power of the horse's dance
not even one is lost.

In the boundless maṇḍala of illusion
of the sameness and non-sameness of the dharmadhātu,
the mudrā of supreme play
is the posture of the feet extended and drawn in,
the meaning of the play of skillful means and wisdom.
Through the self-powered king of great means,
the body and speech of all the buddhas
are perfected in the place of the supreme bindu.

Overpowering Īśvara, the Great God, and the rest,
those with wrathful hand emblems,
holding many kinds of sharp weapons,
cut off the arrogant, cruel aversion.
Delusion, the dharmakāya, the illusion,
the entire compassion of the net,
through the compassion of the wrathful samaya
establishes them in the bindu of sameness:
this is Yamāntaka, the king over the cruel,
truly the supreme liberator of the hosts of the cruel.
Because he has become the protector of beings,
the snakes with which the cruel adorn the dharmakāya,
in which poison and amṛta are no different,
are set as ornaments of wisdom, signs of empowerment.
With charnel-ground substances and drinking blood,
he wears the great tiger skin as the ground of good fortune.
The samaya of terrifying compassion
that cuts the root of birth and death
is supremely proclaimed as Acala the Protector.

Forming gestures with the hand of pride,
the samaya of stealing away pride,
in the domain of Samantabhadra,
the very essence of mantra:
with hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ he gathers, eats and drinks.
Through the blessing of the vajra mind
he is fully proclaimed as Hūṃkara.
The great delusion that does not spread,
in order to drink up the ocean of afflictions,
appears to drink from the great expanse of the bhandha skull cup.
The great blazing cloud of the world,
overpowering the karma of the eon,
brings forth the blaze of vajra fire
and dries up the ocean of afflictions.
Through the samaya of terrifying means,
inconceivable worlds with their encircling rims
are gathered into the immeasurable mansion of his own body.
The wisdom of the Net of Illusion
is the overpowering charnel-ground continent.
Great deities of the two clusters,
through the blessing of the vajra body,
from the unmoving bliss of the bindu,
through the great play of intrinsic nature,
hosts of vajra sorceress-messengers,
perfectly tame the three realms!

ha is the bindu, peace itself.
ha is the bindu, peace and wrath in equipoise.
ha is the bindu, the great power.
ha is the bindu, wrath itself.
ha is the bindu, play itself.
ha through the bindu is activity itself.
ha through the bindu tames the power of passion.
ha is the bindu, all actions perfected.
he is the bindu, the mind of wisdom.
he through the bindu is melodious speech.
he through the bindu is the tongue of fierce majesty.
he is the bindu, play itself.

he is the bindu, the sign of empowerment.
he through the bindu is ferocious.
he through the bindu perfects the great mind.
he through the bindu is the maṇḍala,
the supreme illusion of the terrifying one;
overpowering with the net, it blocks the path.
hūṃ is the mind of the mind of wisdom.
hūṃ is the mind and body of wisdom.
hūṃ is the mind, body and speech of wisdom.
hūṃ is the wish-fulfilling activity of wisdom.
hūṃ is the bindu, wisdom.

phaṭ is the mind of the mind of the body.
phaṭ is the mind of the speech of speech.
phaṭ is the mind of the mind of mind.
phaṭ is the mind of the mind of the dharmakāya.
phaṭ is the mind of the speech of the dharmakāya.
phaṭ is the mind of the mind of the Dharma mind.
Delighting through the Net of Illusion, ho!
Īśvara delighting through passion, ho!
Delighting in the play of the dance, ho!
Delighting, endowed with body, speech and mind, ho!
Delighting through qualities and activities, ho!
Delighting as messengers gather and radiate, ho!
Delighting by appearing to all, ho!
Delighting through blessing, ho!
Delighting in the dharmakāya, ho!
Delighting in the play of wisdom, ho!
Delighting by being nothing whatsoever, ho!
Delighting by gathering in the harmful, ho!
The dharmadhātu itself delighting, ho!

Through this, Great Delight himself became supremely delighted in himself, and all phenomena became of a single nature.

This was the thirty-second chapter, revealing the blessings and supreme qualities of Great Delight, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, in one hundred thousand.

Then the Blessed One, Great Delight, entered into the meditative absorption called "giving the merit of the terrifying one," and spoke this inspired utterance:

"In the wheel, the intermediate courtyards and the gates,
meditate on the terrifying one, lord of the wheel family,
together with the hosts of consorts.
Pacifying and wrathful, magnetizing and enriching:
at the center of that great terrifying host,
in the manner of fashioning oneself as the wrathful one,
meditate on the maṇḍala of body, speech and mind.

In the wheel, the intermediate courtyards and the gates,
meditate on the terrifying one, lord of the jewel family,
together with the hosts of consorts who embrace him,
endowed with the hosts of wrathful goddesses.
Pacifying and wrathful, magnetizing and enriching:
at the center of that great terrifying host,
having blessed body, speech and mind,
in the manner of fashioning oneself as the wrathful one,
meditate on the maṇḍala of body, speech and mind.

In the wheel, the intermediate courtyards and the gates,
meditate on the terrifying one, lord of the jewel family,
together with the hosts of consorts who embrace him,
endowed with the hosts of wrathful goddesses.
Pacifying and wrathful, magnetizing and enriching:
at the center of that great terrifying host,
having blessed body, speech and mind,
in the manner of fashioning oneself as the wrathful one,
meditate on the maṇḍala of body, speech and mind.
Or else, it is the maṇḍala of the lord of the family.

In the wheel, the intermediate courtyards and the gates,
meditate on the terrifying lord of the activity family,
together with the hosts of consorts who embrace him,
endowed with the hosts of wrathful goddesses.
Pacifying and wrathful, magnetizing and enriching:
set out the maṇḍala of the four activities in full.
At the center of that great terrifying host,

having blessed body, speech and mind,
having consecrated oneself as the wrathful one,
meditate on the maṇḍala of body, speech and mind.

The maṇḍala complete with the five terrifying ones:
meditate on the twenty-five, body, speech, mind,
qualities and activities, as complete.
Ornaments, attire and the rest:
just as the terrifying host appears,
meditate on the attire of great fierce majesty.
Songs, dances and mudrās,
knowing them as wisdom and skillful means,
the offerings of the mind of awakening,
the qualities of the symbolic signs and the rest,
food, things to chew, drink and clothing,
everything endowed with the five enjoyments:
in short, actually accomplish the feasts."

This was the thirty-third chapter, the samaya of giving the merit of the Great Terrifying One, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then, so that the rite and the maṇḍala might be fully understood, the Blessed One, Great Delight, spoke this inspired utterance:

"The body, speech and mind of the tathāgatas
are the maṇḍala of the completely pure dharmadhātu.
From the general maṇḍala of secret mantra,
meditate on the maṇḍala of the mother for knowing and entering.
Measuring an earshot, a yojana and so forth,
or one body-length, two or three,
as far as one's own awareness is able,
meditate on the maṇḍala of the Net of Illusion.
Expel the harmful ones, subdue the ground and bless it.
With a sapling, a slender twig, a single stem,
and with the colors of ignorance, just as they are,
bring down the meditative absorption that is to be cultivated.
At the place for reciting the maṇḍala of the terrifying one's body and speech,
the sites, the consorts and the substances
are set out, focusing on them as the supreme of the feast.

First, worship with sublime offerings.
The form, the great cast image, the supreme conch:
I set them out in whatever appearance I wish.
Having entered the power of the terrifying one,
I make as many wrathful goddesses as there are into my retinue.
Turn back obstacles with the supreme meditative absorption.
Having arranged it as the secret essence itself,
joining the one who has passed beyond equally with oneself,
inviting him with the mantra of the mind,
in the manner of entering one's own body,
absorb his form, holding it supremely.
By saying jaḥ three times,
that one gains a body of merit
and bestows the accomplishments of the five wisdoms.
The many messengers who gather and radiate
will do whatever is needed for him.

Or else, on perfectly level ground,
the mudrās, forms and essence syllables
should be drawn in five colors.
The white elixir, the red elixir, the great scent and the great flesh;
fill the vajra and the great conch with the red elixir.
Conches and life-poles, new and old,
the supreme and the lesser transformed fields,
all the substances there may be:
employ them with the meditative absorption of the Great Terrifying One
and with a mind that does not lapse.
In the maṇḍala of the Net of Illusion,
with a resolute attitude,
accomplish it thoroughly, without expectation.
Through approach and close approach,
accomplishment and great accomplishment,
when the days are complete and the signs have arisen,
apply it in conformity with the maṇḍala.
For six periods of thirty days,
or for sixty, or for ninety-six,
meditate on the maṇḍala of the Great Terrifying One.

Offer your own body to the terrifying host.
Regard that itself as the maṇḍala.
They do not transgress; from the samaya
they never transgress."

This was the thirty-fourth chapter, the samaya of the maṇḍala of Great Delight, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then the Blessed One, Great Delight, uttered this essence of mantra:

akiduna jvala maṇḍala phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ
oṃ sarva tathāgata mahāśrī heruka mahākrodheśvari hūṃ phaṭ
rulu mahāsamaya hūṃ rulu rulu hūṃ bhyo hūṃ
oṃ mahāvajra śrīheruka vajrakrodheśvari sarva duṣṭān hūṃ phaṭ
rulu mahāsamaya hūṃ rulu rulu hūṃ bhyo hūṃ
oṃ ratna mahāśrī heruka ratna mahākrodheśvari viṅhamukha hūṃ phaṭ
rulu rulu mahāsamaya hūṃ bhyo hūṃ
oṃ hrīḥ padma mahāśrī heruka padma mahākrodheśvari khāhi hūṃ phaṭ
rulu mahāsamaya hūṃ rulu rulu rulu hūṃ bhyo hūṃ
oṃ karma mahāśrī heruka sarva aga mahākrodheśvari viśvarūve hūṃ phaṭ
rulu mahāsamaya hūṃ rulu rulu rulu hūṃ bhyo hūṃ
oṃ mahā sarva tathāgata vajra ratna padma amogha mahāvajra śrī heruka mahāsamaya ha he hūṃ phaṭ
rulu rulu rulu rulu hūṃ bhyo hūṃ
oṃ sarva tathāgata mahāpadma śrī heruka mantra jvala mahāmaṇḍal kāya vāka citta
oṃ oṃ oṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ svāṃ svāṃ svāṃ āṃ āṃ āṃ hāṃ hāṃ hāṃ
vajra mahākapāla khaṅga daṇḍena jvala siddha mahāśrī heruka amedume siddhodbhāve saṃharaṇa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ mahāyoga addha mahāsamaya rulu rulu alala hoḥ

ho Abiding perfectly in the bindu of mind itself,
the forty-two maṇḍalas are themselves complete.
Buddha Vajra Heruka,
inconceivable clustered maṇḍala,
join me to body, speech and mind!

oṃ vajra krodha samaya hoḥ oṃ vajra krodha samaya stvaṃ oṃ aṃ hūṃ sur stvaṃ kamala mahāsukha mālai manu saman jvala nidhana ava yoga khāhi ala ala hoḥ

This was the thirty-fifth chapter, called "the arising of the essence, the mantra recitation of the Great Terrifying One," from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then the Blessed One, through the great samaya of Great Delight, entered into the meditative absorption of giving away the aggregates, elements and sense sources, and drew forth from his vajra body, speech and mind this mantra called "blessing the hosts of the cruel":

oṃ sarva tathāgata padma samyoginī jaḥ

When this was spoken, in all the ten directions of the six worlds, the essence of the body, speech and mind of the tathāgatas everywhere became a lotus, and from the one with nine heads and eighteen arms, heads, arms and legs as numerous as the atoms of a thousand world realms came to stand, reaching up to the peak of existence.

Then again he entered into the meditative absorption called "the perfection of the great maṇḍala," and rolled up great Mount Meru by stretching and bending his legs. By his saying oṃ abhicara vaśīn, the hosts of gods, the hosts of nāgas, the great yakṣas, the rākṣasas, humans, and nonhumans, however many there were, all came, without any power of their own, to lie beneath his pressing feet.

Then again, by his saying haha avira catiṣṭha, some, with their whole bodies, came to lie beneath great Mount Meru, and some, in plain sight, came to lie pinned beneath great Mount Meru.

Then he knew that a king called King of the Vast Earth, cruel and of great aversion, without faith, a reviler of the Vajra Vehicle, was dwelling in the world at large. Knowing this, he arose from that meditative absorption, and by his saying oṃ padma samayogini rulu rulu rulu hūṃ, everything became the very nature of body-passion, the attire of speech-passion, mind-passion, great jewel-passion and great activity-passion. And in the east, the south, the west, the north and the great center, in the vast surge of blood upon the great Mount Meru of great skeletons, that very thing appeared at all times.

Moreover, all around, inconceivable terrifying forms of the five bodies, inconceivable roars of the five speeches, inconceivable terrifying ones, the play of the five minds, terrifying with inconceivable faces, came to stand upon the great clusters of the five families.

From that, the great supreme essence became the head of mahāratnatilaka, and from that, in the immeasurable palace thoroughly adorned with body, speech and mind, the very bindu-essence of the Great Terrifying One abides with three heads and six arms, dwelling nondually.

Then, right there, inconceivable Great Terrifying Ones were seen covering everything, with bodies, heads, arms, legs and retinues as numerous as the atoms of a thousand realms.

Then the great Māra, the king of the Earth-Holders, said, "Great being, lord of the Earth-Holders, hey, hey! Why do you act like this?"

Then again, by the very nature of Great Delight, oṃ abhicar vaśīna hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ was spoken. At that, the inconceivable hosts and retinues who revile the sacred teaching, the sacred teaching of the Vajra Vehicle, and who harm the yogins among beings, and those great Māras together with their servants and sub-servants, tormented in their own minds, fainted utterly; unseeing, from a state of delusion, without any power of their own and without mindfulness, they went to the place beneath the feet of the great Mount Meru of skeletons.

Then the Great Terrifying One said tiṣṭha vajra aṃ aṃ, and they were parted from their cruel intent; their unfitting bodies were exchanged, and they came to abide as great universal monarchs who tame the hosts of the great gods.

Then Great Delight, the glorious Great Terrifying One, entered into equipoise in the samādhi called the Great Magical Display of their maṇḍala, and from the body, speech, mind, qualities and activities of all the tathāgatas he drew forth, out of the Net of Illusion, the samaya of the great vajra drop of this very mind maṇḍala called the Great Drop.

oṃ Amid the swirling billows of a sea of blood,
a hundred thousand Mount Merus of heaped skeletons,
mountains of five gathered clusters;
a blazing mansion, a wheel of four spokes,
most majestic, adorned with four projecting corners,
square, with four gateways,
beautified by two blazing intermediate courtyards,
majestic with skulls, snakes, varied ornaments, suns and moons.
The many seats rest upon great gods.
Great Delight, Samantabhadra,
with eight hands and feet,
majestic with skulls, snakes, varied ornaments, sun and moon:

the Great Terrifying One, the Heruka,
vajra essence, mind of the drop,
with three heads, six arms, and four legs spread wide.
On the four sides, worshipped by four wrathful goddesses,
he holds the manner of great delight.
In the four directions together with the corners,
the emanated yoginīs, the animal-headed goddesses,
dwell upon Mount Meru and upon great corpses.
Blazing, the great ones hold in their hands
a vajra and a great conch filled full,
a lotus palace, and beat small drums;
they bind with nooses of corpses,
hurl khaṭvāṅgas and embrace,
together with hosts that hold consorts.
The mudrās of the sacred places and lands,
and at the four gates the most beautiful mudrās,
the many great hosts of female servants,
abide in terrifying forms.

This is the thirty sixth chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, called Blessing the Hosts of the Wicked as the Samaya of All the Tathāgatas.

Then all the tathāgatas became of one intention, and the Tathāgata himself uttered this inspired utterance to the Tathāgata himself:

From the maṇḍala of the path of illusion
of the supreme vajra of activity,
to enter the manifestly perfect maṇḍala of the Net
is the intention of the entering mind.
Trained in what is extremely subtle,
it is beautified by forty two maṇḍalas.
By the distinction of the two clusters,
emanating and gathering are likewise.
On delightful ground,
lay the lines with the soles of the feet and draw the maṇḍala.
Meditate on the maṇḍala of oṃ and mūṃ.
From that, fill it with subtle vajras.
Subtly gathering the earth, hold it beneath.
Imagined with the knowledge that it is the host of mothers,

any land whatever comes under control.
Imagining it as a hostile form,
the gathering and radiating of the Net, like that body,
imagine it as haṃ, like a cast image.
From that, like light, hold it beneath.
In secret, make the path of speech haṃ.
The wise one places it upon wind and moon.
By the fierce application of the tongue,
send it far away to other continents and realms.
Oneself, together with the host of hūṃ,
meditate on the unborn letter.
The host of that activity, the dharma element,
blessed as mūṃ, dissolve into the letter.
Through the radiating and gathering of the steadfast a,
meditate thoroughly as on space.
Having become stable, recite the essence of a.
When one has not yet gained experience,
join the practice with the entering mind,
knowing it as the first state,
and equal in its many aspects.
From that, the invisible, peaceful form,
the line that abides in the depths of the mind,
is never to be shown to others,
not for lending, use, sale and the like,
nor applied to enjoyments,
nor for the sake of material wealth.
To the deluded, the arrogant, and those weak in diligence,
it is taught that it must never be given;
like a despised treasure in a corpse,
it is taught that no one should approach it;
like the talk of the crow among living creatures,
it must never be spoken of.

The activity vajra, the host of the genuine,
forty four, the path of the four continents,
Samantabhadra, in the manner of skillful means:
meditate on the deities of the three clusters.

The dharma element, activity, the host of a,
the forty two that set it forth,
Samantabhadrī, in the manner of wisdom,
the genuine, primordial wisdom, the mind of minds:
meditate on the deities of the three clusters.
Dissolve these into the dharma element, a.
The sphere of the dharma of dharmas, of activity,
is Samantabhadrī, the mother of bliss:
within her state, imagine all the hosts.
The elements of earth, water and fire
arise from her sphere;
let one who so desires imagine this thoroughly.
Unabiding, to the limitless reach of space,
one who wishes to become habituated will attain this:
to walk upon water as upon earth,
to dwell in the midst of blazing fuel,
and, lifted by the hot wind,
to travel to all the ten directions.

This is the thirty seventh chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the Vajra Essence of All Activities.

Then the Blessed One, Great Delight, in order that this Secret Essence be held firmly, uttered this inspired utterance:

Through union with suchness, the dharmadhātu,
one is blessed as the lord of all buddhas.
Like the colors of kṣa lam a,
meditate on the maṇḍala of the Net of Illusion.
Just as when metal is poured into a mold,
that itself is the supreme accomplishment of the path of mind.

Through union that makes suchness clear,
one is blessed as the lord of all buddhas.
Like the colors of oṃ lāṃ a,
meditate on the maṇḍala of the Net of Illusion.
Just as when metal is poured into a mold,
that itself is the supreme accomplishment of the path of form.

Through union of suchness with equality,
one is blessed as the lord of all buddhas.
Like the colors of svāṃ laṃ a,
meditate on the maṇḍala of the Net of Illusion.
Just as when metal is poured into a mold,
that itself is the special, supreme path.

Through union that realizes the dharmadhātu,
one is blessed as the lord of all buddhas.
Like the colors of oṃ laṃ a,
meditate on the maṇḍala of the Net of Illusion.
Just as when metal is poured into a mold,
that itself is the supreme accomplishment of the three paths.

Through union with the activity of the dharmadhātu,
one is blessed as the lord of all buddhas.
Like the host of hāṃ laṃ a,
meditate on the maṇḍala of the Net of Illusion.
Just as when metal is poured into a mold,
that is the primordial wisdom of enlightened activity.

From that, meditate on the samādhi of illusion.
The supreme maṇḍala of the Net itself:
meditate on the mudrā of the ten-pronged family.
That itself is ha and kṣaḥ;
meditate on the deities of the host of mūṃ.
From the supreme illusion of the buddhas
comes the manifestly perfect maṇḍala of the Net.
That itself holds in hand the path of hūṃ,
fully adorned with the ten-pronged ornament.
Or else, the five-pronged mind of minds:
from the center, Locanā of hūṃ;
binding the mudrā of holding the hook,
three times with hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ
bless your own body, speech and mind.
Urge on the deities of the host of mūṃ.
Bind the mudrā of the five syllables and bless.
By brandishing the generation through to completion,
draw the maṇḍala of the forty two.
Through pacifying and enriching three times,

the rites one desires are accomplished.
The tenth, the fierce one, deep dark blue,
brandishing with a haughty dance,
stamping the dance to the sweet sound of speech,
when joined in the eight mudrās,
brandishing with phaṭ phaṭ hūṃ,
holding in hand the emblem of the heart,
from the king of body, speech and mind,
those who destroy the body of merit come under control,
and he grants the attainment of whatever is wished and hoped.
Adorned and graceful messengers,
Brahmā, Indra, and the Lord of Desire,
in short, the lords of the twelve continents,
the haughty ones of fierce power,
spellbound by mantra, faint and lose their wits,
and will offer the excellent vase.
Adorned goddesses and nāginīs,
horses and elephants for mounts,
dwellings, supports and clothing,
the jewel that rests upon their crowns,
whatever is wished, whatever the mind conceives, they offer.
They will act toward him like servants.
All of his needs
will be accomplished, entirely and without exception.

This is the thirty eighth chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, Holding the Great Illusion Firmly, the Source of Nectar.

Then the Tathāgata, from the Net of Illusion, entered into equipoise in the samādhi called Taming Beings through Compassion, the Source of Nectar, and uttered this inspired utterance:

How wonderful! With regard to phenomena pure from the beginning,
wrong conceptions are established in two kinds.
All things are born from the five elements.
From what is wholly pure and stainless,
discordant conceptions arise, each apart.
What is medicine for some is poison for others;
there is nothing that has not become medicine.

Everything without exception, from a single cause,
appears separately with discordant distinctions.
No one made them; who is there to make them?
Each is bound by the noose of conception.
All suffering without exception, the machinery of delusion,
the three realms and the four inversions,
the three times and all five classes of beings,
all afflictions and all sufferings, it purifies.
It brings the view of liberation to completion.
The ten grounds are completed, and the ground of buddhahood is completed too.
Therefore this medicine should be prepared,
since it is a medicine that benefits all.
Therefore do not cling to "I" and self.
Cast off the notions of clean and defiled.
Practice everything as equality.
Realize the root, the mind of awakening itself.
Through skillful means, practice the perfections.
Through compassion, let nothing go to waste.
The supreme nectar is the sphere of equality.
The meaning of nectar is the absence of birth and death.
The abode of nectar is the mind of awakening.
The action of nectar is to purify conceptions.
It gathers one's own glory and accomplishes the welfare of beings.
The blessing of the medicine is inconceivable.
It purifies the lower realms and accomplishes the higher realms.
Like the elixir that turns things to gold, and like the dispeller of darkness,
it accomplishes various other aims as well.
Poisons arising from conditions,
root poisons and compounded poisons,
nāga poison, poison sent by sorcery, and the rest:
through the blessing of great compassion,
in order to subdue all poisons,
meditate on the maṇḍala, whole and complete.
In the five places dissolve the five syllables,
oṃ hūṃ trāṃ hrīḥ a.
Or else do it with the letter āṃ.

Or else send it forth from the letter hrīḥ.
Transform the poisons into nectar.
Let them dissolve into the sphere of equality.
a hoḥ: this is in the secret words of the vajra.

hūṃ, by nature the vajra of aversion,
through compassion subdues the self of conception;
it joins "I" and selflessness in the sphere,
and is endowed with a mind of loving-kindness.
oṃ, by nature great delusion,
is a state of clear rays of wisdom light,
of the wheel from which all things arise.
trāṃ, by nature pride, is quality:
through compassion it increases the welfare of beings;
it joins the great peaceful mind in the sphere,
an immeasurable ocean of qualities.
hrīḥ, by nature desire, is supreme speech:
it purifies afflictions and karma.
Afflictions and sufferings are completely purified;
the mind free of attachment is awakening.
a, by nature the Karmasattva,
accomplishes all aims without exception,
the supreme tamer of all wrong conceptions,
radiating through the ten directions and four times.
mūṃ, by nature wisdom and luminosity,
dispels laziness and distraction;
arising from swift compassion,
it is unobstructed everywhere among the victors.
It purifies afflictions and karma,
and brings great relief as well.
The purifier of poisons is the three bodies;
the purifier of the five paths is the five wisdoms;
the weapon of wisdom cuts saṃsāra at its root.
Gathered into hūṃ and scattered by hoḥ,
burned by raṃ and hurled away by phaṭ,
let them dissolve into the sphere of the drop
in which skillful means and wisdom are joined.

Then, having become the nondual sphere,
meditate on the body of the wisdom being.
Meditate on one syllable, three syllables, five syllables.
All the forty two without exception
and the buddha maṇḍala, meditate on them complete.
With no "I" and no self, partake of it as the mudrā.
Then meditate on all the five enjoyments
as the five wisdoms, the five families,
the five goddesses and the five medicines.

By reciting oṃ hūṃ trāṃ hrīḥ aḥ oṃ vajra amṛte kuṇḍali hana hana hūṃ phaṭ oṃ viśuddhe amṛte hūṃ phaṭ oṃ dharma amṛte hūṃ phaṭ oṃ āḥ hūṃ, everything becomes pure. It becomes nectar.

Earth, water, fire, wind and space:
in order to analyze them as without intrinsic nature,
divide each one into five,
and dissolve them into the sphere of mūṃ.
Upon those great elements
generate the superior samādhi.
Awareness is the mudrā of skillful means:
meditate on them as the five tathāgatas,
and the characteristic of each element
should be meditated on as the five mothers.
Their family is the five wisdoms themselves.

Taken as the cause, form and the rest, the forty two,
all things outer and inner, the vessel and its contents,
within the very sphere of suchness,
all that has thus come about and been born,
what need is there to say it, are that itself.
a hoḥ How wonderful! Through the superior blessing,
meditate that the deities are gathered into yourself.
Then, being nondual with the deity,
yourself and the letters oṃ and mūṃ,
the two and the self, dissolve into the sphere.
Meditate on yourself as Amṛtakuṇḍalin,
his body's color like the sun rising on snow,
upon a throne seat of moon and lotus,

having a throne seat of a thousand suns,
surrounded by the hosts of gods and goddesses,
together with the maṇḍala of wrathful gods and goddesses,
beautified by the mudrās of the sacred places and lands,
surrounded by hosts of attendants and handmaids.
a ho A wheel of four spokes with its rim:
in the center, Amṛtakuṇḍalin;
on the eastern spoke, Vajra;
on the southern spoke, Ratna;
on the western spoke, Amitābha;
on the northern spoke, Amoghasiddhi.
Meditate on them as endowed with skillful means and wisdom.
Meditate clearly on the mudrās as well.
Recite the essence syllables and words clearly.
There, the mudrā of nectar
is a full vase, blazing like a wish-fulfilling jewel.
It fulfills hopes just as one wishes,
it dispels afflictions and sufferings,
it endows one with the qualities of the five sense pleasures:
it is the great, unsurpassed accomplishment.
It makes nectar fall like rain.
Together with the mudrās of the four gates,
the very cause of amṛta is
the mind of awakening and the great flesh,
urine and excrement together with maṃsa,
padma rakta and the like,
and other various beneficial substances as well.
Whether separating them or not separating them,
bless them as nectar itself.
In order to purify the habitual tendencies of conception,
purify them beyond clean and unclean.
Dissolve them once again into the sphere.
Meditate on the mudrā blazing with rays of light.
It dispels the four hundred and four diseases,
frees one from the three poisons and from suffering,
lets one live for many long aeons,
and one will attain the great accomplishment:

it is truly said to complete the two accumulations.
Having yourself become the letter hūṃ,
meditate that all things endowed with the five enjoyments
become oṃ āḥ hūṃ.
Light radiates and blazes, emanating to the ten directions;
gathered back again, the light radiates and blazes as nectar.
Meditate one-pointedly, with perfect clarity.
Moreover, seal it with the host of letters.
If it is drunk, the obscurations of the lower realms are purified.
tra ta Relied on constantly, it accomplishes even the supreme accomplishment.
It dispels the four hundred and four diseases.
If one constantly makes offerings of it to the deity,
the deity becomes nondual with oneself.
If one makes a torma of it for the hostile side,
even the fierce and violent become gentle.
Moreover, all accomplishments
are achieved just as one intends.
Since one attains the state of buddhahood,
what need is there to mention gods, spirits and the rest?
Practice without doubt.
Practice constantly and dissolve into the sphere.

This is the thirty ninth chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, from the King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, on Accomplishing Medicine.

Then Great Delight uttered this inspired utterance called The Arising of Their Blessings:

Here, the sacred offering
is the forty five great magical displays themselves,
abiding in the constituents and the elements.
That itself is illusion, skilled in means;
through the Net, body, speech and mind are manifestly perfect.
All without exception are mudrā itself,
having become the support of the supreme dharmakāya:
meditate on them clearly, filling the ten directions.
That itself, filling the whole path of speech,
meditate on fully as the host of hūṃ.

Dissolve the body itself into the host of hā.
Taking up the form of the one to be acted upon,
with powdered pigment of black color,
enter yourself into his heart,
and reciting the mantra called jaḥ,
drive him with iron to go swiftly.
Keener of scent and swifter than before,
he carries out whatever task is assigned.
If you wish to come forth from his body,
take up your own form through pacifying,
and gathering slowly with hūṃ,
you will enter into your own body.

All without exception are mudrā itself,
having become the support of the supreme dharmakāya:
meditate on them clearly, filling the ten directions.
That itself, filling the path of speech and the body,
meditate on intently as the host of oṃ.
Dissolve the body itself into the host of aḥ.
Taking up the form of the one to be acted upon,
with powdered pigment of white color,
enter yourself into his heart,
and reciting the mantra called hūṃ,
he becomes a great king honored by many,
of sharp intelligence, wise mind and fair face,
his enjoyments gather more than before,
and he becomes as one who delights to remain.
If you wish to come forth from his body,
take up your own form through pacifying,
and gathering slowly with oṃ,
you will be brought into your own body.

All without exception are mudrā itself,
having become the support of the supreme dharmakāya:
meditate on them clearly, filling all directions.
That itself, filling the whole path of speech,
meditate on thoroughly as the host of svāṃ.
Dissolve the body itself into the host of svāṃ.

Taking up the form of the one to be acted upon,
with powdered pigment of yellow color,
enter yourself into his heart,
and reciting the mantra called svāṃ,
a minister of great wealth and wise mind,
of sharp intelligence, gathers enjoyments more than before;
enjoying them among his retinue,
he becomes as one who delights to remain.
If you wish to come forth from his body,
take up your own form through enriching,
and slowly saying svāṃ,
you will enter into your own body.

All without exception are mudrā itself,
having become the support of the supreme dharmakāya:
filling the ten directions, meditate on them clear and blazing.
Filling those and the body,
meditate on them intently as the host of āṃḥ.
Dissolve the body itself into the host of āṃḥ.
Taking up the form of the one to be acted upon,
with powdered pigment of red color,
enter yourself into his heart,
and reciting the mantra called āṃḥ,
queens, ministers of the maternal clan and the mighty
come under your power just as you wish.
Enjoying among his retinue,
he becomes as one who delights to remain.
If you wish to come forth from his form,
take up your own form through magnetizing,
and slowly saying āṃḥ,
you will enter into your own body.

All without exception are mudrā itself,
having become the support of the supreme dharmakāya:
meditate on them clearly, filling all directions.
That itself, filling the path of speech and the body,
meditate on intently as the host of hāṃ.
Dissolve the body itself into the host of hāṃ.

Taking up the form of the one to be acted upon,
with powdered pigment of green color,
enter yourself into his heart,
and reciting the mantra called hāṃ,
the great family of activity takes whatever form is desired,
with many troops, mighty forces, and fine armor and weapons.
Those full of aversion will be subdued,
those full of desire will gather,
and the greatly proud will bow down.
He will uphold his teaching.
Enjoying among his retinue,

he becomes as one who delights to remain.
If you wish to come forth from his body,
evenly take up the wrathful form,
and slowly saying haṃ,
you arise in an invisible form
and enter into your own body.
In islands or in charnel grounds,
through my wish, by the Lord of Dharma,
one holds the supreme maṇḍala of illusion,
and the maṇḍala of the Net arises completely.

This is the fortieth chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, The Arising of the Blessings of All the Tathāgatas.

Then the Blessed One, the glorious Samantabhadra, in order to show his own great qualities, for the sake of sentient beings, brought forth from the vajra of body, speech and mind this sphere of suchness:

The mother of the supreme family of glory itself:
on the image into which the deity is to be brought down,
mark the crown, the mouth and the heart;
blessed by the five syllables, imagine it as mūṃ.
Through familiarity with that, marking the secret place,
meditate on the deities of the host of mūṃ.
From that very freedom from extremes, from non-apprehension,
holding to that moonlike manner,
meditate on Buddha Vajra canaka

as joined with the mother, Prajñā.
Entering the path, fill her body.
Familiar with that, the mind blissful and clear, emanate and dissolve.
Likewise meditate on the families as oṃ.
The vessel and its abode are filled with bliss,
and the host of mothers too abides clearly.
The mudrā, the essence, the form and the rest:
contemplate them in accordance with the family.
Like the radiating and gathering of the steadfast āḥ,
imagine the consciousness in the state of blessing.
From the very mind without ground or root,
meditate on clouds of wish-fulfilling letters.
When the mudrā is perfectly clear,
this is proclaimed to be close approach.
Radiating and gathering in the number fitting the family,
having meditated, when recitation is directly present,
bind the mudrā of the supreme hook.
By that, things become just as you wish.

Body and speech by nature, unconditioned,
not dependent on another, the vajra family,
the glorious mother, Vajra Illusion,
proclaimed thoroughly by the Dharma:
for one who wishes for clarity and is to be made to speak,
mark the crown, the mouth and the heart;
blessed into the five syllables, imagine it as lāṃ.
Through familiarity with that, marking the secret place,
meditate on the deities of the host of lāṃ.
From union with Buddhalocanā,
all the victors bestow blessing.
From that very freedom from extremes, from non-apprehension,
having the form of the supreme nature,
meditate on Buddha Vajra canaka
as joined with the mother, Prajñā.
From that, blessed as the vajra,
the secret lotus is the means of entry.
Entering the sheath, fill her body.

Familiar with that, the mind blissful and clear, emanate and dissolve.
Meditate on the vajra families as hūṃ.
With the vessel and its abode filled with bliss,
the host of mothers too abides clearly.
The mudrā, the essence, the form and the rest:
contemplate them intently in accordance with the family.
Like the radiating and gathering of the steadfast hā,
imagine the consciousness in the state of blessing.
From the very mind without ground or root,
meditate on clouds of wish-fulfilling letters.
The mudrā made clear is close approach;
radiating and gathering in the number fitting the family;
in meditation, recitation and direct presence,
it is taught to urge on with the gaze of the hook.
With the mudrā of passion,
meditate on radiating and gathering in accordance with the family.

Treasure of qualities, of body and speech, wish-fulfilling,
the glorious, supreme great lady of Illusion:
the image, dressed and adorned,
on tree saplings and the like,
performing the supreme act of bringing down,
mark the crown, the mouth and the heart;
blessed by the five syllables, imagine it as oṃ.
Through familiarity with that, marking the secret place,
meditate on the deities of the host of oṃ.
From union with the buddha of fire,
all the victors bestow blessing.
From that very freedom from extremes, from non-apprehension,
having the form of a treasury of qualities,
meditate on Buddha Ratna canaka
as joined with the mother, Prajñā.
From that, blessed as the vajra,
the secret lotus is the means of entry.
Entering into the sheath, fill her body.
Familiar with that, the mind blissful and clear, emanate and dissolve.
Meditate on the jewel families as svāṃ.

The vessel and its abode are filled with bliss,
and the host of mothers too abides clearly.
The mudrā, the essence, the form and the rest:
contemplate them intently in accordance with the family.
Like the radiating and gathering of the steadfast svāṃ,
imagine the consciousness in the state of blessing.
From the very mind without ground or root,
meditate on clouds of wish-fulfilling letters.
The mudrā made clear is close approach;
radiating and gathering in accordance with the family,
having meditated, when recitation is directly present,
bind with the supreme noose of samaya.
With the four mudrās of passion,
meditate on gathering and radiating in accordance with the family.
Healing and killing, defeat and victory,
going elsewhere and staying,
coming at will, or speaking, as you please;
from many weapons and terrors,
from acts of binding and from weapons, one is freed.

The glorious mother of the supreme lotus,
holding the form of great bliss, the lord of dance:
the image into which she is to be brought down,
on tree saplings and the like.
First bless the five places;
then meditate on wisdom in the five places.
Mark the crown, the mouth and the heart;
imagine them as vaṃ, the seed of the four activities.
Through familiarity with that, marking the secret place,
meditate on the deities of the host of vaṃ.
From union with the buddha of water,
the vajra speeches bestow blessing.
From that very freedom from extremes, from non-apprehension,
having the form of vajra speech,
meditate on Buddha Great Speech canaka
as joined with the mother, Prajñā.
From that, blessed as the vajra,

the secret lotus is the means of entry.
Entering into the sheath, fill her body.
Familiar with that, the mind blissful and clear, emanate and dissolve.
Summon with the name together with the essence.
Meditate on the vajra speeches as oṃ.
With the vessel and its abode filled with bliss,
the host of mothers too abides clearly.
The mudrā, the essence, the form and the rest:
contemplate them intently in accordance with the family.
Like the radiating and gathering of the steadfast oṃ,
imagine the consciousness in the state of blessing.
From the very mind without ground or root,
meditate on clouds of letters of the Lord of Dharma.
The mudrā made clear is close approach;
radiating and gathering in accordance with the family,
having meditated, when recitation is directly present,
bind with the supreme chain of passion.
With the four mudrās of great passion,
meditate on them as in accord with the family.
Pacifying, magnetizing, wrathful and enriching:
whatever one wishes, these are highly praised.

The glorious lady of Illusion, Accomplishment:
the image into which she is to be brought down,
on the best and middling trees.
Mark the crown, the mouth and the heart;
blessed by the five syllables, imagine it as hāṃ.
That is the host of e.
Through familiarity with that, marking the secret place,
meditate on the deities of the host of fire.

Those are the deities above.
From selflessness, freedom from extremes, non-apprehension,
holding to that manner of Amoghasiddhi,
meditate on the supreme canaka of Amoghasiddhi
as joined with the mother, Prajñā.
From that, blessed as the crossed vajra,
the secret lotus is the means of entry.

Entering into the sheath, fill her body.
Filled with the colors of the crossed vajra,
summon the names too with their respective essences.
Familiar with that, the mind blissful and clear, emanate and dissolve.
Meditate on the vajra deities as hāṃ.
With the vessel and its abode filled with bliss,
the host of mothers too abides clearly.
The mudrā, the essence, the form and the rest:
meditate on them as in accord with the family.
Like the radiating and gathering of the steadfast hāṃ,
imagine the consciousness in the state of blessing.
From the very mind without ground or root,
meditate on clouds of accomplished illusion.
The mudrā made clear is close approach;
radiating and gathering in accordance with the family,
having meditated, when recitation is directly present,
delighting with the melodious speech of dance,
with the four mudrās of passion,
meditate on them as in accord with the family.
Going to the directions and snatching away,
cutting short life, and the activities,
the supreme power of saying whatever one wishes directly:
one sports with the mother of the family.
Exalted beyond existence, nirvāṇa
will be accomplished through this samādhi.

When this had been said, he knew the host of ripenings to be the very great qualities of the tathāgatas. Having known this, he brought forth from the sphere of suchness, the vajra of body, speech and mind, these vajra secret words:

a hoḥ What is to be thought, once it has been thought,
is not grasped by thought; it is inconceivable.
Beyond thought, spontaneously present, unmoving, immeasurable, inconceivable.
The very sphere known as the condition joined with the cause is inexhaustible.
Wondrous! The path of existence, free of extremes, without reference:
that itself is the wheel of supreme qualities, the supreme path.

a hoḥ So it is in the vajra secret words.

This is the forty first chapter, called The Blessed One, the Glorious Samantabhadra, Showing Great Qualities from the Sphere of Suchness.

Then the Blessed One, the glorious Samantabhadra, brought forth from the vajra of body, speech and mind this rite, together with its ritual procedure, called Blessing the Maṇḍala of Speech of the Great Illusion That Shows Great Qualities:

The maṇḍalas of the supreme bringing down,
with their colors and numbers, without confusion:
to one of knowledge, of great intellect and broad mind,
who does not weary of practicing the profound,
keeping to proper food and clothing, give the samaya food.
Cool the disciples with water in a conch vessel.
Teach the samādhi suited to be a support,
and teach empowerment and the supreme accomplishment as well.
Impart the secret samaya of silence.
Having shown the mind of oṃ and mūṃ,
in secret, purify from the five signs.
The forty two maṇḍalas of illusion:
join them with the aggregates, elements and sense bases.
Make the offering endowed with the five enjoyments.
Recite the great speech, the vajra path of speech:

oṃ sarva tathāgata jīna oṃ oṃ vajra kula hūṃ vajra oṃ sarva tathāgata svāṃ ratna svāṃ oṃ padma tathā hṛdaya ārolik hā prajñā hāṃ dhātvīśvari mūṃ dveṣarati lāṃ moharati āṃ rāgarati pāṃ vajrarati tāṃ mūṃ mūṃ mūṃ lāṃ lāṃ lāṃ āṃḥ āṃḥ āṃḥ pāṃ pāṃ pāṃ tāṃ tāṃ tāṃ e vaṃ ma ya va va va va va jra jra jra jra jra sa sa sa sa sa ma ma ma ma ma ya ya ya ya ya stvaṃ hoḥ

When this was said, throughout the boundless ten directions of the six worlds, the supreme of all samayas, the very essence of the body, speech and heart of all the tathāgatas, appeared everywhere as the very nature of the great Dhātvīśvarī, the great Locanā, the great Māmakī, the great Pāṇḍaravāsinī, and the samaya noble lady, the great Tārā.

This is the forty second chapter, called The Wheel of Speech for Bringing Down, the Essence of the Vajra of Body, Speech and Mind of All the Tathāgatas.

Then the Blessed One, the glorious Samantabhadra, entered into equipoise in the samaya called Gathering the Blessings of the Great Illusion, and brought forth from the vajra Net of Illusion of the body, speech and mind of all the tathāgatas:

Gathering the blessings of Lāsyā, the offering goddess,
the one who shows form, who is to be brought down:
on an image in accord with the family,
mark the crown, the mouth and the heart;
blessed by the five syllables, bestow ya itself.
That itself is the lotus maṇḍala.
Familiar with that, marking the secret place,
meditate on the deities of the host of ya.
Those are the deities of hūṃ:
from selflessness, freedom from extremes, non-apprehension,
holding to their own manner,
meditate on Buddha Vajra canaka
as joined with the mother, Prajñā.
From that, blessed as the vajra,
the secret lotus is the means of entry.
Entering into the sheath, fill her body.
Filled with the colors of the vajra,
call out the names too with their respective essences.
Familiar with that, the mind blissful and clear, emanate and dissolve.
Summon with the name together with the essence.
Meditate on the vajra deities as hūṃ.
With the vessel and its abode filled with Lāsyās,
the host of mothers too abides clearly.
The mudrā, the essence, the form and the rest:
contemplate them as in accord with the family.
Like the radiating and gathering of the steadfast hā,
imagine the consciousness in the state of blessing.
From the very mind without ground or root,
meditate on clouds of Buddha Vajras.
The mudrā made clear is close approach;
radiating and gathering in accordance with the family,
having meditated, when recitation is directly present,
bind the mudrā of the four gatekeeper goddesses.

With the four mudrās of passion,
meditate on them as in accord with the family.

Gathering the blessings of the Jewel Garland goddess,
the one who shows form, who is to be brought down:
on an image in accord with the family,
mark the crown, the mouth and the heart;
blessed by the five syllables, bestow e itself.
That itself is the lotus maṇḍala.
Familiar with that, marking the secret place,
meditate on the deities of the host of e.
Those are the deities of svāṃ:
from selflessness, freedom from extremes, non-apprehension,
holding to their own manner,
meditate on Buddha Ratna canaka
as joined with the mother, Prajñā.
From that, blessed as the vajra,
the secret lotus is the means of entry.
Entering into the sheath, fill her body.
Filled with the colors of the jewel,
summon the names too with their respective essences.
Familiar with that, the mind blissful and clear, emanate and dissolve.
Meditate on the jewel deities as svāṃ.
With the vessel and its abode filled with Garland goddesses,
the host of mothers too abides clearly.
The mudrā, the essence, the form and the rest:
contemplate them as in accord with the family.
Like the radiating and gathering of the steadfast svāṃ,
imagine the consciousness in the state of blessing.
From the very mind without ground or root,
meditate on clouds of Buddha Ratnas.
The mudrā made clear is close approach;
radiating and gathering in accordance with the family,
having meditated, when recitation is directly present,
bind the mudrā of the four gatekeeper goddesses.

With the four mudrās of passionate attachment,
meditate in accord with the family.

The gathering-in of the blessing of the lotus expanse,
causing it to descend upon a likeness, is this:
on an image in accord with the family,
mark the crown, the mouth and the heart.
Blessed by the five syllables, imagine it as baṃ.
Meditate on that very thing as the lotus maṇḍala.
Growing familiar with it, marking the secret place,
meditate on the deities of the host of baṃ.
These are the deities of oṃ:
from selfless, extreme-free non-objectification,
holding to that natural state of one's own,
meditate on Lotus buddhas the size of chickpeas
as united with the mother, Prajñā.
Then, blessed as vajra,
this is the means of entering through the secret lotus:
having entered the sheath, fill that body,
filling it with the host of the lotus,
and with their individual essence mantras summon even humans.
Familiar with that, the mind blissful and clear, radiate and dissolve;
meditate on the lotus deities as oṃ.
With the vessel and its abode filled with Song goddesses,
the host of mothers too abides clearly.
The mudrā, the essence, the form and the rest:
meditate on them as in accord with the family.
Like the radiating and gathering of the steadfast hāṃ,
imagine the consciousness in the state of blessing.
From the very mind without ground or root,
meditate on clouds of Buddha Ratnas.
The mudrā made clear is close approach;
radiating and gathering in accordance with the family,
having meditated, when recitation is directly present,
bind the mudrā of the four gatekeeper goddesses.
With the four mudrās of passionate attachment,
meditate in accord with the family.

The gathering-in of the blessing of the dancers of the Karma family,
causing it to descend upon a likeness, is this:

on an image in accord with the family,
mark the crown, the mouth and the heart.
Blessed by the five syllables, bestow the syllable ma itself.
Meditate on that very thing as the lotus maṇḍala.
Growing familiar with it, marking the secret place,
meditate on the deities of the host of ma.
These are the deities of hāṃ:
from selfless, extreme-free non-objectification,
holding to that natural state of one's own,
meditate on Lotus buddhas the size of chickpeas
as united with the mother, Prajñā.
Then, blessed as vajra,
this is the means of entering through the secret lotus:
having entered the sheath, fill that body,
filling it with the host of karma deities,
and with their individual essence mantras summon even humans.
Familiar with that, the mind blissful and clear, radiate and dissolve;
meditate on the karma deities as hāṃ.
With the vessel and its abode filled with Dancer goddesses,
the host of mothers too abides clearly.
The mudrā, the essence, the form and the rest:
meditate on them as in accord with the family.
Like the radiating and gathering of the steadfast hāṃ,
imagine the consciousness in the state of blessing.
From the very mind without ground or root,
meditate on clouds of Buddha Karmas.
The mudrā made clear is close approach;
radiating and gathering in accordance with the family,
having meditated, when recitation is directly present,
bind the mudrā of the four gatekeeper goddesses.
With the four mudrās of passionate attachment,
meditate in accord with the family.

The deities of the forty-two maṇḍalas appearing manifestly,
the many gatekeepers, male and female,
the supreme goddesses of the four times caused to descend,
together with the hosts of gods and nāgas:

it is fitting to make them speak manifestly.
Kingdoms and the seizing of retinues,
gathering and bringing under control,
slaying and expelling, with all the rest,
oneself going and arriving swiftly,
the wealth one desires, and whatever is to be done:
all this is accomplished by this samādhi.
At no fixed time, one meets with offerings.

When this was spoken, all the ten directions of the six worlds became a great offering of the gathering-in of blessings.

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, this is the forty-third chapter, called "The Compassion of the Net of Illusion, which Gathers In Blessings and Causes the Samaya to Descend."

Then Great Delight entered the samādhi called the Vajra Essence of Great Enjoyment, and brought forth this, called "The Enjoyment of the Samaya Offerings of the Great Illusion," from the vajra Net of Illusion of the body, speech and mind of the tathāgatas.

What those of superior, middling and lesser intellect
should definitely meditate upon is this:
one who desires the foremost of royal Earth-Holders,
on a drawn image or on a support,
should mark the crown, the mouth and the heart,
and habitually meditate on jaḥ, red in color.
Familiar with that, draw it inward through the secret place,
and hold one's own body as red in color, in that state.
Mark the crown, the mouth and the heart;
blessed by the five syllables, imagine it as baṃ.
Familiar with that, meditate on the maṇḍala of dance.
Saying jaḥ, bind the mudrā and draw them in,
and habitually, in the manner of entering through the secret place,
gather them by way of the path into the Lord of Speech.
From oṃ, meditate on buddhas the size of chickpeas
filling the vessel, the abode and the maṇḍala.
Through habitual repetition of the name and the essence mantra, summon.
When it has become directly and clearly present,

array the offerings of passionate attachment
marked by the hook and the rest.
When habituation in the mind is clear,
the one toward whom it is done comes under control.

For ministerial Earth-Holders, array the offerings.
When habituation in the mind is clear,
mark the mouth and heart of the one toward whom it is done,
and habitually meditate on jaḥ, red in color.
Familiar with that, draw it inward to the secret place,
and hold one's own body as red in color, in that state.
Mark the crown, the mouth and the heart;
blessed by the five syllables, imagine it as baṃ.
Familiar with that, meditate on the maṇḍala of dance.
Saying jaḥ, bind the mudrā and draw them in,
and habitually, in the manner of entering the secret place,
gather them by way of the path into the supreme of speech.
From āṃḥ, meditate on buddhas the size of chickpeas
filling the vessel, the abode and the maṇḍala.
Through habitual repetition of the name and the essence mantra, summon.
When it has become directly and clearly present,
array the offerings of passionate attachment
marked by the hook and the rest.
When the task is assigned to it,
the one toward whom it is done comes under control.

Goddesses, nāginīs, and women of low caste,
those whose desires are accomplished for a moment or for always:
all this is accomplished by this samādhi.
Upon Īśvara, the Great God (Śiva), Indra lord of the gods,
the great kings and the many guardians of the directions,
their wives, daughters and the rest are marked;
those whose minds are set on mastering sensual enjoyment:
all this is accomplished by this samādhi.
All their aims, without exception,
will be completely and perfectly accomplished.

When this was spoken, all the ten directions of the six worlds shook violently and became completely luminous, and the great enjoyment of the tathāgatas

appeared everywhere.

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, the vajra nature of the body, speech and mind of all the tathāgatas, this is the forty-fourth chapter, called "The Enjoyment of the Samaya Offerings of the Great Illusion."

Then the Great Sage, the Blessed One, appeared to the inconceivable host of nāgas as the great king, the Buddha, the Blessed One himself. Having tamed the host of nāgas of malicious deeds, for the sake of their devotion to the great accomplishment, he spoke these words.

In a place filled with inconceivable hosts of nāgas, of the second class, of the third class, of various classes, and those made into a retinue from the second direction, apart from one's own greater or lesser approach practice, whatever one does to please the mind will not succeed, and they will create obstacles. Therefore this, called the Fifth, the Removal of Obstacles, came forth, and it was spoken for this purpose.

So that one who sits in practice is not unsettled,
for mastering the ground as its owner,
for whatever substances of practice there may be,
for removing venomous snakes,
so that those belonging to the retinue, many or few,
are not seized by the malicious ones,
and so that malicious ones do not dwell
in trees, saplings and the like,
it is highly praised as the Fifth.
So that I may be honored by the malicious ones,
from the samādhi of the Net of Illusion,
oneself, dark blue, the color of the malicious ones,
holding in the hands a noose and an utpala,
upon the head the hoods of ten great snakes,
twenty, a hundred, a thousand or ten thousand,
countless great snakes,
black in color, with three blazing tongues.
Because the hosts of malicious nāgas are many,
with a great retinue, terrifying and hair-raising,
one should form this supreme mudrā.
When the syllables of Akṣobhya and Ratna
are separated and made fitting,

the malicious snakes will spread themselves out beneath.
Say: nāga pukala nāga phaṭ.
Whoever strives in this habitually,
if he takes up this guise of mine,
like a heap amid a mass of flames,
as the great king of great kings,
appearing clearly to all,
they will flee helplessly,
and become like servants to him.

Making oneself owner of the ground is this:
first, on ground that is perfectly level,
fill it with hosts of oṃ and muṃ.
From the maṇḍala of the jewel palace,
meditate on the maṇḍala of the entering host of deities.
Then, spreading the wings wide,
clap the vajra palms fiercely.
oṃ vajra krodha duna mune dunā gaccha
Then utterly destroy the syllables.
Then raise up the final syllable.
Then, the syllable that generates magical display:
taking up this guise of mine,
meditate on the maṇḍala of the level ground.
They become utterly terrified
and flee in all ten directions,
and become like servants to him.

Those belonging to the retinue are my retinue.
However many in a great retinue perform the supreme,
because many malicious ones work harm,
set fire well to the substances,
and it comes forth as my essence mantra is recited.
If one recites the six syllables for them,
the malicious ones cannot harm them,
and will honor and revere them,
and their illnesses will be healed.
For an image appearing directly,
for those of supreme, lesser and middling kind

to whom the hosts of malicious ones cling:
at the heart are the syllables aṃ,
red in color, within a blaze,
and all that appears as form abides there.
Having meditated on that state of the Sage,
imagine the letters of the jewel syllable.
Upon it, stretch out in great terror.
The first and last letters are the eyes,
the others blazing as a host of aṃ.
Akṣobhya himself, below, holds a club,
equipped with a skull staff.
Through mindfulness of the mantra upon the tongue,
empowered by all the victors,
the malicious nāgas will be tamed,
and flee in all ten directions,
and make offerings to him and become his servants.
oṃ mune padma samayogi hūṃ hūṃ jaja
Whoever strives in this habitually,
taking up this guise of mine,
will make offerings to those worthy of honor,
and all accomplishments will come swiftly.

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, this is the forty-fifth chapter, the Taming of the Malicious Deeds of the Hosts of Nāgas by the Great Sage, the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One, the glorious Samantabhadra, spoke this utterance for the sake of this, called "Overpowering the Hosts of Bhūtas."

From the maṇḍala of the Net of Illusion,
meditate on the deities of the two clusters.
Having arranged the place where I abide,
for a year, or for three or five months,
with a great vajra conch that is filled,
holding the vajra in hand, and the bell,
approach through mantra recitation and habituation in samādhi,
as dye changes the color of a substance,
until the signs become manifest.
Buddha Vajra, holding the vajra in hand,

transforming his own nature
into the great wrathful one, Vijaya,
eyes glaring, fangs bared, hateful eyes blazing,
legs extended and bent, menacing:
meditate on him upon the field.
When it becomes violently trembling,
recite his essence mantra:
that is the completion of his approach.
The signs of accomplishment in this way are these:
before whoever is the object,
looking with averted face and eyes,
say "phaṭ" fiercely upon the tongue.
They will faint; from aṃ let red elixir descend.
From that, the mind called hūṃ,
when it gathers into its first place,
if one wishes them to leap up, they will rise.

From the maṇḍala of the Net of Illusion,
meditate on the deities of the two clusters.
Having arranged the place where I abide,
for a year, or for three, five or seven months,
with his great conch that is filled,
holding the vajra in hand, and the bell,
approach through mantra recitation and habituation in samādhi,
as dye changes the color of a substance,
until the signs become manifest.
Buddha Vajra, holding the vajra in hand,
as the great wrathful one, Yama the King,
joined with the queen of wrathful Yamas,
transforming his own nature into that,
eyes glaring, fangs bared, with hateful eyes,
legs extended and bent, menacing:
meditate on him upon the field.
When it becomes violently trembling,
reciting his essence mantra as well,
cut at the waist with oṃ,
and meditate that thereby they come under control.

Earth into gold, water into earth,
just as is pleasing to the mind,
in whatever way, it will be accomplished.
From that, it is certain, according to one's wish:
that is the completion of his approach.
The signs of certainty in this way are these:
in the presence of the name, the form, or the person directly,
shaking the head, look with fierce, hateful eyes.
At the tip of oṃ say "phaṭ".
They will faint; from oṃ let red elixir descend.
From speech, by means of what is called aṃ,
together with the recitation, dissolve that into oneself.
Then it is certain, according to one's wish:
that is the practice of his approach.
The signs of certainty in this way are these:
in the presence of the name, the form, or the person directly,
looking with averted face and eyes,
by saying "phaṭ" fiercely from oṃ,
they will faint; from aṃ let red elixir descend.
From that comes what is called hūṃ.
When it is gathered into its first place,
if one wishes them to live, they will rise.

The manifest awakening of the Net of Illusion,
the whole essence of supreme awakening,
the mudrā, the duration of abiding and the rest,
the samādhi of the single part:
with a great vajra conch that is filled,
holding the vajra in hand, and the bell,
approach through mantra recitation and habituation in samādhi,
as dye changes the color of a substance,
until the signs become manifest.

Buddha Vajra, holding the vajra in hand,
transforming his own nature
into the great wrathful one, glorious Paramāśva,
eyes glaring, fangs bared, with hateful eyes,
legs extended and bent, menacing:

meditate on him upon the field.
When it becomes violently trembling,
reciting his essence mantra as well,
cut at the waist by means of oṃ,
and meditate that thereby they come under control.
Earth into gold, water into earth,
just as is pleasing to the mind,
in whatever way, it is certain to be accomplished;
it comes about for him according to his wish:
that is the completion of his approach.
The signs of his accomplishment are these:
in the presence of the name, the form, or the person directly,
shaking the head, look with fierce, hateful eyes.
By saying "phaṭ" fiercely from aṃ,
they will faint; from oṃ let red elixir descend.
From that, the mind called hūṃ,
when it is gathered into its first place,
if one wishes them to leap up, they will rise.

From that very Great Illusion,
Buddha Vajra, holding the vajra in hand,
transforming his own nature
into the great wrathful one, Amṛtakuṇḍalin,
eyes glaring, fangs bared, with hateful eyes,
legs extended and bent, menacing:
meditate on him upon the field.
When it has become violently trembling,
and goes swiftly off in some direction,
reciting his supreme essence mantra,
urging it on with hūṃ,
make it go back to its first place.
Meditate that thereby they come under control.
From that, whatever various things one desires,
each and every one is accomplished:
that is the completion of his approach.
By saying "phaṭ" fiercely at oṃ,
having visualized the one toward whom it is done,

by means of a snap of crossed fingers,
they will faint; from oṃ let red elixir descend.
By meditating in the mind, they will rise.

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, this is the forty-sixth chapter, the Arrangement of the Samaya Offerings that Make the Great Illusion Utterly Victorious.

Then, in the presence of the Blessed One, Great Delight, the great haughty ones, Maheśvara (Śiva), the Four Great Kings, and those who had become guardians of the directions, together with their commanders and wives, with their servants, attendants and sub-attendants, with minds filled with great terror, respectfully made a pledge, and also spoke with one voice their respective maṇḍalas and these, called their essence mantras:

"The offering of the maṇḍala of the haughty ones and their retinue,
and of our body, speech and mind, is this:
our retinue and attendants, six hundred million,
dwell in places of fresh and old skeletons,
feast on heaps of moist flesh and blood,
drink from skull cups and eat without limit;
with short spears, swords and axes,
nooses, clubs and hurled weapons,
drums and ḍamarus, scattering blood,
they are surrounded by all the hosts of the malicious.
Whoever merely holds the names
of these maṇḍalas of delight,
meditates on this at the soles of the feet,
and recites his own essence mantra,
we will act as servants to him.
Whatever his need may be,
we will accomplish it completely, without exception.
Having sat down, offer the essence mantra thus:
khaṃ dhu ha svāhā

"The offering of the maṇḍala of Īśvara, the Great God (Śiva),
and of our body, speech and mind, is this:
our retinue and attendants, eighty thousand koṭis,
with scattered flowers strewn about,

with many layered cushions of cloth,
with jewels laid out and drums beaten,
music, song and dance most melodious;
in the abodes of jeweled houses
we enjoy many goddesses,
we drink from jeweled vessels,
covered above by spreading parasols;
we appear in beautiful forms;
precious flowers and the like,
and flowers of the gods, we scatter in all directions,
surrounded by all the many hosts of gods.
Whoever merely holds the names
of these maṇḍalas of delight,
draws this at the soles of the feet,
and recites his own essence mantra,
we will act as servants to him,
place him on our crowns and honor him;
whatever his need may be,
we will accomplish it completely, without exception;
we will show him our forms and appear before him.
oṃ sarva devā mahā upaha

"King Vaiśravaṇa and Dhṛtarāṣṭra,
with our many thousands of hosts of retinue,
offer our body, speech and mind thus:
our retinue and attendants, a hundred koṭis of thousands,
with scattered flowers strewn about,
many ornaments and ointments spread upon the ground;
our commanders, twenty koṭis in number,
proclaim whatever is excellent;
with great ceremony and respectful reverence,
we make offerings in the proper manner:
such are we, together with our retinue.
With jewels laid out and with drinks,
adorned with melodious music, song and dance,
I dwell in jeweled houses,
with mounts and many troops all around.

Drinking beer from jeweled vessels,
covered above with adorning parasols,
we appear in beautiful forms;
we scatter precious flowers in all directions,
surrounded by all the many hosts of kings.
With the lord of the gandharvas and the lord of fire,
with Īśāna and the lord of the wind,
in this way we act with respect.
Whoever merely holds the names
of these maṇḍalas of delight,
having drawn them at the soles of the feet,
and recites his own essence mantra,
we will act as servants to him,
place him on our crowns and honor him;
whatever his need may be,
we will accomplish it completely, without exception;
we will show him our forms and appear before him.
oṃ siddha dhi dhi dhu ho svāhā

"King Virūpākṣa and Virūḍhaka,
with our many tens of thousands of hosts of retinue,
offer our body, speech and mind thus:
our hosts of retinue, a hundred koṭis of tens of thousands,
with scattered flowers strewn about,
many ornaments and ointments spread upon the ground;
our commanders, twenty koṭis in number,
proclaim whatever is excellent;
with great ceremony and respectful reverence,
we make offerings in the proper manner:
such are we, together with our retinue.
With jewels laid out and with drinks,
adorned with melodious music, song and dance,
I dwell in jeweled houses,
with mounts and many troops all around.
Drinking beer from jeweled vessels,
covered above by spreading parasols,
we appear in beautiful forms;

we scatter precious flowers in all directions,
surrounded by all the many hosts of kings.
With the hosts of yakṣas and rākṣasas,
the lord of the waters, and Yama's great retinue,
in this way we act with respect.
Whoever merely holds the names
of this great maṇḍala of delight,
having drawn it at the soles of the feet,
and recites his own essence mantra,
we will act as servants to him,
place him on our crowns and honor him;
whatever his need may be,
we will accomplish it completely, without exception;
we will show him our forms and appear before him.
oṃ dhaka bhidu bhavi śupaśe oṃ hūṃ"

When they had spoken thus with one voice, all that exists, as much as there is, was tamed by this great maṇḍala of mind, and the Blessed One, Great Delight, brought forth this secret vajra word from the vajra of body, speech, mind, qualities and activity: a ho.

The Tathāgatas, inconceivable, their essence inconceivable,
beyond the scattering and gathering of seeds, so hard to approach,
by a single unerring great action, thoroughly tame us,
and I cannot transgress the command of their praise.
Through the compassion of the mind, for as long as the unerring path itself remains,
to The Secret Essence, Ascertaining, the supreme Illusion itself,
I myself shall bow: what need is there to speak of others?
That itself is the very mind emanated from the mind.
ho: in secret vajra words.

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, this is the forty-seventh chapter, the Abodes of Those Who Were Thoroughly Tamed and the Offering of Their Essence Mantras.

Then, in the presence of the Blessed One, the embodiment of Great Delight, the glorious great Heruka, the great haughty ones, Maheśvara (Śiva) and the rest, the host of worldly beings, their minds filled with great longing through

the blessing of the Tathāgata, spoke with one voice this song of praise for that purpose:

"How wonderful! Glorious one of great and marvelous magic,
nature of Buddha Vajra,
for whom poison and nectar are no different,
the yogin's mind whose nature is pure,
Samantabhadra, vajra body,
chief of the wrathful kings of the five wisdoms,
blood-drinking, terrifying Heruka,
infinite buddha who tames an ocean of beings,
inconceivable compassion, chief of all the wrathful kings,
most exalted of all blood drinkers, wish-fulfilling treasury,
yellow-black, dark blue-black, green-black, red-black,
and blue-black, body majestic as Mount Meru,
dwelling in the center of the mountain of fire at the end of the eon,
fierce-faced in the midst of heaps of many corpses,
body gathered from merit, inexhaustible vajra,
like the light of sun and moon amid a host of stars,
with great might and haughtiness you crush all hosts of terrors,
displaying excellent, unequalled miracles,
abiding in the manner of the dance of the lord of desire.
Devouring with greed, the faces of mind, body and speech
dry up the endless ocean of blood and crush the spines;
wrathful frowns, drawing out hearts, terrifying, flicker like lightning;
the dark brown hair of a hundred thousand charnel grounds is terrifyingly majestic;
destroyer of saṃsāric thought, flaunting a garland of fresh skulls;
appearing at the summit for the sake of play, you laugh a a ha;
great in yourself, your head is adorned with the victors of complete empowerment;
your brows and wrathful frowns flicker like lightning,
sending forth and gathering in blood drinkers in accord with the directions.
By such emanations you overpower all.
Though terror arrays great hosts of darkness,
by your hateful eyes, blazing vast as sun and moon,
the heaped hosts of terror and suffering are utterly purified.
In wrath your mouth gapes, great teeth bared and blazing,

as if climbing from the peak of existence down to the realms of hell;
you swallow the world at once and cut off the six paths completely.
With the blazing emblems of wisdom held in your hands,
you reduce the three existences, without remainder, to empty atoms.
Sporting with the sounds of the palate, as if slapping beings,
you spread the teaching of the Dharma through all the three realms.
As food you partake of the great supreme vajra blood drinker,
and hold as your hide the fresh skin of the slain perishing aggregates.
Tamer of nāgas, your qualities are adorned with a thousand black snakes;
even the hosts of nāgas with their terrors are pressed beneath your feet.
Tamer of desire, chief of all desire,
great desire, the very body of desire,
you make many retinues into a terrifying retinue.
Tamer of hatred, chief of all hatred,
malicious hatred, body of all hatred,
melting all the hosts of terror with your rays,
utterly majestic, a form terrifying even to the terrifying.
Tamer of delusion, chief of all delusion,
dispeller of deluded minds, body of great delusion,
undivided blood drinker, great armor, steadfast as Mount Meru.
Tamer of pride, chief of all pride,
having slain the hosts of terrors, abode of many heaps of corpses,
legs spread, fangs bared, never at the end of your time of satisfaction,
you rejoice in coming with terror and are fiercely hateful.
Tamer of envy, chief of all envy,
great supreme envy, body of great envy,
gathering all women, dwelling at the center of the maṇḍala,
you slay with phaṭ those on wrong paths who are malicious.
You wear a skirt of human skin to tame the malicious;
your body is adorned with forms of the hosts of terrors, like your body.
Your legs and arms are beyond imagining.
Your great left legs, many, extended, crush the gods and pervade the māras;
your right legs, with many great means, gather power, casting out and drawn in.
Raising and snapping your vajra fingers, you utterly dispel the great sleep.
From the center of great light, great lightning flickers:
you hero unsurpassed in terror,

great lord of medicine who joins foul food with nectar,
one as terrifying as you is rare indeed.
Upon the stains that grow back though washed for eons,
by the blessing of the light of the sunrays of wisdom
and the magical display of the rain of pure compassion,
in an instant, by a mere sign, you purify from delusion and turmoil;
in the maṇḍala of wisdom that blocks the path of death,
compassion dawns that utterly purifies birth.
Treasury of great kindness, without love or hatred,
to the body, speech and mind of Heruka I bow."

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, this is the forty-eighth chapter, called "The Song Remembering Kindness."

Then the Blessed One, Great Delight, in order that this king of secret mantra be steadfast and unchanging, and abide in the world realms, spoke this utterance for that purpose to those of the bhūtas: the mistress of mistresses, the great Manurākṣasī, the Manurākṣasīs, Brahmāṇī, Raudrī, Indrāṇī, Vaiṣṇavī, Kaumārī, the Red One, Amṛtā, Śāntī, Daṇḍī, Rākṣasī, Bhakṣasī, Ratī, Rudhiramadī, Ekacāriṇī, Manohārikā, Siddhikarī, the River Goddess, the Slayer, the Human Woman, Vārāhī, Cāmuṇḍā, the Noseless One, Varuṇānī, Mahākālī, the great red-yellow Goat-Headed One, the great blue-black Kumbhakarṇī, the great yellow-black Lambodarā, and to the queens, ministresses, female commanders, attendants and sub-attendants, servants and sub-servants and the rest, the handmaids, concubines and bondwomen.

"This Secret Essence, Ascertaining,
is the king of all secret mantras.
The wisdom symbolized by great means,
the Essence of the Net of Illusion,
and the many secret tantras
are emanated from my mind.
In the domains of Brahmā and Śakra,
Maheśvara (Śiva) and the rest,
of the commanders and of Hārītī,
in Videha and Godānīya,
in Kuru and in Jambudvīpa,
this essence of my mind
is to be spread through all ten directions.

As for entrusting it to a person:
the abode of the command, rich as a wish-fulfilling treasury,
the outer and inner vehicles and the treatises,
and the eighty-four thousand teachings,
to one skilled in conduct, meditation, recitation,
and in all the vows,
armored in meditation, on the side of the Dharma,
able to uphold the teaching,
entrust the Secret Essence as supreme;
it is not to be told to others.
To one unshakable, profound of mind, able to bear conditions,
devoted to wish-fulfilling union,
teach the root and branch samayas.
With a partner, the samaya is great.
Skilled in both kinds of union,
able to accord with scripture and valid measure,
not telling it to others,
and making offerings to the teaching:
in the samaya of close approach,
in accomplishment, approach and close approach,
strive greatly, as far as one is able.
Having abandoned all the ways of ordinary beings,
whose mind is disturbed by nothing,
rushing with strength to the feast of offerings,
summoning women, offer to the chief.
By one skilled in secrecy, able to take a consort,
let it be fully entrusted to one who is certain;
it should not be taught elsewhere.
Enjoy desire, unobstructed and free.
To a woman who has every quality,
and who acts in accord with all desire,
once she has accepted the root,
show the body of the deity fittingly;
but the secret instructions of close approach
should never be given.
Having shown her that way of union,
nothing else is taught to be shown.

Faithful, gentle and sharp-witted,
of great faith and respectful to the Dharma,
suited to passion, obedient to the command,
happy to remain and listening to scripture,
accomplishing the root and branch samayas,
preparing the place of offering, guarding the vows:
having caused the blessing to descend in the approach,
in the place of offering of the feast of secret mantra,
having caused my secret to descend in blessing,
unobstructedly, in direct perception,
possessing the means of union, joining in union,
in the union that delights the nature
of the forty-two maṇḍalas,
make offering to the feast with the accomplishment of equality.
To those who lack the samaya, coarse in conduct,
who do not hold the teaching from the depths,
do not spread desire,
and do not show the meaning
of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.
My empowerments and trainings
are to be given fully, in proper order.
Men and women of low birth who indulge their desires,
of little enthusiasm and very great desire,
weak-minded, envious, given to exaggeration and denial,
fond of sleep, fond of beer, of little diligence,
disrespectful toward training, without earnestness,
not remembering the master, with little thought for their siblings,
even if they abide in the samaya,
cannot truly rejoice
in upholding my secret.
They are weak in view, transgressing the command,
hard to liberate, and weak in power.
In darkness, in secret, and among people,
wherever they meet in solitude they indulge desire,
and to some of those of desire
they speak the secret words.
Except in accord with the actual meaning,

the Secret Essence is not to be given.
Even until the world of the eon ends,
do not let the bliss of the mind radiate,
and never teach it.
If, out of delusion, it is given
for the sake of those who delight in worldly desire,
life is cut off by fever and disease;
it is the abandonment of root and branch,
and one dwells long in burning and torment."

When this had been spoken, all the hosts of women of all existence were tamed by this samaya. Then the Blessed One, Great Delight, brought forth this secret vajra word from the vajra of body, speech, mind, qualities and activity:

"Oh, how wonderful! How wonderful! Phenomena are illusion.
That very state is woman, the secret of the mantrin,
set down in five and six times, the treasure from which appearance and existence arise.
Having found the true path, it abides manifestly everywhere, abides everywhere.
Of however many mudrās of the many phenomena and of the equality of the nature of reality,
this great path, the miracle that turns bad actions into virtue,
the distinction of them all, is the one bliss of woman.
Because it is the very nature of all phenomena, it is taught fittingly, so that the lesser do not disparage it.
The very wealth of illusion is the Sugata himself, utterly clear."

In secret vajra words.

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, this is the forty-ninth chapter, the Taming of Women by the Great Samaya.

Then the Blessed One, Great Delight, spoke this pleasing offering for that purpose:

"Therein the great offering sacrifice is this:
first, liberate oneself through realization and familiarization.
Then, with a mind that is nondual,
with compassion for evil-minded worldly beings,
liberate them nondually.

With the great offering of embrace, in union,
delight others by delighting oneself.
The great substances of the accomplishment of equality
offer to the feast that is equal to oneself.
Food and chewables, drink and clothing,
all that possesses the five enjoyments:
maṇḍala dissolves into maṇḍala.
The wondrous qualities of the sugatas,
gone in the ten directions and the four times,
are not found anywhere else;
what need is there to speak of the existence of the gods and the rest?
For yogins who are fit for the work,
the Great Mudrā becomes complete,
and the clear mind, which is nondual,
becomes the great blazing maṇḍala."

When this had been spoken, great delight pervaded all the ten directions of the six worlds.

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, this is the fiftieth chapter, on the Offering Sacrifice.

Then the Blessed One, Great Delight, in order to make it meaningful, spoke the great samaya for that purpose.

"For those who have become certain in the unsurpassed vehicle,
even though they engage in all the actions of the afflictions,
what they do amasses no karma but becomes the accumulations,
and their moral discipline and vows are perfect.
In the samaya of the unsurpassed and supreme,
the moral discipline taught for the sake of discipline,
and however many inconceivable vows there are,
are all, without exception, included and completely pure.
Not even a middle way between existence and nonexistence is apprehended;
in the manner of an illusion or a mirage,
there is no life, and in killing there is nothing to kill;
life and person are mere misconceptions.
Because the two truths are inseparable,
it is the way of delight in magical display, not something separate.

Because there is no other and nothing not given,
there is no taking: all is the very expanse.
Phenomena are like illusions,
and what is designated by names and words is false;
practicing falsehood upon falsehood itself,
'false' is a mere designation and does not exist.
Attachment to what is free of attachment,
and, in attachment itself, no attachment:
that is the king of supreme pure conduct,
the very great attachment.
Do not abandon the unsurpassed; honor the master;
do not break the continuity of mantra and mudrā;
be loving toward those who have entered the genuine path;
for the sake of the secret meaning, do not speak of it.
These are the five roots,
the supreme samayas of practice and of guarding.
Delusion, desire, aversion,
pride and jealousy are not abandoned.
The white elixir, the red elixir, the scented substances and the great flesh
are not discarded, in a pure vessel.
These are the supreme samayas of the ten branches,
practiced with the understanding that all is primordially pure and equal.
The five samayas of guarding and practice
are the roots; breaking them, one becomes cut off from the family.
The five not to be abandoned and the five not to be discarded
are the branch samayas, hard to transgress.
If one abides in the samaya of equality,
joining equality with equality,
one will attain the great perfection of equality;
if one transgresses it, one is not a buddha.
With common people whose root samayas are damaged
and who make no effort to restore them,
do not converse even for an instant or a moment;
the faults of their damage cannot be told.
If the root samayas are damaged,
all practice is turned upside down,
and various unpleasant results

gather, though they are unwanted.
If the branch samayas are damaged,
there is no result, and one falls into the lower realms.
The samayas are the great vajra,
the very nature of all the buddhas.
Of the five root samayas,
each one is divided into two and three tens;
of the ten branch samayas,
each one is divided into two tens.
This samaya is most wondrous.
In the ten directions of the six worlds,
as many beings as there are in the three existences,
so many samayas unfold to tame their thoughts.
Moreover, by the mudrā of all without exception
of the supreme Victor Samantabhadra,
the sublime, without effortful practice, is accomplished without exception.
These and other infinite supreme ones,
holders of the supreme family of the Victors,
are honored by the lords of the world and their retinues.
By the supreme of the sublime and by the sublime ones
they are blessed, regarded as sons and brothers.
They abide in the very domain of the Sugata
and are joined with fearless Samantabhadra.
Suchness and the means of taming,
however many inconceivable vows there are,
are all completely pure and spontaneously accomplished;
if damaged, they are made complete by restoration;
these and other inconceivable supreme ones."

When this was spoken, the Tathāgatas themselves were tamed within the Tathāgatas themselves.

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, this is the fifty-first chapter, on Samaya.

Then, from the King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, the Tathāgata, in order to make it meaningful for the mantra holders, summarized the root of the three hundred samayas and spoke this inspired utterance for the sake of the mantra holders:

"In worlds as many as the dust motes of the ten directions,
there are unbearable misconceptions as many as atoms,
and the antidotes that tame thoughts are inconceivable.
The inconceivable disciplines and vows,
and all the many supreme vajra vehicles,
though they stir from the very nature and are without elaboration,
through the deluded thought of one's own awareness
there are inconceivable views, high and low;
to tame them, what suits each was taught.
The genuine and the misconceived, both,
are transformed in their essential nature,
and in that there is nothing to contrive or change.
If from the very beginning there is no essential nature,
there are no afflictions to abandon and no aim to achieve;
all without exception becomes of one taste.
Since the relative is like the moon in water,
it can become anything and accomplish anything.
For the yogin who realizes that suchness,
the ultimate is without arising or ceasing,
and the relative, an illusion, accomplishes anything."

So it is in the secret words of the vajra.

From the Net of Illusion, this is the fifty-second chapter, the concise explanation of the fifteen roots of the three hundred and sixty samayas.

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, entered into equipoise in the meditative absorption of the play of the vajra mind and spoke this inspired utterance:

"From the clear center of the sky
arise masses of wish-fulfilling clouds in many forms;
various things arise, and light radiates and blazes.
raṃ This is the fire that burns the three existences;
it blazes as the fire of the wisdom of mind.
haṃ In the clear maṇḍala of the senses,
the substances of the sense fields are gathered
and subside, vivid and radiant, into light.
a From the expanse of peace the mudrā blazes,
the blessing of compassion, most wondrous.
hūṃ Accomplishing the aims of the various beings,

this is declared to be supreme awakening.
ho It destroys the four and purifies the lower realms.
trāṃ ta As the alchemy of medicine purifies poison,
the outer and inner stains are purified;
they are made pure by the two selflessnesses.
hri Clear and pure."

By this all the abodes were made to quake and stir violently, and so their chiefs, together with their retinues and servants, came as though driven by the force of the wind. They were these: Yama, Lord of Life, Mahākāla, with his consort; the Great Black Māra with fiery breath; his consort, the black māra woman Dripping Blood; the king of the rākṣasas, Black Killer, with his consort; the great yakṣa Pūrṇabhadra; his consort, the yakṣiṇī Ekajaṭī, eater of flesh; the king of the gods, Maheśvara (Śiva); the lord of the rudras, Black Liberation; the great king Mujé Tsenpa; the lord of the outer gods, Black Kāla; great Viṣṇu, who roams everywhere; the lord of the nāgas, Fierce Youth; the great king of the gods, Lichin; the great yakṣa Hand Roamer; the great being, Vajra Beauty; the great nāga māra, Yamshü Marpo; and, besides these, inconceivable hosts of gods, nāgas, asuras, devourers, hungry ghosts, bhūtas, and terrifying messengers all gathered together.

Then the Blessed One, knowing that he would thoroughly tame that retinue of great malevolent ones, manifestly emanated the maṇḍala of the great charnel ground:

"The maṇḍalas of the expanse of space,
reflected as forms, are utterly terrifying.
Their sounds are harsh, violent and fierce;
their smells are foul, reeking of rot and decay;
their tastes are sour and burning;
their touch is hot and rough, yet does no harm.
The fire of great aversion blazes;
pride is a crag packed with skeletons;
the black darkness of delusion gathers thick;
desire roars as a great river of blood;
the wind of jealousy rages wildly.
Amid the revelry of the great sthira,
tigers, leopards, beasts of prey, jackals and wolves,
kaṅkas, vultures and flocks of birds,

piśācas and blood-drinkers crunch bones.
Bloated, rotting and decaying corpses,
scattered remains and wailing voices,
cries and roars ring out fiercely.
hūṃ he he phaṭ bhyo ru lu
Meditate on yourself as nondual
with the blazing face of the great maṇḍala
of the assembly of great wrathful ones.
Having recited each one's own mantra,
from all the sentient beings of the six classes,
all the wicked and malevolent ones
are summoned with jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥs;
three times or seven times dissolve them into the mouth;
even if it be a god, he will be destroyed.
hoḥ Moreover, the food offering
is offered with every kind of wealth:
human fat and pungent butter,
and the red argha is offered continuously.
a hoḥ Or else one should offer it three times, a hundred and eight times,
a thousand or a hundred thousand times.
With black thorns or poisonous wood,
or other substances for burning, the three harmful ones,
one should perform every rite of suppression."

From the Net of Illusion, the general teaching of the maṇḍala of the play of compassion, hoṃḥ oṃ hūṃ hrāṃ hrīḥ āḥ. From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, hauṃḥ, this is the fifty-fourth chapter, in which all without exception are gathered here.

Then the Tathāgata, the king of the wrathful ones, meditating as the assembly of fierce wrathful ones from the teaching of the Net of Illusion, spoke this inspired utterance:

"The essence of supreme awakening
is not something sought through signs;
but through the three purities, without error,
and by familiarity with the king, self-awareness,
this supreme awakening will be found.
To accomplish the violent and fierce,

the liṅga is placed in the bhaga,
and the effigy should be made together with the name.
Whichever wrathful face it may be,
meditate on it constantly, three times or seven times,
and the face that becomes manifest blazes.
Having become yourself the deity of the maṇḍala,
gather the liṅga again and again
and dissolve it into the center of the expanse.
Gather it with hūṃ and cast it with phaṭ.
With the mouth, recite your own mantra
ten thousand or a hundred thousand times in the threefold manner,
and feed it again and again.
All the sentient beings of the five destinies
will dissolve helplessly into the mouth.
Yama too is especially splendid.
Body colors like conch and the rest,
fangs bared and wrathful brows knit,
mouths gaping and blazing mudrās:
these and the rest should be meditated upon.
This is the mudrā of holding oneself.
Having taken the effigy, for the purpose of one's own mantra,
where it can be plainly seen with the senses,
gather the pills and offer them into the expanse;
it is certain to be accomplished without doubt.
Because the hero has need
of the wicked who destroy the sacred Dharma,
do that which benefits all!
hoḥ hūṃ jaḥdaṅ and phaṭ and transference and the rest
he declared to be supreme for guiding them.
The effigy gathered into the name, too,
just as before,
should be set on the path of awakening through aspiration;
make it free of the habitual tendencies of signs.
Emanate it from the expanse and dissolve it into a.
a ho
In the mind itself, the mind is spoken."

From the Net of Illusion, this is the fifty-fifth chapter, the close teaching of the extremely secret wrathful ones.

Then the Tathāgata, the king of the wrathful ones, gathered all activities into the vajra and spoke this inspired utterance:

"Meditating in the manner of the three purities,
abiding in the teaching of the Net of Illusion,
gather everything into hūṃ
and meditate on a blazing triangular maṇḍala.
In the great mass of blazing fire,
summon the fire god with agne jaḥs,
kindle the fire called raṃ,
and meditate on the entire wrathful maṇḍala, without exception,
as vajra aversion.
hūṃ The great assembly of the fierce ones blazes intensely,
the color of black smoke,
churning with many blazing rays,
adorned with many suns, skulls and snakes,
lions, elephants and ferocious tigers,
and holding various blazing implements.
The sounds of phaṭ, hūṃ and ha la,
fierce cries, churn the sky in the ten directions.
phaṭ They are surrounded by hosts of wrathful gods and goddesses,
beautified by the mudrās of the lands and sacred places.
ha he They are surrounded by hosts of attendants, maidservants and slave women,
bhyo and of kiṃkaras and the rest,
with their own seats and implements,
proclaiming ferocious roars and their own mantras.
Meditate on them as having ugly, fierce forms
and as extremely wrathful.
Yourself in the very state of phaṭ,
meditate always with clarity, intimacy and a trained mind.
Having gathered with jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥs,
gather all the sentient beings of the six classes
and offer them to the wrathful assembly;
even if it be a god, he will be destroyed.
The other requisites accord with the general rite;

the means of torment, too, are as above;
the number of offerings also accords with the general rite.
āḥ Moreover, of the inconceivable maṇḍala,
hūṃ meditate on wrathful faces, mouths gaping and eyes glaring,
brandishing vajra bolts,
surrounded by skull cups and hooks,
blazing with the assembly of the six sounds of hūṃ.
Having summoned them with the mudrā of seizing,
if they are dissolved into the mouth, it is accomplished all the more;
not even a particle of dust is left.
The assembly of the retinue, too, is as before;
in the manner of fulfillment, send off the dispatch offering.
hūṃ The fierce red one with long lips,
surrounded by a garland of blazing vajras,
with great light blazing and radiating,
crushes the world realms all at once.
hūṃ The wrathful assembly fully recites
the mantras, and the mudrās of the sacred places and lands,
and the hosts of attendants, maidservants and slave women
recite their own mantras in full.
ha he bhyo Moreover, with these words of praise:
hūṃ By the blessing of vajra compassion
all the world realms are filled,
and all the fierce disturbers, without exception,
are subdued by the power of the vajra.
hūṃ Vajra aversion with its retinue
destroys all the infinite world realms
in an instant, in a moment;
there is nothing at all that is not destroyed."

From the Net of Illusion, this is the fifty-sixth chapter, on the fierce homa.

Then the Tathāgata, the king of the wrathful ones called Lotus Gatherer, for the sake of many beings, spoke this inspired utterance:

"Through the union of wisdom and skillful means,
all without exception are gathered into the expanse;
from the expanse the light of primordial wisdom radiates and blazes,
and all without exception are joined in the expanse.

hrīḥ From an outspread crescent maṇḍala
many rays of light blaze intensely,
and it is encircled by bound vajra chains.
Furthermore, all the most sublime of ornaments
adorn and encircle it.
Inviting the fire god as before,
meditate on the entire wrathful maṇḍala, without exception,
as the wrathful ones of the lotus family,
with the color of fierce crimson,
and with many further emanations
encircling the four directions, the four intermediate directions, above and below,
fiercely proclaiming their own ferocious mantras.
hrīḥ Yourself being the vajra of nonattachment,
having meditated clearly on the maṇḍala above,
all the beings of the ten directions
and all the malevolent-minded, without exception,
summoned with jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥ and spho ṭa,
should be offered to the maṇḍala.
The intention is accomplished and the lower realms are purified.
hrīḥ Meditate on the hosts of many celestial palaces and maṇḍalas,
the maṇḍala shaped like the face of a lotus,
with lotus trees at its edge,
and blazing with the light of lotuses and vajras.
Furthermore, adorn every maṇḍala beautifully
with lovely supreme ornaments.
Having become yourself the lotus deity,
if you constantly make offerings
of various divine substances,
the finest food and drink,
red wood and sweet fragrances,
in the numbers of times mentioned above,
whatever action you desire,
of this world or beyond it, will be accomplished.
The mantra is the syllables raṃ and hrīḥ;
the color is crimson, of great radiance;
pervading the ten directions, it is gathered into hrī.

Offer with songs and dances of delight.
hrīḥ By the blazing vajra lotus,
the glory, splendor, life and the rest
of all the endless, infinite ten directions
are gathered into that blazing lotus,
equal to the body of the buddhas;
and further, the supreme enjoyments and the rest,
all the actions one desires, come under one's power;
what need is there to speak of gods, rākṣasas and the rest?
hrīḥ Vajra desire with its retinue
brings all the infinite world realms
under its power in an instant, in a moment;
there is nothing at all that does not come under its power.
hrīḥ"

From the Net of Illusion, having brought all without exception under power, this is the fifty-seventh chapter, on the homa of subjugation.

Then the Tathāgata, the king of the wrathful ones called Radiating, drew these maṇḍalas forth from his own expanse and spoke this inspired utterance:

"The maṇḍala of great bliss blazes,
churning with many radiating rays of light.
Meditate on it as blazing supremely as the field of merit
and filling the sky of the ten directions.
It is encircled by vajra jewels;
the qualities of the Victors are equal to space.
trāṃ In the four directions and the center, the light of primordial wisdom blazes;
the maṇḍala is encircled by jeweled nooses.
Furthermore, various mudrās,
and all the wrathful ones as well, radiate joy;
great white light blazes,
and the various mudrās transform into anything at all.
It is encircled by gods and goddesses.
With various requisites of offering,
white and fragrant woods,
and all the other offerings,
make abundant offerings to the maṇḍala.

Having yourself blazed intensely as the jewel,
trāṃ the white syllable blazes as light.
All the wrathful ones are likewise.
In the maṇḍala that has become manifest,
with pā śa hoḥ and jaḥ hūṃ
summon all of the five paths in the ten directions,
and meditate on light radiating as they dissolve into the expanse.
All is equal to the buddha fields;
it does not exist from anywhere else:
it is the stable primordial wisdom of illusion.
Furthermore, in the inconceivable maṇḍalas,
the vajra blazes in the expanse of jewels,
and the maṇḍala is encircled all around with ornaments.
Furthermore, gods and goddesses
make offerings pervading the ten directions.
The qualities are equal to the fields of the Victors.
trāṃ Make offerings with songs and dances.
Having made abundant offerings filling the ten directions,
all the buddha fields without exception,
with jeweled offerings that increase glory,
one revels abundantly in the vajra expanse.
hoḥ trāṃ Vajra pride with its retinue
makes all the infinite world realms
increase in an instant, in a moment;
there is nothing at all that has not increased."

From the Net of Illusion, this is the fifty-eighth chapter, on the homa of increase by the King Who Increases.

Then the Tathāgata Vairocana, the great wrathful one, transformed all the maṇḍalas into a great blaze and spoke this inspired utterance:

"The maṇḍala of primordial wisdom has no center and no edge;
it is inconceivable and spontaneously present.
All the maṇḍalas of the Victors without exception
arise without clinging in the Sugata himself.
oṃ From a circular, blazing maṇḍala
encircled all around by blazing wheels,
light blazes intensely in yellow.

The wondrous body and the rest
should be meditated upon by the great being;
all the maṇḍalas will be accomplished.
The seed syllable is a yellow oṃ.
Inviting the fire god as before,
all the wrathful maṇḍalas without exception
are the vajra of delusion,
radiating various rays of light,
with blazing wheels and mudrās,
adorned by hosts of gods and goddesses.
Seats, abodes and the expanse itself:
in those maṇḍalas of the Victors,
in those that abide in the ten directions,
having summoned with the cakra and the hook,
and dissolved them into the expanse of the maṇḍala,
the fierce, the turbulent, the malevolent and the wicked
become peaceful, vivid and radiant.
oṃ Furthermore, in the inconceivable maṇḍalas,
of the maṇḍala of blazing wheels,
encircled by oṃ and by lions' heads,
all the vajra mudrās that adorn it
should be encircled by the peaceful ones of the age of perfection.
The king with a beautiful body, the blazing wheel,
the ornaments peaceful and white,
and supreme awakening blazing, are meditated on as vivid.
They move through the sky and float through the air.
Furthermore, all six classes of beings without exception
will become peaceful; of this there is no doubt.
Having made offerings with dance and song,
all the malevolent ones of the ten directions without exception
will completely cast off their malevolent minds
and turn into the light of the white deity.
Blissful awakening radiates and blazes with light.
Vajra delusion with its retinue
pacifies all the infinite world realms
in an instant, in a moment;
there is nothing at all that has not been pacified."

From the Net of Illusion, all without exception having been pacified, this is the fifty-ninth chapter, on the homa of pacification.

Then the Tathāgata, the Blessed One, Great Delight, entered into equipoise in the meditative absorption called the Blessing of the Spontaneously Present Samaya and spoke this inspired utterance:

"To the supreme maṇḍala of the assembly of e,
blazing, greatly fierce and ferocious,
make the offering with a wrathful mind;
even the merit body of the buddhas is destroyed.
On the five nectars or the five foods,
make the effigy together with the name.
Having summoned it, strike it with the vajra kīla;
having reduced it to dust, offer it to the assembly.
In the maṇḍala of the assembly of e,
when they are linked and bound in a chain,
they are bound; if it is moved, the ten directions shake;
intoxicated, they may even be burned.
To the supreme maṇḍala of the assembly of vaṃ,
the great mountain of blazing splendor,
make the offering with a mind of passion;
even vajra speech comes under one's power.
On the five nectars or the five foods,
make the effigy together with the name.
Strike it with the kīla of vajra passion,
and offer it, dissolving it into the assembly of passion.
In the maṇḍala of the assembly of vaṃ,
when they are linked and bound in a chain,
they are summoned, and whatever it is follows behind;
whatever one desires will come accordingly.
To the supreme maṇḍala of the assembly of ma,
of great splendor, blazing, gathering and radiating,
make the offering with a joyful mind;
its qualities are equal to the bounds of space.
On the five nectars or the five foods,
visualize the qualities as a wish-fulfilling treasure.
Strike with the kīla of pride radiating joy,
and offer it so that vajra splendor increases.

In the maṇḍala of the assembly of ma,
when they are linked and bound in a chain,
a great magical display of blazing splendor unfolds,
and the wish-fulfilling filling the sky comes about.
To the supreme maṇḍala of the assembly of ya,
shining with clear splendor,
make the offering with a clear mind;
even the greatly fierce and ferocious become calm.
On the five nectars or the five foods,
visualize the nature of the fierce, ferocious and turbulent.
Strike with the kīla of calm clarity,
and offer it to the assembly of blazing calm.
In the maṇḍala of the assembly of ya,
when they are linked and bound in a chain,
they are blessed as blazing calm,
and everything becomes unmoving.
To the hosts of attendants, maidservants and slave women,
give the remainder offering they desire.
Having loudly proclaimed their samaya,
meditate that they perform whatever action is desired.
In former times the great glorious Heruka,
who tamed all without exception,
those extremely malevolent and of fierce disposition,
had wondrous power and blessing.
Having brought the Great God (Śiva) and the rest under his power,
he made the retinue of Īśvara his attendants,
and appointed each to its own tasks.
As they have promised and vowed,
bring these about without obstruction and swiftly.
If you do not act as you vowed,
as you yourselves swore an oath,
do not transgress that commitment.
If you transgress that samaya,
your heads, bodies and hearts too will be cut
into seven pieces by the wrathful yakṣa.
Therefore, do as you are charged
by the yogin mantra holder.

If you do not bring about that action,
then, just as you yourselves swore and promised,
you will rot, decay and burn, and go to hell.
Fully perform the actions
of the yogin who abides by the samaya,
and protect his retinue as an only child.
The sorceresses, too, will obtain accomplishment.
Bring about the actions you are charged with!"

Thus he commanded. This is the principal action for accomplishing the wrathful ones.

"Through the great dances and songs
of the great Heruka and the rest,
everything at all is done.
Through the great dances and songs
of the great Treasure Holder and the rest,
if gathering is wanted, they gather;
if increase is wanted, they increase.
Through the great dances and songs
of the great Swollen One and the rest,
if calm is wanted, they dissolve;
if stupor is wanted, they intoxicate.
Through the great dances and songs
of the great Lion-Faced One and the rest,
everything is devoured entirely;
not even a particle of dust is left.
Through the great dances and songs
of the great Laughing-Faced One and the rest,
everything is devoured entirely,
and all are utterly ruined.
Through the great dances and songs
of the attendants, maidservants and slave women,
things are dispatched and sent off:
everything at all is done.
In trees, thickets of saplings,
a lone tree, or a place touched by fire,
with clarity, joy, passion

and wrath, perform the kali intensely."

When this was spoken, the Tathāgatas themselves were purified within the Tathāgatas themselves.

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, this is the sixtieth chapter, called the Blessing of Spontaneously Present Enlightened Activity.

Then, from the King of Tantras of the Tathāgatas, the Net of Illusion, it was taught that all phenomena are gathered into mind and phenomena; that all wisdom is gathered into the four mothers, and the four mothers too are gathered into one; and that all skillful means are gathered into the four families, and the four families too are gathered into one. Having taught that everything is gathered into the expanse and the primordial wisdom of the expanse, he summarized the meaning of the words from beginning to end and spoke again as follows. This is the supreme root of the meaning:

"All without exception, with nothing left out,
is unapprehended and unattached: the nature of reality.
Likewise the expanse itself appears as many and various skillful means;
skillful means itself is an illusion, a mirage, the moon in water, a reflection.
That itself is self-aware primordial wisdom, appearing variously without attachment.
Because, endowed with skillful means and wisdom, one has arrived at the supreme state,
however one acts, it is inexhaustible, nondual, and does not become an obscuration.
It is primordially the play of the supreme, of wisdom and great skillful means.
That itself is the various mudrās, the emanations, self-awareness.
Because cause and result are primordially inseparable, neither earlier nor later,
the result becomes the path, and they are joined equally at a single time.
This is the source from which all wish-fulfilling jewels arise,
the treasure in which all is gathered, the wish-fulfilling treasury,
free of duality, the very expanse of all, equal and unequal.
I and no-self, the various signs, are inseparable;
empty and not empty, not abiding, are gathered in suchness.
The self-arisen vajra maṇḍala sends forth inexhaustible maṇḍalas.
The maṇḍalas of the passed beyond and the not passed beyond, inconceivable

and spontaneously present,
endowed with the inexhaustible, perfect the six wheels of ornament;
the supreme garland of self-arisen luminosity of the unborn expanse,
primordially uncontrived and unmade, is clear in the state of self-awareness.
All arising and entering is gathered in the state of the great treasure of self-awareness.
The ten directions without exception, with nothing left out, all gathered together,
and all the inconceivable celestial palaces of the realms, supreme great jewels,
are rightly enclosed in the two, the unborn expanse and one's own awareness.
Aspirational conduct, emptiness, cause and result, are purified again and again, unapprehended.
The abode of the Jewel, primordial luminosity, without attachment and unattached:
mere names, the supreme play, perfected by supreme skillful means and wisdom.
On the very steps of the path, the ten perfections are completed and cause and result are practiced.
Truly endowed with the vajra of equality, the great skillful means,
it is spoken of as without going, without coming, not abiding, all-pervading and without pervasion.
a ho"

From the King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, this is the sixty-first chapter, teaching that the perfections, the twelve grounds, the supreme through skillful means, and all the buddha fields without exception are gathered into mind and phenomena.

Then the Tathāgata, abiding in equipoise in the maṇḍala of the five primordial wisdoms, spoke this inspired utterance:

"All the five aggregates and the limbs as well
are awakening, abiding as the five syllables.
Linked as oṃ and mūṃ,
they arise from the very vajra of awakening.
In general, all that is expressed,
all of it, is mere name, the letter a.
Arising and perishing themselves are the five letters.
That is the mind of awakening,

from which unapprehending supreme awakening arises.
Three dawning, five blazing, ten in abundance:
it is the inexhaustible treasure of jewels,
endowed with the six higher perceptions and adorned with the excellent marks.
Radiating from e and gathering into a,
it is the very expanse of the secret bindu.
Clouds arise from the expanse of the sky,
pervading all, a variety of clouds.
From within the forty-five, inconceivable,
the blessing is marvelous and most wondrous;
it has become a treasure of inexhaustible qualities.
ho Primordially, equality is the expanse of the secret maṇḍala;
not other than the expanse, it is primordially the state of the bindu.
The expanse of primordial wisdom itself is in the manner of a reflection, an illusion;
in the very act of appearing, it abides without agent or action.
The meaning of the forty-five great magical displays of primordial wisdom,
the inconceivable, spontaneously present, sublime maṇḍalas,
abides in equality, skillful means and wisdom being nondual.
Meditating with realization of the meaning of the three kinds of purity and equality,
it is the supreme state, the realization of the meaning through the four kinds of equality.
Cause and result, spontaneously present, are gathered into the four perfections.
The five primordial wisdoms, complete, are gathered in body, speech and mind.
From the peaceful path without attachment, one enters the bindu.
The five primordial wisdoms, complete, do not pass beyond their sphere of activity,
and are fully endowed with the unattached maṇḍala of luminosity.
By the king, self-awareness, all without exception
in the pure and equal maṇḍala are joined as wrathful gods and goddesses.
Phenomena are empty by their own nature.
The various conceptual thoughts that grasp
the inner and the outer of the inner

are the momentary expanse without entities.
That itself is the path of complete purity.
The inverted itself is the genuine;
ignorance is clear primordial wisdom;
affliction and suffering are supreme awakening;
all is the abode of the supreme qualities.
a ho All the maṇḍalas of the Victors of the ten directions without exception,
unraveling the definitive meaning, are gathered into the forty-five.
Their condensed meaning is gathered into five letters;
the meaning of the five is gathered within three letters;
those three are gathered into the letter a,
and a itself, unborn, dissolves into the expanse of perfect equality.
a ho Unapprehended emptiness cannot be expressed;
the unapprehended Tathāgatas, too, are inconceivable;
the supreme unborn expanse, too, is inconceivable;
the unceasing mind of awakening is without arising or perishing.
The blessing of compassion,
without going, without coming, not abiding, radiates."

Thus he spoke to himself.

"From the expanse the expanse arises, clear as the mudrā of skillful means;
from skillful means the expanse arises, clear as the mudrā of the mother.
Because primordial wisdom is abundant in the expanse through the expanse,
the maṇḍalas of the assemblies of the mind of awakening cannot be expressed."

This is the sixty-second chapter, on the dissolution of all the definitive meaning of the maṇḍala of the Tathāgatas, without exception, into the mudrā without characteristics.

Then the Tathāgata, having emanated as the King Amitāyus, spoke this inspired utterance:

Condensing the teaching of the Net of Illusion:
In the maṇḍala of bhruṃ and viśva,
upon the maṇḍala of ma and a,
having thoroughly meditated on the vajra wheel,
meditate on the meaning of the forty-five,
and meditate that by it the ten directions are filled.

Summon with bhruṃ and jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ;
the supreme essence of body, speech, and mind
should be dissolved into body, speech, and mind.
Take the nṛ itself either as actual or as mentally imagined.
The supreme vase, the excellent one,
is this very place where life is deposited.
Summon it again and again,
and when it has directly ripened,
conceal it once more within the expanse.
With the protection of the vajra armor
make it stable, and ward off with the wheel.
Dissolve it into the essence of five syllables.
All the buddhas, entirely without exception,
meditate on as King Amitāyus:
his body colored like a gleaming snow mountain,
adorned with various garlands of ornaments,
with a garland of wish-fulfilling jewels,
a casket of wish-fulfilling jewels,
jeweled ornaments and an excellent vase,
and other things that accomplish the benefit of beings,
inconceivable, limitless, and supreme.
If the obstructors will not give up the nṛ,
Amitāyus and the wrathful ones,
filling the realm of space in the ten directions,
uttering fierce sounds and cries,
should subdue them all without exception.
Confer Amitāyus as the empowerment.
Through the life approach and close approach,
the life accomplishment and great accomplishment,
through the richness of skillful means and wisdom,
whatever actions one wishes are accomplished.
The goddess of life empowerment is she who increases continuity,
white in color, blazing with radiating light;
her hand full of jewels,
she transforms her various mudrās into whatever is needed.
To all the six classes of beings without exception
who dwell in the ten directions of the six worlds,

she grants this beneficial life empowerment.
There is no increaser of continuity beyond this.
This great magical display, the recitation of syllables,
should be done without error in the threefold manner;
do not interrupt the rite of mantra recitation;
perform it with supreme familiarity, clarity, and stability.
oṃ oṃ oṃ oṃ oṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ svāṃ svāṃ svāṃ svāṃ svāṃ āṃḥ āṃḥ āṃḥ āṃḥ āṃḥ hāṃ hāṃ hāṃ hāṃ hāṃ brūṃ brūṃ brūṃ brūṃ brūṃ bā bā bā bā bā jra jra jra jra jra ā ā ā ā ā yu yu yu yu yu śṣe śṣe śṣe śṣe śṣe hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ a a a a a o
If the lives have not come under control,
then the Sugatas too, as Amitāyus,
with forms of body, speech, and mind
fill the realm of space in the ten directions,
and with mudrās and various weapons
conquer the māras of the worlds in the ten directions,
and bring the lives of the five classes of beings under control.
With the plow mudrā and the like,
having stirred up the realms of the worlds below,
summon life back from the abode of Yama
and dissolve it into the five essences.
With the mudrā of the great wheel,
having stirred up the realms of the worlds above,
from Īśvara, the Great God (Śiva), and the others,
and from the obstructors moving through the intermediate space,
forcefully summon the life of the nṛ.
Having dissolved it into the syllables of the wheel,
then those five syllables
should be dissolved into the five places of the nṛ.
oṃ oṃ vajra kapaca vajra rakṣa hūṃ oṃ sarva tathāgata vajra adhitiṣṭha vajra svāhā
This is the rite of protection by mudrā.
The five syllables are a single syllable;
the single syllable, beyond objectification, dissolves into the expanse.
oṃ
The wish-fulfilling vase, a precious jewel,
adorned with ornaments and garlands of jewels,

with the five precious substances and the five medicines,
the five grains, the five incenses, and the five white mustard seeds:
the mantra practitioner, very steadfast and intelligent,
should recite and meditate on the mantra without impairing any of its limbs.
When it has been furnished with the five ornaments,
all the maṇḍalas will be accomplished.
Then that son of noble family,
having furnished all the requisites without exception,
pleasing and honoring with various kinds of offering water,
will obtain the accomplishments.

This is the sixty-third chapter, the supremely secret chapter on the sublime empowerment, the rite of life from the Net of Illusion.

Then the Tathāgata Vajra Gatherer, having again condensed it into what is called "Speaking So That the Five Classes of Beings Are Powerless," spoke this inspired utterance:

"The expanse of the secret maṇḍala itself,
within the state of Samantabhadra's compassion,
endowed with body, speech, and mind and perfect in qualities,
should be joined in the field of equality.
Through the vajra, utterly secret,
the vajra thoroughly joined,
meditate that it arises as oṃ and mūṃ;
meditate that all dissolves into the expanse.
In the sublime secret maṇḍala
and in those drops and mantra,
the excellent lines of nṛ, ash, and manta,
with excellent porticoes and enclosing gateways,
single-pointed vajras blazing with light,
and the sublime hook of summoning:
draw single-pointed and three-pointed vajras.
Furnish the maṇḍala with its materials,
and present various offering waters as offerings.
yaṃ
Light radiates from smoke-colored wisdom.
From a, upon a moon maṇḍala,
from jaḥ come countless hooks;

by them make it enter the heart.
From ma, upon a sun maṇḍala,
from jaḥ come many hooks;
from the heart of whoever is summoned
draw it out and place it in his mouth.
From ma, upon a sun maṇḍala,
from jaḥ come many hooks;
from the heart of whoever is summoned
draw it out and place it in his mouth.
This mantra should be fully recited:
oṃ jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ ho a nṛ pra du, then the name, pra veśa.
Recite it for whatever action is desired.
Interlace the fingers of both hands,
hold them tightly clenched as a fist,
and with the ring fingers, the little fingers, and the two thumbs,
draw the thumbs out in between.
oṃ, the name, pra veśa ā ā.
Strike forcefully with ash and white mustard seed,
and make that name enter within.
When it has descended, bind it with the noose of the vajra chain.
Ask, "What are you?"
Whatever it is, a god, a spirit, or the like:
if it is a god, make offerings to it;
if it is a graha, mix sandalwood and saffron,
give it that to drink, and fully recite this mantra:
oṃ vajra dhaka krodha samaya hūṃ phaṭ
If it will not speak,
interlace the fingers of both hands outward,
clench them as fists, and join the little fingers;
raise them upright and touch them to the mouth of the one into whom it has descended.
By reciting the mantra oṃ vajra bhāṣa vije pra veśa hūṃ hūṃ many times,
think that wisdom, unobstructed and free of obscuration,
enters into those words of truth.
At the tip of the tongue is a white a;
upon it a moon maṇḍala;
if one meditates on a red oṃ jaḥ dhīḥ there,

it will speak without doubt.
Meditating on oneself as ṭākki hūṃ,
whatever beings of the five paths there may be,
such as those of a and nṛ,
recite oṃ ṭākki hūṃ together with their own mantras
a hundred thousand times, and summon them.
Recite with pra veśa as well.
Further, with jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥste:
the support for placing and bringing it down
is a child twelve years old;
bring it down into one or into five.
A drop, a vase, a blazing mirror,
and all the other supports as well:
the rite of making it speak is complete.
With the vajra-claw mudrā
summon with all the summoning mudrās.
jaḥ hūṃ
Gather Īśvara, the Great God (Śiva), and the others,
and entrust them with tasks in the same way.
If they will not comply with ṭākki hūṃ jaḥs,
then with Hayagrīva, pressing down their abode and their land,
their borders, head and tail,
recite fiercely and summon with the hook.
Without mistaking the life-essence,
torment them and draw them forcefully.
Whatever means of summoning there may be,
transcendent or worldly,
summon without hesitation.
When the various tasks are completed,
into the five vases prepared before
put the five medicines, the five grains, the five precious substances,
the mother of the family, and Amṛtakuṇḍalin,
all the actions one wishes,
and whatever else is needed.
oṃ vajra amṛta a a a oṃ mahā vajra amṛte phaṭ
One also says ja gad ja gad ca.
Recite oṃ buddha locani svāhā.

In that sublime secret maṇḍala,
speak to the very perfection of the five wisdoms:
"Essence of wisdom, listen!
Again and again, vividly,
meditate always with supreme awakening."
The accomplishment of doing so is this:
transcendent and worldly
accomplishments are obtained through intelligible speech."

Thus it is, in vajra secret words. For the sake of beings it was uttered once again.

This is the sixty-fourth chapter, on bringing down the pra.

Then the glorious Śrī Heruka, having entered into nondual union with the consort Krodhīśvarī, emanated many maṇḍalas of wrathful ones from the vajra of the mind of awakening. He brought under his control, entirely without exception, the great worldly sovereign goddesses, the lords, the kings, the kings of kings, the ministers, the generals, inconceivable hundreds of thousands of retinues, and all the rest. As for the great terrifying goddesses, both now and in the time to come, he appointed some to the activity of increasing life; he appointed some to increase wealth; he appointed some to travel unobstructed through the great elements; he appointed some to travel with their forms invisible; he appointed some to transform into any of various forms; he appointed some to bring the hostile side under control; he appointed some to bring decline and bewilderment; he appointed some to wither and cast out. Having appointed them to whatever other various tasks were desired, he spoke this inspired utterance:

"Through the vajra that knows equality,
the supreme lords of the world are brought under control.
Through the blessing of great compassion,
the various aims of beings are shown.
Because one is endowed with skillful means and wisdom,
it is accomplished just as it is focused upon.
This is the self-arisen god of gods,
who sports endowed with love and compassion.
Through great compassion and skill in means,
though he engages with each and every one,

habitual tendencies do not accumulate,
and the accumulations of merit and wisdom are perfected.
Apart from the conduct of skillful means,
there is not even an atom of deluded thought of apprehended and apprehender.
Because he is inseparable from suchness,
he abides always in the luminosity of intrinsic nature."

Then one should meditate on oneself, as in the meaning of the tantra set out above, as whichever of those wrathful and peaceful deities one is accustomed to. When the samādhi has become workable and the deity has become clear, one performs the recitation of one's own deity, hundreds of thousands of times.

To summon the Great God (Śiva): the hook, the noose, spho ṭa vaṃ. mahā devā hūṃ jaḥ jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥ.
From the heart-place of the lord of gods
draw him forth again and again.
mama trag śa mahā deva gṛhṇa gṛhṇa hūṃ hūṃ
The god's bodily color is gleaming white;
his body is adorned with every jewel;
on his crown a wish-fulfilling jewel blazes;
and what he holds in his right hand
is a vase of the water of wish-fulfilling jewels.
His qualities, the five kinds of precious things,
fulfill the hopes of all the gods.
Dwelling with the queen Utmata,
he is always endowed with the five sense pleasures.
Oneself as Vairocana, and the celestial palace;
the form of the god in the manner described before.
Recite the god's seed syllable a hundred thousand times,
so that it is endowed with life.
From in front, draw him with jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥs;
from behind, the vajra holder pushes him.
Closer and closer, until there is no duality,
and when the Great God has become clear,
set him to do whatever action is desired.
The Great God and his whole retinue

will gather, accomplished and brought under control,
and will perform whatever actions are desired.

Then he spoke this rite for accomplishing the Four Great Kings.

Through the samādhi of the supreme mind of awakening,
all the four directions without exception,
for the accomplishment of the holder of vidyā-mantras,
and the Four Great Kings too are brought under control.
Meditate on oneself as the Heruka of the four families,
just as was set out above.
With the deity itself always clear,
meditate clearly on the form of the deity.
Oneself nondual with the deity,
meditate clearly in the true sense.
Then King Dhṛtarāṣṭra:
his form like a snow mountain at sunrise,
endowed with a hundred sacrifices and rays of light;
in his right hand a vajra trident,
in his left he holds a vase of nectar.
in tra sā ya svā hā jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥ tra mi ta hūṃ hūṃ su ra ta baghra jāḥ jā jā hūṃ hūṃ
Having recited this a hundred thousand times, oneself as Vajra Heruka,
with those mudrās of drawing in,
draw him from the heart of the lord of gods;
from behind, the vajra holder pushes him.
When he has come under one's power as lord of gods,
set him to do whatever action is desired.
He accomplishes each and every thing;
he gives forth to all and devours all.
All the retinues of the god without exception
truly gather,
and all follow like servants.
To accomplish King Virūḍhaka:
oneself as Ratna Heruka,
with body color as it occurs in the tantra,
and the mudrās likewise.
Through the blessing of light radiating and gathering,

Virūḍhaka is brought under control.
dhṛ ta dhṛ ta svā hā jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥ gṛhṇa gṛhṇa du rthid svā hā haṃ haṃ haṃ ratna jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥ
Having recited this essence a hundred thousand times,
practice the samādhi so that it is endowed with life.
Oneself as Ratna Heruka,
from Virūḍhaka's heart-place,
seizing him firmly with jaḥ,
one should summon him before oneself;
from behind, the vajra holder pushes him.
Then, when he has become directly present,
set him to do whatever action is desired.
His color blazes as the color of gold.
Gather all his retinues to oneself,
and the palace of wish-fulfilling jewels is accomplished.
To accomplish King Virūpākṣa:
oneself as Padma Heruka,
with body color as before,
and the manner of the mudrās likewise.
Having clearly recited the essence a hundred thousand times,
when the samādhi and the mudrā can be transformed,
and one has become clear as the deity:
that king's bodily color
is deep red and gleaming;
in his right hand he holds a vase of nectar,
in his left, in the manner of the five nectars;
he fulfills the hopes of the nāgas of the west,
and has a hood of nine snake heads.
To bring him fully under control:
bi rū ḍha ka svā hā jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥ nā ga śi ni bi ya phag śa phag jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥ
Having recited this many hundreds of thousands of times,
bring him under one's own control.
Having meditated clearly on oneself as the deity,
from Virūpākṣa's heart-place,
seize him firmly with ja and draw him;
from behind, the vajra holder pushes him.

Then, when he has become nondual with oneself,
inseparable,
set him to do whatever action is desired.
Virūpākṣa's retinues without exception
accomplish the actions of control.
To accomplish King Vaiśravaṇa:
oneself as the wrathful Amṛtakuṇḍalin,
with body color and hand emblems as before;
meditate thoroughly, clear and radiating light,
and recite the essence of one's own mantra a hundred thousand times.
When the samādhi can be transformed,
Vaiśravaṇa is thoroughly accomplished.
His form is the jewel beryl,
or else his color is blue and gleaming;
in his right hand he holds a jeweled staff,
in his left a vase of sense pleasures;
his head is beautified with various jewels.
bai śraṅ ṇa ye svā hā jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥ ku ber kaṅ kaṅ yaṅ yaṅ jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ hoḥ
Recite this a hundred thousand times, and so that it has life,
recite it again and again.
Oneself as Amṛta Heruka,
draw him with ja from Vaiśravaṇa's heart,
and bring him fully under control;
from behind, the vajra holder pushes him.
The wish-fulfilling jewel comes under one's control;
the yakṣa retinues are gathered like servants;
jewels are sent forth and the actions are accomplished;
he will perform whatever actions are desired.

This is the sixty-fifth chapter, from the Net of Illusion, on accomplishing the Great God and on arranging the maṇḍala of the Four Great Kings and accomplishing them.

Then the Blessed One, Great Delight, sang this song to the maṇḍala of the assembly in a most fearsome melody:

hūṃ Great fierce one, blazing like the fire at the end of time,
with the splendor of the rays of a hundred thousand suns,

a wrathful frown like a thousand flashes of lightning,
fangs bared, great devourer, ho!
hūṃ A fearsome roar that resounds like a thousand thunders,
a crash like a hundred thousand Mount Merus toppling,
the great prolonged laughter, a a ha la,
the great whirling of the scattering wind of the staff, ho!
hūṃ Wrathful wisdom, great light,
the wisdom maṇḍala clear everywhere,
blazing wisdom that conquers everywhere,
great drop of manifold wisdom, ho!
hūṃ King of wrath, great cloud,
wrathful maṇḍala that sends down a great rain,
treasure from which the maṇḍala arises as wished,
great drop of manifold wrath, ho!
hūṃ Great māra of all māras,
māra of māras, conqueror of māras,
terrifier even of the hosts of terror,
great terrifier, great drop, ho!
hūṃ Great vajra rock, the firm one,
vajra river, the gatherer,
vajra fire, great all-blazing one,
vajra wind, great scattering wind, ho!

Thus he sang it out.

This is the sixty-sixth chapter, on pleasing, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then the Blessed One, Great Delight, to the Tathāgata himself, the king of secret mantra.

Then the Tathāgata, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, spoke this inspired utterance in order to teach the meaning of oneself and Vajrasattva gathering inseparably, again and again, into the authentic expanse, and of oneself seeing the face of Vajrasattva directly:

"Seeing the face as relative illusion:
all is in the manner of a mirage and an illusion.
All that appears and exists, without exception,
is known to be alike, in the manner of the moon in water,

without duality of object and thought.
Whoever knows it thus,
the expanse without ground or root, the momentary,
the expanse without before or after, suchness,
is the vajra that nothing can harm.
Vajrasattva abides in that.
Through conduct in harmony with the deity, that is seeing the face.
The authentic maṇḍala of intrinsic nature
is pure, joined in equality,
the dharmadhātu inseparable from oneself.
All is spontaneously present as awakening.
Whoever realizes it in this way
is one who has the two wisdoms,
and by that he sees the true essence.
That itself cannot be harmed by anything;
it is supremely firm and stable.
Luminous from the expanse of intrinsic nature,
it is truly called the supreme sattva.
If one realizes it thus, that is seeing the face;
likewise it is equality, perfection, spontaneous presence.
Meditate on the Tathāgatas and the five wisdoms,
the maṇḍala of the great self-arisen.
Through skill in means free from conceptualization itself,
if one meditates on the deity as clear and without substance,
in a manner devoid of seeing, hearing, and the rest,
if one meditates clearly on one's own wisdom,
anything at all is accomplished in what has no intrinsic nature,
yet in being accomplished there is no substance.
Just as the Blessed One
planted a palm tree in the midst of Māra's army,
and gathered all into the tree of awakening,
and the vicious ones, displeased by their very nature,
could never cut the palm tree down to wither,
that itself is Vajrasattva.
Seeing oneself and the samādhi,
that itself is seeing the vajra face.
Meditating on Vajrasattva himself,

if the samādhi is very familiar and clear,
all becomes the vajra itself,
mastering all, unharmed by anything.
Oneself and the sattva are inseparable,
just as things appear according to shared karma;
oneself and the sattva have one view and conduct:
that itself is seeing the vajra face.
The authentic maṇḍala of reflections,
great and coarse, is realized through skillful means.
Apprehending individual characteristics is the thought of wisdom;
the nondual connection is great skillful means.
All abides in the state of wisdom.
All that appears and abides, every bit of it,
because it has not moved from suchness,
is neither moving nor not moving;
abiding and not abiding cannot be divided.
All gathers into the expanse of equality.
Gathered, densely massed in that very place,
all is in such a state;
equality and duality are inseparable, unharmed by anyone.
That itself is the place where the sattva dwells.
The one of supreme family who realizes it thus,
being of the same family as the sattva himself:
that itself is seeing the vajra face.
The aggregates and elements, taken as the cause,
are one in suchness as their ground and root.
Appearing as illusion, in the manner of a reflection,
appearance itself is without substance;
that very substance displays variety.
The five aggregates themselves are the Tathāgatas;
the faculties and minds are the mind of awakening;
the objects and the times are the great ones;
the forms of the thought of self are the wrathful ones;
the four extremes of permanence and annihilation are the wrathful goddesses.
That mind is called self-awareness itself.
All turning into the expanse is Samantabhadra;
that itself is Vajrasattva.

Whoever realizes it thus,
because his intent accords with the sattva himself:
that itself is seeing the vajra face.
All phenomena without exception,
signified by names, phrases, letters,
and sounds, teach meaning;
yet all are like the letters of a single name.
None of them is a substance;
the nonsubstantial itself appears in variety.
In appearance itself there is nothing at all.
Though it performs all the various acts and agents,
it is without substance: that is the authentic itself.
That which nothing can harm
is not earth or stone, devoid of awareness;
it is utterly luminous.
Vajrasattva abides in this way.
Whoever realizes it thus
is the cause of the sublime supreme family;
because he is inseparable from the vajra family,
that itself is seeing the vajra face.
A person endowed with excellent force of intellect
realizes the meaning of inseparability from all.
Though the result has not yet become manifest,
because he has made his abode in the mind of awakening,
just as, for example, in the womb or in the egg,
though not manifest and obscured,
one emerges with great strength complete,
so as soon as the body of conceptual thought is cast off,
he gains mastery over everything
and comes to hold the sublime supreme family.
The supreme accomplishments equal to Vajrasattva
are completely perfected.
He also attains the realm of Sukhāvatī,
and comes to play in supreme awakening.
As the teacher of gods and humans,
having gained mastery over body, speech, and mind,
whatever he focuses on is accomplished.

He gains power over the four immeasurables,
and enjoys the supreme taste of bliss in all things.
Finally he attains the state in which the suffering
of birth, aging, sickness, death, and the rest is exhausted.
He comes to hold the supreme vajra family,
and through the blessing of great compassion
he leads all beings without exception
into the vajra family.
He cuts down the hosts of Māra and tames the afflictions;
he turns the wheel of Dharma perfectly;
and to all beings without exception
he also shows the way of impermanence.
To the śrāvakas, the way of the arhat;
to those of awakening, the way of the self-arisen;
the unsurpassed vehicle, the way of the buddhas;
to the spontaneously present, the vajra expanse.
He shows a way in harmony with each,
yet he does not move from the expanse of intrinsic nature;
while unmoving, he teaches everywhere.
All phenomena without exception
abide in such a state."

Thus it is, in vajra secret words. He said this to himself.

This is the sixty-seventh chapter, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, on a single holy person of excellent force of intellect seeing the face of Vajrasattva.

Then the Tathāgata, in order to make the mantra holders' practice fruitful, condensed the root of the three hundred samayas from the King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, and for the sake of the mantra holders spoke this inspired utterance:

In the worlds of the ten directions, numerous as atoms,
wrong conceptions, unbearable, are numerous as particles;
the remedies that tame such thoughts are inconceivable:
the Vinaya and vows beyond reckoning,
and all the many supreme vajra vehicles.
Though they move from that very nature and are free of elaboration,

through the deluded thought of self-awareness
views high and low are inconceivable;
to tame them, the teachings are given as is fitting.
If the authentic and wrong conception
abided by their essential nature,
there could be no altering or transforming them.
If they had an essence from the very beginning,
there would be no abandoning afflictions and accomplishing purification.
All without exception becomes of one taste.
Because the relative is like the moon in water,
it can become anything and be accomplished as anything.
For the yogin who realizes suchness,
ultimately there is no arising or ceasing,
and relative illusion accomplishes anything.
In times of degeneration, wrong conception itself,
if realized as free of apprehended and apprehender,
is the very nature of selfless wisdom.
Through compassion, skill in means, and samādhi,
anything is accomplished just as it is focused upon.
If you say each has a definite intrinsic nature,
then the authentic path itself could not be cultivated.
Therefore the authentic ones of great mind
explain all as without substance.
For example, one who knows the kinds of poison
appears unharmed by poison.
Even halahala poisons,
when processed, become rasāyana medicine,
turn into nectar, and bring about long life.
The afflictions, taught as individual and general:
by realizing their characteristics without error,
they become the path of purification.
Even the accomplishments of body, speech, and mind
are nowhere else; they are just that.
The five great inner ones too,
when their individual and general meaning is examined,
are completely pure, being without characteristics.
Because their individual energies are taken up,

they are emanated as great skillful means.
Because the signs do not abide by intrinsic nature,
they are joined into the expanse of wisdom.
What is called delusion
is a synonym for the name ignorance;
the two are explained as nondual, one in meaning.
Its individual characteristic is stated thus:
phenomena, self, and things,
imagined as having essential nature and so on:
thought itself becomes a stream of illusion,
the continuum of the elaborations of wrong conception.
Yet all is of one taste in the dharmadhātu:
the dharmatā of patience, the single eye.
Its general characteristic is stated thus:
impermanent, suffering, empty, and selfless.
Ignorance need not be abandoned;
awareness need not be accomplished;
all dissolves as one taste into the expanse.
Conceiving illusion as a thing:
the very thought of illusion is not observed;
that unobserved itself appears in variety.
In its very arising, it is the single dharmatā;
the expanse itself, unobserved, is suchness.
That itself is the dharmakāya, the great seal.
As for illusory things that are not observed,
even the thing itself as the object of thought
is dharmatā, unobserved, pure from the beginning.
Because illusion and the unobserved are inseparable,
and existence and nonexistence are inseparable,
if one gains mastery through samādhi,
that is the great seal of mind.
Dharmatā is not an object of reference;
while unobserved, it emanates as illusion;
the activities for those to be tamed are inconceivable:
that is the great seal of speech.
Thus delusion need not be abandoned;
it is the vast Vairocana.

Aversion, taught as individual and general:
the thought of utter malice
toward all illusory things
has the nature of wishing to destroy them.
Its general characteristic is stated thus:
impermanent, suffering, empty, and selfless.
In aversion and compassion there is nothing to abandon or accomplish,
because they are of one taste in the dharmadhātu.
The malicious one, by nature illusion,
if he realizes that all things perish,
then all illusory appearances
are not other than the dharmadhātu;
the unobserved itself arises as illusion.
The intrinsic nature of all phenomena
lacks any nature of self, life, or nourisher.
All appearances are the dharmadhātu;
malice and illusion are dharmatā.
All is unobserved: that is suchness.
All is inseparable: the seal of Dharma.
Unobserved illusion is utter malice;
thought is utter malice;
dharmatā and illusion are not observed.
Because dharmatā and illusion are not observed,
the ultimate and the relative are of one taste.
If one gains mastery through samādhi,
that is the great seal of mind.
The unobserved one of utter malice
performs inconceivable activities of taming:
that is the great seal of speech.

The general characteristic of aversion,
when thoroughly examined in its very truth,
is the characteristic of purification:
being nondual, aversion is not to be abandoned.

The characteristic of pride, explained,
is swaggering from within, puffed up with conceit;
it overpowers others.

The general characteristic, explained, is
impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and no-self.
There is no abandoning pride to achieve peace.
Because all is of one taste in the dharmadhātu,
relatively, as illusion, there is just this inner swagger.
It is not other than suchness:
unobserved dharmatā arises as swagger.
In the very arising of swagger is dharmatā;
the nature of swagger is unobserved and pure.
Because swagger and non-swagger are inseparable,
that is the great seal of the dharmakāya.
The unobserved itself swaggers as illusion,
and by swaggering it overpowers.
It is not other than the dharmadhātu:
because illusion and dharmatā are inseparable,
the ultimate and the relative are both one.
If one gains mastery through samādhi,
that is the great seal of mind.
Swaggering, unobserved, as illusion,
the taming of pride is inconceivable:
that is the great seal of speech.
The specific and general characteristics of pride
are the characteristic of purification.
Pride is not to be abandoned to achieve peace.

The characteristics of desire, specific and general:
it is clinging to all of existence.
The general characteristic, explained, is
impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and no-self.
There is no abandoning attachment to achieve non-attachment.
Because all is of one taste in the dharmadhātu,
relatively, in the nature of illusion,
desiring and being attached is illusory craving.
Because it is not other than the unobserved,
the unobserved itself arises as illusion.
Because phenomena are not other than oneself,
the unobserved itself arises as illusion.

Because conduct and illusion are of one taste,
neither dharmatā nor what bears it is observed.
Inseparable from all the Victors,
it is the seal of the dharmakāya.
Unobserved, one desires and clings as illusion;
desire and dharmatā are not observed;
because illusion and the unobserved are inseparable,
the two truths are inseparable and one.
If one gains mastery through samādhi,
that is the great seal of mind.
The unobserved expanse itself unfolding as desire
tames in inconceivable ways:
that is the great seal of speech.
The specific and general characteristics of desire
are the characteristic of purification.
Since attachment and non-attachment are not two,
the characteristic of desire is not to be abandoned.

The characteristic of jealousy in all its forms
is, toward the excellence of others,
a narrow-minded thought, an illusion of other,
scheming with stratagems, having the nature of illusion.
The general characteristic of jealousy, explained, is
impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and no-self.
There is no abandoning jealousy to achieve broad-mindedness.
Because all is of one taste in dharmatā,
toward the relative, illusory excellence of others,
the jealous thought is itself of the nature of illusion.
It is not other than the unobserved:
the unobserved itself arises as illusion.
The thought of means
to outdo that excellence is the dharmatā of illusion;
because it is inseparable from all the Victors of the three times,
that is the great seal of the dharmakāya.
Toward the unobserved, illusory excellence of others,
one holds jealous thoughts,
yet thought and jealousy are not observed;

because the two truths, in which illusion and the unobserved are inseparable,
are of one taste,
if one gains mastery through samādhi,
that is the great seal of mind.
Toward the unobserved excellence of others,
jealousy fully unfolding
performs inconceivable activities of taming:
that is the great seal of speech.
Jealousy, taught in its specific and general aspects,
is the characteristic of purification.
There is no abandoning narrowness to achieve breadth.

All the many kinds of sentient beings,
the five inner great elements and the rest, have been shown;
their specific and general characteristics are to be explained.
By not realizing skillful means and wisdom,
one is not liberated: that is the saṃsāra of the three realms.
If one sees with certainty in this way,
just as a disease fully held in check by mantra
cannot do harm to anyone,
so when skillful means and wisdom are realized,
the three poisons and suffering do no harm.
If one is not held by skill in means,
then even non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) who practice the virtues of the path
are born in the higher realms as gods and humans,
but do not attain the ground where there is no birth and death.
For one held by skillful means and compassion,
when all beings of the deeds of immediate retribution, without exception,
are killed out of a bodhisattva's compassion,
immeasurable merit is obtained.
If one does not kill them, one abandons those beings to their fate;
one is without compassion, and there is wrongdoing.
Desire, aversion, and delusion,
and great pride and jealousy:
since that awakening mind
is clearly the vajra Tathāgata,
the afflictions themselves have been clearly declared

to be the very essence of the Tathāgatas.
Because all phenomena are pure by nature,
saṃsāra becomes completely pure.
For one endowed with skillful means and wisdom,
all afflictions are causes of awakening.
Since the nature of saṃsāra is selfless,
therefore the Tathāgatas are inconceivable.
For one who has become endowed with skillful means and wisdom,
the distortions themselves are the path to awakening.
Because the nature of saṃsāra is unobserved,
nirvāṇa does not exist.
Through the means of the unsurpassed secret mantra,
things are accomplished just as they are taken up.
It is inconceivable and has nothing fixed.
Ultimately nothing whatsoever is established,
yet illusory emanations are inconceivable.
For one held by the great means,
even the path of the afflictions is liberation.
If one is not held by the great means,
even practicing virtue, one will not be liberated.
The yogin endowed with the ultimate,
even while engaging in the binding things of the afflictions,
becomes liberated.
Since neither saṃsāra nor nirvāṇa
exists at all,
when saṃsāra is fully understood,
that is the very limit of nirvāṇa.
If the afflictions and distortions,
even though held by skill in means,
did not become liberated and freed,
then all the deeds that bodhisattvas perform
for the sake of taming beings,
even appearing as hunters and courtesans, would be downfalls.
If the excellent conduct of bodhisattvas
were improper because ordinary people lack it,
then the supreme and most profound mantra
would come to be practiced by all people.

It is taught that amṛta is to be accepted.
If equal and unequal are inseparable,
one gains mastery of vajra body and speech;
therefore these are taught as substances of accomplishment.
If the equality of wisdom is not realized,
although some animals may possess a kind of dharma,
and there are the livelihood of sages, those who conform to permanence,
and those who renounce desire for as long as they live,
I have not declared that they are liberated.
Through the fourfold mode of the complete purity
of all phenomena, the meaning is directly realized.
Causes are pure by nature,
and results become completely pure.
The characteristic of the cause is pure:
it is the five outer great elements,
mind itself appearing as the duality of apprehended and apprehender.

The apprehended object itself is the great elements.
Since the continuum itself is one's own mind,
the great elements are pure from the level of the cause.
The complete purity of the result is this:
the bones of all sentient beings
are the vajra awakening mind;
flesh is the lotus and rakta;
excrement, urine, and saffron water
are pure because they dwell in each one's own body.
Through ultimate purity without objectification,
all phenomena, outer and inner,
are not the essence of anything at all;
being without arising and ceasing, they are pure from the beginning.
Relative purity from the beginning is this:
everything appears with the nature of illusion,
abiding unobserved, like the moon in water;
the unobserved itself appears in manifold ways,
equal from the beginning as the Tathāgata.
Therefore act without clean and unclean.
To reverse the conceptions of beings,

medicine should be accepted as foremost.
Thus sentient beings, being mistaken,
do not know all phenomena to be pure,
and do not realize the meaning of skillful means and wisdom.
Some eat for as long as they live;
some, like the sages,
give up meat and live on grass and water.
Though they eat, they accomplish nothing, not realizing the meaning.
Yogins endowed with skillful means,
because all is completely pure by nature,
realize it thoroughly through the expanse of equality,
and so, through the union of skillful means and wisdom,
they will accomplish it without doubt.
Conceiving of things and non-things is a sign;
conceiving of clean and unclean is a sign.
Abandoning even signs themselves,
through knowledge one will not remain in poverty.
These are rightly declared substances of accomplishment:
the awakening mind, the great flesh,
excrement, urine, and rakta.
The practitioner should apply himself to them diligently.
Great and wondrous accomplishments are attained:
mastery over life, the state of a vidyādhara,
flying through the sky, and unobstructedness are accomplished,
and finally, through the unborn vajra,
other things too, just as one aims at them,
will be accomplished: of this there is no doubt.

Through the very meaning of the secret essence,
do not abandon the chosen deity, but meditate constantly.
The primordial characteristic of the deity
is that of all who have gone in the three times.
If the deity is abandoned, practicing virtue becomes meaningless.
The meaning of not abandoning the deity is this:
the lord of the vajra body, speech, and mind
of all the maṇḍalas of the Sugatas of the three times,
not separate, nondual with the self

of all spontaneously present wisdom:
this is the meaning of meditating to completion.
If the Three Jewels are abandoned, the holy life becomes meaningless.
If one joins oneself in equality with the deity,
even with few qualities one will attain accomplishment.
Applying the equality that is there from the beginning,
meditate constantly as the deity itself.
One becomes equal to all the Sugatas,
and body, speech, and the five wisdoms are perfectly accomplished.

Do not disparage the vajra master.
He shows awakening, he is the guide,
like a guiding staff leading the blind;
he dries up the ocean of affliction and suffering.
To revile that master
is like putting out the lamp in a dark pit,
so that what is to be seen is not perceived:
one will manifestly undergo wretched suffering
for a long time, for many eons.
Therefore always be respectful toward him.
Hold him as far more important
than a king who has power over your body.
Honor him far above
the kind parents who gave you birth.

Vajra brothers and sisters,
who go to the realm of unsurpassed awakening,
are, through the power of dharmatā, samaya, and aspiration,
certain to reach the precious ground of awakening.
To turn against them and bear them grudges
is like striking oneself with a weapon:
for five hundred lifetimes,
one will cut off one's own life and be ruined.
In this life, various misfortunes
will come about as unhappiness,
and in the worlds beyond as well
one will experience, one after another,
the sufferings of the three lower realms and the unfree states,

and for a long time, never freed,
one will undergo extreme misery.
Practice together as though of one accomplishment.
Brothers and sisters follow along with nondual faith.
They are the unsurpassed maṇḍala of the Sugatas;
with clear wisdom, always cherish them.
Thus it was said.

Do not proclaim the secret to others.
The samayas of body, speech, and mind:
through the two kinds of yoga of equality,
having realized skillful means and wisdom in union,
one overcomes through the conduct of equality,
and realizes truly, unlike the ordinary.
Keep it utterly secret
from those on the side of non-realization, and from all people.
The various secret code words that were spoken
were made through skill in means.
It is not that the secret mantra has faults;
through great compassion and skill in means,
it is kept secret for the sake of unfit vessels,
the dull-witted, and those with evil karmic residue.
If by chance this secret meaning
is proclaimed to one with evil karmic residue,
then just as, when fire is kindled with a fire-drill,
the fire-drill itself is seen to burn,
and other things are burned as well,
so the excellent meaning of the Dharma is like fire.
Those of small fortune and inferior wisdom,
evil-minded and ignorant of cause and effect,
by denigrating equality
are hurled into the three lower realms.
If those who do not realize the secret meaning come to experience suffering,
then the one who spreads the secret, too,
will have a field ploughed on the tongue with which he spoke,
and will experience great suffering.
Therefore keep it secret for the sake of beings;

do not speak it even in the direction of the wind.
Do not break the continuity of mantra and mudrā.

What is proclaimed as mantra is this:
in the great maṇḍala of great equality,
where ultimate and relative are inseparable,
the syllable oṃ of body, speech, and mind,
and the rest, forty-two in all.
The characteristic of the great seal is this:
the body, speech, and mind and the five wisdoms
of the Sugatas of the ten directions and four times,
inseparable from oneself: that is the great seal.
Endowed with the qualities of clarity and diligence,
empowered as one wishes, without attachment,
one should make it familiar and stable.
Therefore, if there are interruptions and no diligence,
it is like wanting fruit
from a burnt seed:
the practice will be without result,
and one will remain in the unfree states of saṃsāra.
For one who has entered the great yoga,
all phenomena, outer and inner,
are without objectification, free of one and many,
neither edge nor center,
without essential nature and without characteristics.
Through the great seal of equality,
all the ten directions and four times,
and the qualities and faults of the transcendent and the mundane,
are without arising and ceasing,
established as no essence at all: they are equal.
Relative phenomena are without arising and ceasing;
unobserved, they are not the essence of anything.
Like the moon in water,
they appear in manifold ways and can perform activities.
The ten directions of the great seal,
all the three times and the three realms,
the mundane and the transcendent,

and all qualities and faults
abide from the beginning equal as illusion.
Having realized oneself as the king of mantra holders,
if one abides without wavering from
oneself as dharmatā, without arising and ceasing,
then all the great seals too,
completely, the body, speech, and mind of the Tathāgatas
of the ten directions and three times,
all inseparable, equal from the beginning,

unmixed, vast, and unbroken,
the celestial palaces and the maṇḍalas of sun and moon,
inconceivable and spontaneously present,
the inconceivable qualities of body, speech, and mind:
meditate on them as complete in the great expanse of equality.
Such are these three samayas;
if one abides in them, one will attain accomplishment.
With the limbs unimpaired, recite mantra,
and enjoy all the objects of desire.
If body, speech, and mind become stable,
one will attain boundless awakening.
If one transgresses the great samaya,
the danger is declared to be very great.
If, out of delusion, one transgresses
the buddhas and bodhisattvas
and the mantra conduct that accomplishes the aim,
that person's life will come to an end right there.
Guarding samaya, reciting mantra,
mudrā, and not breaking the continuity: these four
are to be held with great and steady diligence.
If the yogin's diligence becomes slight,
the danger of not attaining accomplishment is declared to be great.
Just as, if a man does not quickly
grasp the sword's edge with care,
his hand will surely be cut,
so the secret mantra practitioner without care
will die, or else will be without result.

Excellent yogins
keep the limbs of mantra unimpaired and clear,
make the ultimate unimpaired and pure,
generate great diligence, and accomplish swiftly.
Mantra and meditation unimpaired, mudrā clear:
ritual and implements were not taught as the main thing.
If they are complete, there is no fault;
if they are incomplete, there is no fault;
even if they are incomplete, one will attain accomplishment.
By joining oneself with one's own deity,
all accomplishments will be attained.
Even if the rite has too much or too little,
one will attain accomplishment; there is no fault.
Thus it is in secret words.
This is the sixty-eighth chapter, explaining in brief the fifteen roots of the three hundred samayas.

Then the Tathāgata Great Delight taught the dwelling place, the conduct, and the manner of gazing:
If you desire the meaning of the spontaneously present Great Vehicle,
vast, profound, and spacious, wisdom is swift.
Realizing the profound meaning, irreversible bliss;
without I and without self, spacious bliss.
As the dwelling place, the nondual dharmadhātu is shown:
great skillful means, the all-accomplishing, luminous love;
the all-delighting, fierce lady of the expanse;
a retinue of greater and lesser bodhisattvas;
a retinue of servants, led by the many classes of gods and spirits;
my own form with its marks, supremely adorned.
In the spacious center of the sky of the dharmadhātu,
wisdom swiftly goes to the meaning,
without going, without coming, without abiding:
the supreme awakening mind, ah, what bliss!
In the maṇḍala of inexhaustible wisdom,
wisdom soars as the play of compassion;
union in the nondual expanse, ah, what bliss!
Into the swamp of ignorance and delusion

the arrow of the lamp of wisdom is shot,
and the darkness of delusion is dispelled:
natural luminosity, the supreme of bliss.
Virtue and nonvirtue are not two;
thoughts and signs are not grasped as existent.
Since in what is naturally luminous from the beginning
there is neither virtue nor evil, what great bliss.
Since bliss and non-bliss are not two,
wisdom is unattached and completely pure.
All is inseparable wisdom;
mind itself being clear, ah, what bliss!
As adornment, all the maṇḍalas are beautiful,
formed from the cause that is wisdom;
in the clear state without obscuration, outside or within,
wisdom with a steady mind, what great bliss.
Toward everything endowed with the five enjoyments,
one holds no notion of clean and defiled;
since all is of one taste in dharmatā,
being nondual, what great bliss.
Through the samādhi of lesser and greater wisdom,
all is without error, in accord with the scriptural system;
saṃsāra is not abandoned, yet there is no suffering;
content in nonduality, ah, what bliss!
All without exception in the state of oneness:
the looking and the view, both are absent.
When the lamp of wisdom is held aloft,
all the realms of the ten directions are seen.
Because here and beyond are not two,
there is neither going nor anywhere to go.
Without leaping with great strides of the limbs,
in all the world systems of the ten directions,
the domain of the supreme Sage, the Teacher,
is accomplished just as one intends.
All phenomena are unobservable;
dharmatā, as illusion, is accomplished as anything at all.
When the meaning is examined with undefiled profundity,
there is nothing whatsoever that has not become pure.

Unfabricated wisdom, clear throughout,
is pure by nature.
Although it abides thus from the beginning,
the clear lamp is obscured
by the cataract of ignorance and delusion,
and one circles continually in the darkness of the three realms.
Through grasping at thoughts as signs,
one experiences bodies, enjoyments, and abodes,
and various pleasures and sufferings.
Who is it that makes this?
No truly mighty one made it;
one has merely bound oneself.
All phenomena without exception
have no core:
they are like an illusion, an optical illusion, an emanation,
a mirage, a rainbow, and the moon in water.
Whoever fully realizes it thus
is declared to be a buddha himself.
He dwells on the ground of a buddha;
he is unborn perfection,
and the supreme state of non-doing is complete as well.
Thus he spoke to himself.
This is the sixty-ninth chapter from the Net of Illusion, teaching the dwelling place and abode.

Then all the Tathāgatas spoke this practice for accomplishing the deathless vajra.

One who wishes to accomplish the great vajra corpse
should meditate on everything as being without birth and death,
as equality and as purity itself.
With the jaḥ hūṃ vaṃ of the wrathful Amṛtakuṇḍalin
one should summon.
With oneself and the wrathful one nondual,
one should practice again and again.
When the deity bodies have become clear,
one should place them beneath the great corpse.
Having arranged the entire maṇḍala there,

meditate on the maṇḍala of wrathful gods and goddesses.
Send forth messengers on errands to the ten directions,
and bring all without exception under control.
The practice should be meditated upon with one,
or else two, three, or five.
Having summoned the nṛ with many messengers,
place it in the corpse again and again.
It becomes long, yellow, and glossy in color.
Then, through the samādhi of amṛta,
for many hundreds of thousands of times,
recite in the threefold manner of recitation.
Reciting the vajra mantra, three-pointed,
the recitation issues from between them;
make it endowed with five rays of light.
When the corpse becomes limp and quivering,
rouse it with the five nectars.
Then set out the five syllables,
and meditate on them as clear and gleaming.
The five senses and the mode of the senses,
and on the five limbs the mode of the five families:
meditate on them with that vajra samādhi.
Then, when the corpse begins to move
and moves violently,
bind it very tightly with a noose,
and press down its limbs as well.
Show skull cups in the four directions.
Meditate on oneself in the form of Hayagrīva,
and recite the mantra many hundreds of thousands of times;
radiate to the ten directions and dissolve it into the corpse.
Then, when the corpse moves violently,
with that vajra samādhi
one should meditate on it as stable.
Then, when it flutters,
whatever is the a nṛ bri du,
strike it hard with the vajra and bring it down.
Having drawn the nṛ out from the mouth of the skull,
cut it with the teeth of vajra samādhi.

Eat it with the vajra mantra and dissolve it within;
one should meditate on it as nondual.
Then, when the corpse rises,
confer empowerment upon it from the vajra expanse,
pour amṛta water into it,
and set it to perform all activities.
The words the corpse then speaks are:
"Hero, what shall I do? Things of agelessness and birthlessness,
and all activities without exception, I shall do."
Through such a supreme kind of practice,
all ashes come back to life.
The places for the practice are charnel grounds,
fearsome mountain crags, the haunts of obstructors,
empty forests full of thorns,
places of slender willows encircled by mountains,
utterly secluded places,
and places where yakṣas and rākṣasas appear:
one should practice in such places.
One should practice for nine, twelve, thirteen,
or up to sixteen.
One will accomplish it without doubt.
The provisions for outer and inner sustenance,
the corpse of the five roads and the five medicines,
and all the grains should be kept at hand.
Always offer a great feast;
do not interrupt it, three or five times.
Eat your food from a skull cup,
and your drink likewise.
Keep a lamp burning constantly;
make its substance from the fat of the nṛ,
and likewise for anointing the limbs.
Make the wick from lotus material.
The vessel is a great conch without seams;
with or without locks of hair is acceptable.
If de byi pu tra is not available,
the color is found in one that is mottled.
To ward off obstacles to the vajra practice,

always seal the boundaries.
From the right and left legs of the nṛ,
take bones that are not thick but thin;
having made them into ki la ya,
recite with the kīla mantra and the wrathful mantra
a hundred thousand times.
On the palms and fingers of the right and left hands,
meditate on the ten wrathful gods and the ten wrathful goddesses
as blazing bodies of dhāraṇī.
Then, in the manner of nondual union,
the practitioner should meditate as the vajra.
Apart from the actual practice itself,
seal the boundaries in the ten directions as well.
Until accomplishment is attained,
practice the three, meditation, recitation, and mudrā,
heedfully, as if one's head were on fire,
without any interruption.
Through such a supreme kind of practice,
gods, mātṛkās, and rākṣasas serve like slaves;
the worldly Īśvara is brought under control;
the retinue and circumstances of the supreme vajra family
come about just as one wishes.
These great miraculous powers
should be displayed openly only once one is able to conceal one's body;
otherwise keep them utterly secret.
This was declared for the sake of the definitive accomplishment of the body.
This is the seventieth chapter, on the accomplishment of the vetāla.

From The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, this definitive inspired utterance, called the samaya of dance and song, play and dance and song, was uttered:
In the maṇḍala where all
of the infinite ten directions and four times is inseparable,
in the celestial palace where sun and moon have risen,
having spread out seats of lotus without attachment,
on the ground of the palace of inexhaustible jewels,
in the blissful maṇḍala of awakening,

immeasurable in its greatness and smallness,
having fully arranged blissful awakening,
gathering all without exception, gathering into the expanse,
moving the body, stirring and shaking the limbs,
and all the gazing and conduct of the five senses
are declared to be the great seal.
The maṇḍala above, in the measure of sun and moon,
on the ground of the Unshakable,
having spread out seats of lotus without attachment,
in the manner of skillful means and wisdom without attachment,
all the limbs and senses, every one,
are completely pure by nature,
and are the samādhi of the five Tathāgatas.
Unbound from the beginning, entirely,
through the maṇḍala of superior samādhi,
on the head is the circle of the Tathāgata,
on the four limbs the circles of the four families.
Clearly visualizing colors, shapes, and mudrās,
and skillful means and wisdom,
radiate them to the ten directions and purify the lower realms;
gather them back into their places and radiate the maṇḍala.
All, both those who have passed beyond and those who have not,
are joined in the realm of the Sugata.
When the five great limbs are moved,
the maṇḍalas of the five families all move without exception;
the five classes of beings are set on the path of awakening,
and the five degenerations too are completely purified.
When good, beautiful, and fine garments are worn,
lights of many kinds radiate.
Then, endlessly, without limit,
one is adorned with the five wisdoms.
A person endowed with great skill of mind
should always meditate on the maṇḍala in this way:
not merely in words, but in the depths of the mind,
as inseparable from oneself.

Having become endowed with skillful means and wisdom,
facing toward the east,
one should leap with the great stride of a lion.
Meditating on traṃ, the syllable of the tongue,
emanate inconceivable hundreds of thousands of tongues,
and hri too, beyond conception.
Throughout the inconceivable ten directions and four times,
the maṇḍala of speech blazes with light.
The limbs of the maṇḍala of the one speech
are inconceivable and resound everywhere.
Sounds, names, and words are each distinct and clear.
Spreading out the faculty of the tongue, he speaks,
telling of both the liberated and the unliberated.
Yet in definitive truth alone,
in suchness, nothing at all was spoken.
In the maṇḍala of the faculty of the ear,
having clearly visualized the syllable traṃ,
the maṇḍalas of the ten directions and four times
are infinite and inconceivable;
by contemplating traṃ again, light radiates and blazes.
All the maṇḍalas of the directions and times without exception are heard;
the abodes of saṃsāra of the six classes of beings are heard as well;
sound and hearing are nondual.
Likewise smells, tastes, and tactile objects:
having clearly visualized their respective characteristics,
set out their seed syllables in the same way.
All the maṇḍalas of the buddhas without exception,
and all the six classes of beings without exception,
are enjoyed in the manner of non-attachment.
With smells and the rest, as supreme bliss,
all are truly offered to their satisfaction.
For all the six classes of beings without exception,
one also accomplishes whatever benefit is suited to them.
Through skill in means and compassion, one shows it thus.
Likewise, the Tathāgata family and the vajra family,
and the others, the Unattached and the rest, endowed with wisdom:
meditating on the five principal lords and five principal ladies
as endowed with skillful means and wisdom,

and meditating well on one cluster, or else three,
or a maṇḍala of five,
with skillful means and wisdom in mutual union,
make the deities clear, radiate light, and dissolve it back,
and meditate on the maṇḍala as blazing with rays of light.
When the samādhi has become very clear,
one should meditate on oneself and the ten directions
as inseparable and nondual.
Then, with skillful means and wisdom both,
view and conduct never parted,
when the maṇḍalas are clearly visualized,
facing east from the center,
move with the great stride of the feet,
move all the gestures of the hands,
and make the mudrās of dance and performance.
The maṇḍala radiating white light,
the bodhisattva completely pure,
utterly clear and blazing with light:
may that skillful means and wisdom be accomplished!
With the vajra that nothing can withstand,
the four māras are vanquished.
Vidyādhara of the vajra of the supreme vehicle:
may that skillful means and wisdom be accomplished!
Through oneself, the vajra of the family,
may there be no affliction or suffering!
Through mirror-like wisdom,
may skillful means and wisdom become clear!
Cutting off affliction and suffering at the root,
it dispels the darkness of ignorance.
Through the rising sun of the rays of compassion,
may skillful means and wisdom blaze with light!
Utterly solid, without birth and death,
displaying the play of vajra compassion,
compassion arises fully toward beings:
may skillful means and wisdom be endowed with love!

Having become endowed with skillful means and wisdom,
facing toward the direction of qualities,
moving the body, stirring and shaking the limbs,
one should also stamp with great strength.
The treasury from which all maṇḍalas without exception arise,
the inexhaustible precious jewel,
fulfilling the hopes of all without exception:
may that skillful means and wisdom be accomplished!
Showing the color of the center of the sky,
or else all of refined gold,
the inconceivable maṇḍala, inexhaustible:
may skillful means and wisdom be swiftly accomplished!
Though the precious qualities are inconceivable,
all abide in the state of equality:
such is the wisdom of equality.
May skillful means and wisdom become equal!
The great and wondrous qualities of the Sugata,
the realm of awakening, unattached from the beginning,
where all abides in reality itself:
may skillful means and wisdom be swiftly accomplished!

Having become endowed with skillful means and wisdom,
facing toward the west,
moving the first limb,
and making the dances very clear,
one should also stamp with great strength.
Though one enjoys all phenomena without exception,
like the lotus in the mud,
one abides in the manner of non-attachment:
may that skillful means and wisdom be accomplished!
Where karma and affliction have set,
there is not an atom of habitual tendency or sign:
may skillful means and wisdom be swiftly accomplished!
The unattached maṇḍala of awakening
is the expanse itself, come from nowhere;
it dwells in the expanse in the manner of non-abiding:
may skillful means and wisdom be swiftly accomplished!

Having become endowed with skillful means and wisdom,
facing toward the north,
moving the body, making the limbs dance,
with each of the mudrās made clear,
one should stamp with the great stride of the feet.
Through the wisdom of true realization,
having purified all the obscurations
of inconceivable eons,
may skillful means and wisdom be swiftly accomplished!
Through the blessing of body, speech, and mind,
the four māras are vanquished and adversity is dispelled;
without agent or action, all aims are accomplished:
may skillful means and wisdom be swiftly accomplished!
That which perfects all without exception
transforms into every kind of variety.

Displaying its color in the manner of green:
may skillful means and wisdom be swiftly accomplished!
Accomplishing all aims without exception,
perfecting all activities without exception,
completing the task with great diligence:
may skillful means and wisdom be swiftly accomplished!
Cutting off the net of suffering,
even while making every maṇḍala without exception,
coming from nowhere and going nowhere:
may skillful means and wisdom be swiftly accomplished!
All the sugatas without exception,
great in nature throughout all directions and times,
in the nonreferential maṇḍala of the mind
all gather without exception, utterly pure.
Through the genuine maṇḍala of great skillful means,
light radiates to all the sugatas.
The maṇḍala of bliss endowed with skillful means and wisdom
is gathered in by the skilled.
Of all things without exception, there is nothing
not included within the four families.
That itself is the very maṇḍala of the sugatas:
may skillful means and wisdom be blissfully accomplished!

Gathering the maṇḍala of the five families at the head,
rays of light of the five wisdoms radiate,
filling the ten directions with clarity:
may skillful means and wisdom blaze with light!
Likewise, the one who holds the supreme family
gathers all without exception into the expanse
and reveals all as Samantabhadra:
may skillful means and wisdom be accomplished as the principal!
Through the blessing of great compassion,
for all without exception who dwell in the directions and times,
the great wheel of Dharma is turned:
may skillful means and wisdom be supremely accomplished!
Because all beings without exception
possess the body of suchness,
to the deluded who do not see it, it is the color of the sky:
may skillful means and wisdom be accomplished in the expanse!
The body appears in every variety, as anything at all:
to those of great skillful means, in the form of equality;
to the śrāvakas, in the form of an arhat;
to the pratyekabuddhas, in the form of a rhinoceros;
to those who perfect the perfections, in the form of the Śākya;
to gods and humans, in the form of the ten virtues;
to animals, as an antelope (eṇaya);
and to all other beings as well,
it appears in whatever way will tame them.
Revealing bodies such as these,
may skillful means and wisdom be accomplished as the body!
Having meditated with skillful means and wisdom united,
adorned with the five ornaments,
one arranges the maṇḍala on the five limbs
and drums upon the palace with the ornaments of wisdom.
In the nondual maṇḍala, round in form,
in the maṇḍala without edge or center,
in the spontaneously present great assembly, in awakening,
may skillful means and wisdom be swiftly accomplished!
The sacred dharmadhātu, without self,
in the nonreferential expanse all gather without exception.

Because equal and unequal are indivisible,
may skillful means and wisdom be accomplished in the expanse!
When the maṇḍala of the Sugata moves its head,
all the buddhafields without exception quake.
When the movement of the hands is stirred into motion,
the realms of the vidyādharas are purified.
When the great feet stride and leap,
the abodes of the six classes of beings are emptied.
When the eyes gaze upon the ten directions,
the armies of the four māras are defeated.
May all skillful means and wisdom without exception
accomplish aims such as these!
All things without exception are thus;
in them nothing whatsoever is apprehended,
and there is no entity of arising, ceasing, or abiding,
of coming or going.
In performing the many kinds of yogic dance, song, and play,
nothing is done.
May that very reality, in its various forms,
accomplish the yogic activities!
When, through all skillful means and wisdom,
one enjoys in such a way as this,
all the maṇḍalas of the buddhas without exception are pleased,
and all beings of the three realms of existence
become pervaded by great joy.
Without abandoning the body, one reaches the level of a vidyādhara;
having long enjoyed the bliss of the Dharma,
as unsurpassed Vajrasattva,
adorned with the major and minor marks,
possessing the six superknowledges and knowing all,
one revels in the completion of both great accumulations,
and holding mastery over the buddhafields,
in every domain of activity maṇḍalas
are accomplished just as they are envisioned.
Yogis who are fit for the work
should perform activities such as these.
Even if the result has not yet become manifest,

having gained mastery over body, speech, and mind,
they will not miss the appearance of the buddhas,
they will never be born into the Lesser Vehicle,
they will never fall into the three lower realms,
they will never fall into evil lands,
bad places of miserable livelihood,
and they will not forget the supreme Vajra Vehicle.
Their lives are long and their happiness is perfect;
their bodies are comely and their limbs complete;
their faculties are whole, with nothing lacking or in excess;
their voices are melodious, and they work for the benefit of beings.
All their own enjoyments
are gained without harm to others.
Endowed with the strength of great might,
they act rightly for the sake of beings,
and never do harm to others.
Great in compassion and endowed with wisdom,
great in power and endowed with skillful means,
they perfectly carry out their own aims and the aims of others.
In the end, on the ground where there is no birth or death,
they attain the accomplishment of mastery and enjoyment
over all the celestial palaces
arrayed with the precious qualities of the buddhas.
Whatever yogi, extending the faculty of the tongue,
teaches the meaning of this,
the definitive meaning of the secret,
may he be accomplished as unsurpassed and supreme!
With the topknot of indivisible awakening,
abiding as a mountain utterly firm,
which the winds of the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) cannot sway,
such is the vajra of the supreme vehicle:
a treasure from which inexhaustible maṇḍalas arise,
a precious wish-fulfilling jewel,
utterly clear without being polished.
Though it has remained for countless eons,
its body has the form of a youth in full bloom.
Free of birth and death, it is the vajra

treasure from which all things arise,
endowed with perfect qualities.
Having accomplished unsurpassed awakening,
may vajra wisdom be spontaneously present!
May the two great accumulations be completed!
As the Teacher of all,
having attained the state of omniscience,
may one hold mastery over the buddhafields!
May all who realize this, the vajra family,
also accomplish body, speech, and mind!

Yogis endowed with skillful means and wisdom should at all times enjoy the five sense pleasures and engage in dance.

This concludes the seventy-first chapter, on dance, song, and play, from The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality.

Then the Tathāgata brought forth the maṇḍala of body from the King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, and spoke these words.

From the expanse endowed with suchness,
illusion and net become joined together,
and through the appearance of the vajra light of the supreme body,
the concordant vajra appears of itself.
The bodies of the six streams of saṃsāra that appear
are karmic appearances concordant with conceptual thought.
Likewise, the stainless supreme body
is summarized as the five bodies of the Sugata:
the Blessed One, the form of awakening,
the unsurpassed form, and the vajra body,
these and other inconceivable bodies.
Showing bodies in the ten directions and the four times,
showing bodies to tame beings through skillful means,
the vajra body of supreme awakening
shows bodies in realms free of attachment,
and appears without stirring from the expanse.
The appearing body is the expanse of suchness.
It does not show only pure bodies:
to all those whose thoughts go astray

it also shows bodies that tame each one individually.
Then it is the body without birth or death,
the lotus body unattached to karma.
Though liberated and unliberated are various,
it appears in variety yet does not abide;
there is neither appearance nor nonappearance.
The supreme family that realizes this
is designated vajra.
However many inconceivable bodies are shown,
all without exception are gathered into the vajra.
What is also called the wheel,
these and other inconceivable bodies,
arose from the center of the skillful means of awakening.
If one knows all the various bodies
to be like rainbows and the moon in water,
then from the expanse itself, it is nothing but the appearance of the expanse.
Mind itself appears as the maṇḍala of speech;
speech itself is the maṇḍala of body;
indivisible, so they are, entirely.
Those who wish to accomplish the excellent maṇḍala
should always, in all three times,
since self and what is one's own are indivisible,
regard this as the maṇḍala from the very beginning.
That this is the supreme accomplishment,
the All-Victorious One has thus declared.

"Bringing Forth the Maṇḍala of Body," from the Great King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion. It is said that the chapter on the profound maṇḍala of body is explained in the Later King of Tantras and was not translated into Tibetan. This is the seventy-second chapter, on gathering into the maṇḍala of the body of the intrinsic nature.

Then the Tathāgata, from the Great King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, from the net of methods for applying oneself to the stages of samādhi and swiftly gaining the accomplishments, spoke these words:

The accomplishment of inconceivable maṇḍalas
draws forth its meaning from the nonreferential expanse.
Resting in the natural state, uncontrived, just as it is,

the spontaneously present maṇḍala arises.
If, from the nonreferential maṇḍala of the mind,
one gains mastery through samādhi,
the various emanations of wisdom are accomplished.
Every domain of activity is a maṇḍala;
the wisdom maṇḍala liberates and protects.
Enjoyment bodies and buddhafields
are accomplished through aspiration, just as one wishes.
Vast, spacious, and spontaneously present,
outer and inner, the world and its beings, are pure from the very beginning.
The realization of purity is itself the expanse;
from that comes vajra equality.
If you wish to accomplish the attainments swiftly,
meditate in a way that is very subtle and profound.
Self, what is one's own, and others,
meditate upon as the utterly nonreferential expanse.
Having grown familiar with that samādhi,
one should understand all things as illusions, as mirages,
and as the mode of emanations.
Having grown familiar with this again and again in the same way,
then meditate on the subtle samādhi.
Gather the outer and inner, the world and its beings, into hūṃ.
Whatever is to be accomplished has its own particular syllable,
yet in general, whatever one meditates on is alike in every case:
all gathers into Vajrasattva himself.
The five limbs and consciousness itself
are gathered completely into the syllable hūṃ.
So that it is as though visible to the eye of nṛ,
growing familiar with it again and again,
one should emanate many rays of light.
Having filled the ten directions and the four times,
one should dissolve them back into the hūṃ.
The hūṃ itself dissolves into the nonreferential expanse.
From the expanse into which it dissolved, a white a blazes forth.
Having meditated on it as clear and utterly brilliant,
meditate that everything becomes a.
Having grown familiar with it as suchness,

from the a emanate a sun maṇḍala.
How wonderful! Once it has clearly come about,
meditate on sun and moon as full sun and moon discs.
Meditate on a clear hrī as a lotus free of attachment.
Meditate on a celestial palace of blazing jewels.
The sun and moon seats and the celestial palace,
gather them all and meditate on them as subtle.
Likewise, through the abiding syllable hūṃ,
dwelling there as a brilliant blue,
meditate on rays of light radiating out.
Having gathered the radiating light back into the expanse,
meditate on vajra light rays radiating powerfully.
When the radiating vajra light has blazed forth clearly,
one should dissolve it into the expanse once more.
That itself becomes the body of the sattva:
meditate on it as very subtle and condensed.
Likewise, when nonduality has become clear,
meditate on a single body with vajra and bell.
Once it has become suchness itself,
meditate on it as having three heads and six arms.
Meditate also on various wrathful tamers.
According to the greater or lesser wisdom of one's intellect,
one should meditate in gradual stages,
or else one should meditate all at once,
as sun, moon, planets, and stars at a single moment
appear clearly in a limpid pool of water.
One of the supreme family who has thus grown familiar and realized
accomplishes just as one gains mastery:
flying in the sky, dwelling as a vidyādhara,
turning back the flow of rivers and stilling the wind,
passing unobstructed through mountains, cliffs, and the like,
not sinking in water, not burned by fire,
not endangered by poison or weapons,
becoming invisible and emanating many bodies,
and anything else, just as one wishes:
holding mastery over gods and demons,
lengthening and shortening lifespans and times,

producing a trichiliocosm in a mustard seed,
all is accomplished just as it is envisioned.
Snakes and vicious beasts of prey
will follow behind like dogs.
Māras, vicious beings, and the like
cannot prevail and become like servants.
Without abandoning the body, one reaches the level of a vidyādhara;
through the enjoyment of wisdom and merit
one gains the supreme assembly of the wheel of syllables.
Through the blessing of compassionate emanations
one also teaches the path of individual liberation
and also works for the benefit of all beings without exception.
Having carried out every activity,
one attains the immutable state beyond birth and death,
adorned with all the major and minor marks,
possessing the great accumulations of merit and wisdom,
and accomplishing the ultimate, where nothing remains to be done:
the dharmadhātu, with nothing to accomplish and nothing to abandon,
suchness, with no going and no coming.
If one practices and meditates in this way,
even if the result has not yet become manifest,
in all one's lifetimes and births
one will never be born into evil deeds,
one will never come to the Lesser Vehicle,
and one will become a holder of the supreme vajra family.
So it is in the words of the vajra secret.

From the Great King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, this is the seventy-third chapter, on obtaining the accomplishments through the lineage that is to be kept utterly secret.

Then the Tathāgata spoke these activities of the fire offerings (homa) from the King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion.

First, meditate on suchness until it is clear and familiar. Then meditate on a single clear and brilliant a at your heart. When that a has become very clear, meditate that it radiates as light into the ten directions. Gather that light back into the a and dissolve it there. From ma and a, meditate on the maṇḍalas of the sun and moon, merged, brilliant, and clear. From hrī, meditate clearly on a

lotus maṇḍala. Meditate on hūṃ blazing with intense light. In the maṇḍala of the heart, meditate on a single Vajrasattva a finger's length in size, together with his mudrā. Recite clearly the forty-two mantras, their syllables, and their mudrās as well. Recite also the three syllables and the five syllables. Seal the boundaries with the four syllables of abiding. Perform fire offerings constantly, and perform the gathering feasts and offerings as well. For the sake of those unable to do many, it is acceptable to perform whichever fire offering one can.

As the principal deity at the center of the maṇḍala: for the general rite, Vajrasattva; for the wrathful rite, Vajra as well; for magnetizing, Padma Heruka; for enriching, Ratna Heruka; for pacifying, Buddha Heruka. For the invitation, one invites from the principal deity of whichever fire offering one is performing, saying ehyehi mahākāruṇīka. When presenting offerings and the argha: for the wrathful rite, at the head of the mantra string, hūṃ; for the peaceful rite, at the head of the string, aṃ; apply the same to those in between. For the invitation, from whichever principal deity one is practicing, for pacifying add śāntiṃ; for the general rite, complete each deity's own mantra. The wrathful rite faces south, magnetizing west, enriching north, and pacifying east; for the general rite, any direction will do. The hearths are a triangle and an open-mouthed skull cup, a crescent, a lotus, and the one free of attachment. Of the seven kinds of mudrā there are the great mudrā, the mudrā of the nature of reality, the samaya mudrā, the action mudrā, the mudrā of skillful means and wisdom, the mudrā of samādhi, and the mudrā of superior samādhi.

From the Great King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, this is the seventy-fourth chapter, on the four kinds of fire offering.

Then the Tathāgata, from the Great King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, also explained the fifteen wondrous samayas in brief, as follows:

Through the wisdom of omniscience,
in the very state where all is equal,
these are gathered into the expanse as a single taste;
never has it been said that they fail to become the aim.
The desire for supreme qualities:
since all that appears and exists, without exception,
is joined with the realm of equality,
one engages in it in the manner of nonattachment.
This is the pure and excellent path,

the ground for going to supreme awakening;
it becomes an inexhaustible treasure of great bliss,
the vajra body that nothing can assail.
But desire, which is affliction and suffering,
becomes obscured by body and food,
and one goes from place to place in the realms of the hungry ghosts,
tormented by thirst and hunger,
forever seeing pus, blood, and foul vomit,
without even the power to enjoy happiness,
and guarded by the harsh and vicious.
The anger of great compassion
cuts off the door to the sorrow of saṃsāra
and leads beings into the path of the Sugata,
so that they come to possess the genuine meaning.
Displaying wrath in the manner of compassion,
it places them in the state of perfect equality.
Through the peace of Vajrasattva
genuine, supreme bliss is accomplished.
The bliss of clear wisdom:
self and what is one's own are indivisible;
it plays in the expanse without intrinsic nature,
the state in which nothing at all can be expressed,
possessing a body that pervades everything,
the utterly luminous, pure path.
It purifies the obscurations of bodhisattvas
and clears away the poison of the afflictions of sentient beings.
The pride that purifies all realms
is the treasury that gives birth to good qualities.
Where there is no I, no self, and nothing to apprehend,
who would give rise to pride toward that?
One accomplishes the utterly victorious leader of the herd,
whom hosts of fourfold armies cannot conquer,
and attains the samādhi of heroic going
that crushes the gods, demons, and armies of Māra.
Jealousy, applied to the meaning of narrow and vast:
if one realizes the meaning of no I and no self,
narrow and vast are not two,

and the vast maṇḍala of supreme bliss is accomplished.
But if one does not understand the reality of jealousy
and grasps at an I and a self,
one is born in the abode of the asuras,
and from there goes to the realm of the hungry ghosts.
Even if one finds land and a place,
it becomes very unhappy and cramped.
Moreover, over all one's enjoyments
one has no control and falls under the power of others.
In short, affliction and suffering are produced.
The genuine realization of jealousy
is to be jealous of grasping at an I and a self
and of all that is inverted,
and to join all things in nonduality.
Then supreme bliss, too, will be accomplished,
the meaning of nonduality will be realized,
one dissolves into the expanse without I or self,
and the spontaneously present supreme aim will be accomplished.
If one constantly meditates on the deity in one's mind,
through cause and result spontaneously present,
one gains mastery over all things
and will be born in the abode of the vidyādharas.
What the vajra family is to practice
is brought to completion through liberation and union.
Union itself is liberation;
by their very nature they are union and liberation;
in liberation itself there is union.
There is union and liberation through samādhi,
union and liberation at the time of sense objects,
union and liberation by those of great skillful means,
and union and liberation made manifest.
Or else, union and liberation of the self and so forth:
one joins the expanse of wisdom with the self.
The emanations of great skillful means are inconceivable;
one liberates all things into the expanse, into the expanse.
The activities of play are inconceivable;
the emanations of compassion are inconceivable;

the activities of union and liberation are perfected in oneself.
Emanations of the mind of awakening radiate into the ten directions;
they empty the abodes of the lower realms,
bring about the attainment of the bliss of the vidyādharas,
and purify the unsurpassed realms.
Body and speech, spontaneously present, tame the ten directions.
Proclaiming the name "Vajra,"
they establish even those of the Lesser Vehicle in the vajra,
and the inexhaustible treasure is accomplished as well.
The body of the vajra knowledge-holder,
the body of the equality in which all is indivisible,
the supreme wisdom of omniscience,
through immeasurable emanations of compassion,
knows the six classes of beings in all times and places without exception.
Within beings themselves is the very body;
it knows the afflictions as the path of awakening;
saṃsāra itself is the abode of bliss.
The dharmadhātu and the full extent of sentient beings
are indivisible in genuine reality itself.

From the Great King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, this is the seventy-fifth chapter, which also explains the fifteen wondrous samayas in this way.

Then the Tathāgata, from the King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, uttered this inspired utterance, himself to himself, on this very elaboration of the samayas.

The samaya called "Vajra of Elaboration":
Within the compassion of the vajra of anger,
which cuts off the abodes of the hells,
the eight and eight, sixteen, are joined into a pure realm.
For those in the hot hells, the medicine of coolness;
for those in the cold hells, the medicine of warmth;
balancing cool and warm, soft and rough:
thus it displays the blessing of compassion.
The blessing is wondrous and utterly marvelous.

The samaya called "Wisdom of Attachment":
In the manner of nonattachment,
one should enjoy all desirable things.

Just as one tastes the flavor of bliss,
in the very experience of feeling there is no intrinsic nature.
Through the wisdom free of attachment
the abodes of the hungry ghosts are cut off,
and it shows that both afflictions,
of being obscured by body and by food, are absent.

The samaya called "Delusion":
Through the luminosity of great wisdom,
nondual, without I and without self,
the suffering of those without memory or speech is cleared away.
Having purified the obscurations into nondelusion,
through the compassion of clear wisdom
it frees from the afflictions without agent or action,
and it empties the abodes of the animals.
Thus it lights the lamp of compassion.

The samaya called "Jealousy":
Through the wisdom of great vastness,
for those who grasp at an I and a self,
compassion joins them evenly in nonduality,
and narrow and vast are both absent.
For one who possesses a vast and spacious mind,
there is nothing that is not included in this.
It joins all things in vastness itself,
and it empties the realms of the asuras.

The samaya called "Pride, Supreme Bliss":
In the primordial equality of the nature of reality,
there is no such thing as "I" and "you."
All things are of a single taste in the expanse;
to its nondual character nothing can be added.
Since it is the state without great or small,
it is shown that there is nothing to be done.
Through the realization of the selflessness of pride,
the abodes of the haughty are emptied.

The samaya called "Natural Luminosity":
Whatever exists in this world,

all that holds to names and conventions,
if one deconstructs their individual characteristics,
is without intrinsic nature: it is reality itself.
Through the wisdom of the great self-arisen,
all things are joined into buddhafields,
uncontrived, unmade, naturally clear:
the buddhafield, luminous from the very beginning.

The samaya called "The Very Maṇḍala":
Abiding in the intrinsic nature itself,
made by no one, self-arisen,
it joins all things into suchness
and dissolves them into the state of the nondual expanse.
Through the maṇḍala of self-arisen wisdom
all without exception are gathered into suchness.
Gathering and not gathering are both absent:
it is reality itself.

The samaya called "The State of Bliss":
All things without exception are utterly pure;
because they are not other than their own expanse,
bliss and nonbliss are both absent.
All things are of a single taste in the expanse.
Since the state of suchness prevails,
reality itself has spoken thus.
Explaining and listening are both absent as well;
both are gathered into suchness.

The samaya called "Supreme Victor of the Four Times":
The supreme, unsurpassed wisdom
holds mastery over all things
and joins all things in equality.
All that is past and not yet past,
what will arise and what is uncertain to arise,
through the distinction of wisdom that realizes them,
are joined together at once in equality,
where the four times have no before and after.

The samaya called "Spontaneous Presence":
The transcendent and the worldly
are all indivisible awakening.
Phenomena pure from the very beginning,
uncontrived and spontaneously present:
this is the great path of awakening.
All things are gathered into indivisibility itself.
Accomplishing the aim of awakening is complete from the beginning;
all things dissolve into the realm of equality.

The samaya called "Vajra Birthplace":
Certain to be of the family of the supreme Great Vehicle,
being of that family, one is held by the teaching of awakening.
If one knows the expanse in which all is equal,
it is the birthplace of all the supreme families.
In birth itself there is no birth;
there is no karma and no karmic imprint.
Unstained by anything, it conquers all;
it is also the ground without birth or death.

The samaya called "Arraying the Fields of Awakening":
In the ten directions, endless and boundless,
the inconceivable appearances and sounds,
the outer and inner abodes,
dissolve into the expanse of suchness.
In short, in all the realms without exception,
elaborated by the ornaments of wisdom
that array precious qualities,
the qualities of those fields are inconceivable.

The samaya called "Abode of Wisdom":
Wisdom free of apprehended and apprehender
is the abode of all the tathāgatas.
Those who wish to accomplish the great secret mantra
attain the wisdom free of apprehended and apprehender.
The dharmadhātu and sentient beings
are one in suchness, without duality.
The person who realizes this
is said to be the abode of the vajra.

The samaya called "Supreme Fearless Victor":
Purification and affliction
do not exist as two separate things;
affliction cannot be corrected by an antidote.
Since all things are of a single taste in the expanse,
in it there is no fear and no antidote.
Unassailable by anything and unsurpassed,
it is also the field of supreme bliss,
without I and without self, the supreme among victors.

The samaya called "Stable Celestial Palace":
Joining all of the ten directions and the four times
into the field of the Victor,
its narrowness and breadth cannot be measured.
Its mark is like the crown protuberance of a buddha;
it is accomplished from the cause of wisdom;
it is accomplished just as it is envisioned.
Accomplished from the exhaustion of defilements,
it is the dharmadhātu, never subject to fear.

The samaya called "Joining All Variety":
Since it is not the way of outcasts,
it is accomplished just as one intends.
Since awareness has become self-governing,
one may make things empty or not empty.
Since all is the state of indivisibility,
colors, shapes, and precious jewels
pervade everything, in the manner of a mustard seed:
inconceivable, without edge or center.

The samaya called "The Power of the Guide's Abode":
Through inconceivable ignorance and wrong conceptions,
the inconceivable world systems,
both the cause and the result of saṃsāra,
are instants without basis or root.
If one knows the genuine mind of awakening,
ignorance, its cause and its result, are utterly purified.
The afflictions themselves are awakening,
and all things without exception are the abode of bliss.

The samaya called "Showing the Five Paths":
Having meditated on the three kinds of samādhi,
and having closed the doors of the five paths of affliction,
one sees that what appears as the five paths is conceptual thought.
Conceptual and nonconceptual are both absent;
that nonduality is the genuine path.
In the very state of skillful means and wisdom
one should realize perfect meditative equipoise
and should teach the unsurpassed.

The samaya called "Teaching the Genuine Meaning":
Although inconceivable vehicles are taught,
and although suchness itself does not speak them,
according to the stages of beings' understanding
they are made clear to all, suited to each one.
This is the supreme Vajra Vehicle:
just as water flows down the rivers into the ocean,
and all of it is of the very nature of water,
so all the vehicles are the vajra ground.

The samaya called "Thorough Realization":
For one fully endowed with wisdom and great intellect,
never has it been said that it fails to become the aim.
For the inconceivable beings of the three realms of existence,
the evenness of compassion is inconceivable.
It teaches only what accords with the aim
and cuts the noose of discord, saṃsāra.
It purifies the fields of the sugatas,
and all things gather, pure, into the expanse.

The samaya called "Transforming Awakening":
Having gained mastery over self-aware wisdom,
just as white is changed in color by dye,
and just as poison too becomes medicine,
so the three poisons are awakening,
and the five classes of beings are joined to the path of awakening.
It is the path that frees from affliction and suffering.
If liberated and unliberated are not two,
all things without exception are the cause of awakening.

The samaya called "Equally Perfect, Spontaneously Present":
Wisdom appearing as illusion
and wrong conception appearing as illusion,
since both are illusion, are equal in nature.
Not abiding even in equality itself,
the accumulations of merit and wisdom are perfected.
In the maṇḍala of the two wisdoms,
the vajra of the supreme vehicle is perfected without exception,
with excellent minor marks beyond measure.

The samaya called "Mastery over All":
Through the distinction of thorough realization,
if one aspires, one knows every domain of experience.
Over suchness and over conceptualization
one gains mastery, since they are not two,
and all without exception become fields of bliss,
and all become supreme awakening.
In what has been without entity from the very beginning,
all is accomplished just as it is envisioned.

The samaya called "The Power of the Vidyādhara's Abode":
Having grown familiar with the three kinds of wisdom,
and realizing the meaning of the samādhi of equality,
one should always meditate on the great vastness.
Having gained mastery over self-awareness itself,
in which cause and result are perfected at a single time,
one's age is that of sixteen,
and one remains, prolonging it for hundreds upon hundreds of years,
and without casting off the body one becomes a buddha.

The samaya called "Endowed with an Inexhaustible Treasure":
Through great and utterly pure wisdom,
all domains of experience become pure.
The knower and its domains are not two;
they are of a single taste in suchness.
By joining all things into the field of the Victor,
it becomes an inexhaustible treasure of jewels.
The supreme samaya, endowed with what is inexhaustible,
is Akaniṣṭha, whose edge and center are inconceivable.

The samaya called "Equally Perfect Without Accomplishment":
In the maṇḍala where all is equal,
the suchness in which the expanse and the awareness
of freely moving self-arisen wisdom are not two
is the vajra family.
Where all things are without duality,
there is nothing to accomplish and no accomplishing.
In what is spontaneously present from the very beginning,
nothing can be corrected by a path.

The samaya called "Blessing All":
Although phenomena have been pure from the very beginning,
when the mind is turned around by inversion,
one dwells in wrong conceptions and enjoys them:
the inconceivable deluded saṃsāra of ignorance.
In order to turn back evil, deluded conceptions,
great compassion, through skillful means,
guides the afflicted and places them in the higher realms,
and teaches them to realize the great path of awakening.

The samaya called "Infinite Supreme Speech":
All phenomena without exception
are taught by imputing them in names and words.
However many meanings are expressed,
in vajra speech there is no elaboration.
That which is free of elaboration is the speech of wisdom
that understands every kind of sign in all its variety,
transcending all sounds, names, and words.
All is the lotus free of attachment.

The samaya called "Inexhaustible Transformation":
Through the wisdom of omniscience,
all that appears and exists, without exception,
is mastered by suchness
and dissolved into the expanse of wisdom.
Endowed with an inexhaustible treasure of wisdom,
the blessing of compassion is inconceivable,
and the meanings of the transcendent and the worldly
are each realized and utterly purified.

The samaya called "Understanding All Languages":
For hundreds of thousands of maṇḍalas of liberation,
and for the six classes of beings in all times and places without exception,
though not a single word of speech is uttered,
through the blessing of former compassion,
to both the liberated and the unliberated,
each according to what they wish,
the supreme and sacred speech of the Dharma
urges them toward liberation and purifies the lower realms.

The samaya called "Mastery of Self-Awareness":
In directions and times beyond conception,
all the various signs that are imputed,
however many exist there,
are the conceptualization of self-awareness itself.
In the infinite expanse of buddhafields,
the maṇḍalas of the tathāgatas
and the inconceivable emanations that arise
are a domain purified as emanations of wisdom.

The samaya called "Understanding Without Letters":
Abiding in the inexpressible state
free of letters, words, and sounds,
speech itself is without intrinsic nature,
and all phenomena are pure from the very beginning.
Since all has become the enlightened mind,
it does not abide in sounds and words;
the enlightened mind does not abide in the mind.

The samaya called "Vanquishing the Hosts of Māra":
The afflictions themselves are completely pure;
the five aggregates themselves are manifest buddhas.
Oneself is the maṇḍala of the deities,
the eternal abode free of birth and death.
By the supreme being who has vanquished the four māras,
all the great arrogant ones are vanquished.
The vināyakas of ignorance are tamed and cut off,
and all dissolve into the expanse of phenomena.

The samaya called "Renowned Throughout the Three-Thousandfold World":
Through the blessing of great compassion,
in worlds of the ten directions as numerous as atoms,
the activity for beings is inconceivable.
Through body, speech, mind, qualities,
and spontaneously present wisdom,
no one to be trained is left neglected.
Purifying the lower realms, and in the fields of awakening,
it teaches the Great Perfection of wisdom everywhere.

The samaya called "Supreme Speech of Wisdom":
All things, both transcendent and not transcendent,
when examined thoroughly with correct knowledge,
are without intrinsic nature, yet appear as anything at all.
In their very appearing, they are the expanse itself.
The wisdom that realizes this
has mastery over all and is self-sovereign;
everything appears like the sound of words.
This is the supreme speech of wisdom.

The samaya called "Inconceivable Wisdom, Vajra Speech":
Phenomena are inconceivable;
without edge or center, they pervade everything.
Pervading and not pervading is the vajra speech,
proclaiming various sounds and languages,
the sound of things where there are no things.
Just as when a lute is taken in hand,
although various sounds arise,
there is no thing there: just so is suchness.

The samaya called "Directions and Times Indivisible":
All the ten directions without exception,
and all that arises in the four times without exception,
being without direction and without before and after,
are all the expanse of suchness.
All the separate appearances
of the transmundane and the mundane
are truly gathered in the king, self-awareness;
that self-awareness itself is everything.

The samaya called "Fearless Vajra":
The unconditioned itself is the conditioned;
the conditioned is neither appearing nor non-appearing.
Existence and nonexistence, too, are indivisible.
Its nature pure from the very beginning,
unfabricated and unmade, it is naturally clear.
It cannot be destroyed or demolished:
the vajra self that nothing whatsoever can overcome.
So it was spoken.

The samaya called "The Body of Suchness":
Likewise, in the inconceivable buddhafields
and for all beings without exception,
to the liberated it is a pure body,
to those with concepts it is a body of saṃsāra.
It shows the meaning to each as suits them,
yet the Teacher himself has no substance;
like the moon in water, he appears to all.
Realize everything in this way!

The samaya called "Spontaneously Present Abode of Bliss":
Just as in all phenomena without exception
the heart of awakening is present,
all are gathered in the heart of awakening,
by nature luminous from the very beginning.
Since all things, outer and inner, without exception
abide within one's own state,
oneself has mastery over oneself,
and there is no need to wish for any field of experience.

The samaya called "Great and Supreme, Completely Pure":
Because one has oneself become the king of awareness,
one has mastery over all.
Having taken the unsurpassed ground,
one is the lord of all.
Since all without exception is nondual,
there is no commanding and nothing to be commanded.
Through empowerment in suchness,
all is of one taste in the expanse.

The samaya called "The Maṇḍala of All Phenomena":
In the outer and the inner, the vessel, its contents, and selves,
the natural maṇḍala abides from the very beginning.
All the great appearances of form
are the very maṇḍala of the tathāgatas.
That which holds the displays of illusion
is likewise the maṇḍala of the mothers.
Self-awareness is the maṇḍala of awakening,
abiding as the gathering of all from every side.

The samaya called "Great Inexhaustible Treasure":
The contaminated is like the wealth of yakṣas:
that of sentient beings increases, declines, and is exhausted.
But the qualities of the tathāgatas
are inexhaustible, without increase or decline.
Elaborated into many, they do not dwindle;
gathered into few, they do not grow coarse.
Being an inexhaustible treasure of jewels,
they pervade all things.

The samaya called "Completely Pure Awakening":
Although all phenomena without exception
are completely pure from the very beginning,
through the condition of conceptual thought, adventitiously,
they dwell in the prison of saṃsāra's three realms.
Through the purity of unobscured self-awareness,
when one realizes the meaning, that nirvāṇa and saṃsāra
both are without intrinsic nature,
they are completely pure as a buddhafield.

The samaya called "Rolling Up Apprehended and Apprehender":
When one conceives in a distorted way,
self and mine appear as separate.
Dualistic grasping then enters into that,
and though without intrinsic nature, things appear as separate.
When examined thoroughly through correct realization,
all things are empty.
Not abiding in things or in thingness itself:
realizing that is what frees one from suffering.

The samaya of Dhātvīśvarī, become the Mother:
When there is reliance on the five elements,
all things arise and abide without exception.
It is the ground of all births without exception,
and it is the cause of everything.
Likewise, through the three kinds of wisdom,
diligence free of laziness is called forth.
Likewise, when the expanse itself is realized,
it is the source from which unsurpassed awakening arises.

The samaya called "No Fault in Phenomena":
The unsurpassed maṇḍala
and all the abodes of the lower realms without exception
are both pure in their very cause and nature;
their nature is wisdom, just so.
The world of the completely pure result,
the stable and the moving and the rest,
even as it appears, is without essence.
That itself is the great dharmakāya.

The samaya called "Acting for the Benefit of Sentient Beings":
Since all are one in meaning as the mind of awakening,
great compassion arises as the root.
Through skillful means one practices the perfections,
and travels by way of the afflictions as the path.
Even the afflicted abiding in the three realms
is nothing but distortion appearing.
Realizing it as such is the higher realms and liberation.

The samaya called "Grasping the Meaning Through Realization":
That all is spontaneously present,
and knowing its way to be like an illusion or a mirage:
both are gathered into self-awareness itself.
That itself is declared to be the truth.
What is expressed in sounds and words
draws out the essence of the true meaning.
Without relying on names, words, and sounds,
one should understand it in the depths of the mind.

The samaya called "Dwelling in Mind":
All phenomena without exception, whatever there are,
do not exist apart from mind itself.
Since mind and phenomena are indivisible,
the path of awakening is not far.
It comes from nowhere and goes nowhere;
it is nothing but nonconceptual self-awareness.
Buddhas and sentient beings abide in mind.

The samaya called "Inexpressible, Free of Elaboration":
However many various things are expressed,
whether transmundane or mundane,
apart from their individual characteristics,
not even a hair's breadth is expressed.
Adorned by great merit,
the buddhafield itself is pure.
Through bad actions one dwells in the three realms,
yet that itself is no elaboration apart from the expanse.

The samaya called "Unchanging Vajra Speech":
The emanations of pure body and speech,
and the various displays of the Great and Supreme as well,
appear to the mind of awakening,
and in their very appearing they are gathered into the expanse.
Through inconceivable distorted movements,
one circles in the abodes of the three realms and the five paths.
That itself is wrong understanding appearing in various ways;
apart from that there is nothing at all.

The samaya called "Unfabricated from the Very Beginning":
Awakening beyond intellect need not be wished for.
All the five kinds of beings without exception
abide in the heart of awakening from the very beginning.
The expanse of suchness pervades everything.
Into this state of things as they are,
the mind that realizes it thus enters,
and when it is realized as nondual,
who is it that fabricates, and who that realizes?

The samaya called "Natural Luminosity":
All phenomena without exception,
as self-awareness pure from the very beginning,
are naturally clear, fabricated by no one.
That domain of those who possess wisdom,
unattached like a lotus,
is not something common to all.
That domain of the tathāgatas
is realized by persons of supreme acuity of mind.

The samaya called "Dhātvīśvarī of All":
Become a treasure of inexhaustible qualities,
a wish-fulfilling treasury that knows no time of exhaustion,
it arises from the most profound mind,
free of self and of mine.
When the meaning of the profound dharmadhātu is realized,
the bodies and wisdoms are inconceivable.
When the meaning of self-aware wisdom is realized,
one attains the eternal state free of birth and death.

The samaya called "Binding to Awakening":
When, with wisdom free of apprehended and apprehender,
one rests in equipoise in the expanse without attachment,
all is the field of suchness,
and affliction and suffering will not arise.
Having myself perfectly completed it,
in accord with the nature of phenomena just as it is,
I shall establish the lesser vehicle and the distorted,
all of them, in the expanse of equality.

The samaya called "Directions and Times Nondual":
All the ten directions and the four times
appear separately as marks of understanding,
yet in their very appearing they are indivisible.
Like a sphere without edge or center,
self-awareness, too,
is without edge or center and is not many.
It goes nowhere, yet pervades everything;
granting bliss to all, it abides nowhere.

The samaya called "All Endowed with Riches":
When phenomena are understood individually
and all is known as the nondual expanse,
one attains the ornament endowed with inexhaustibility,
an ever-inexhaustible treasure of jewels.
When one takes up residence in suchness,
affliction and suffering do not arise;
it is awakening itself, ever abiding in bliss,
endowed with all the major and minor marks.

The samaya called "The Two, Skillful Means and Wisdom":
All that appears, in whatever way,
is all of the nature of skillful means.
Means is joined to means,
yet joining and the joined both do not exist.
All the various appearances,
even as they appear, are without intrinsic nature.
That itself is declared to be wisdom.
Means itself is never apprehended.

The samaya called "Joining Wisdom Itself as Means":
From the very expanse of suchness
various displays arise as anything at all.
In their very arising they are without intrinsic nature;
in their very nonexistence the various appear.
Means and wisdom arise from the expanse.
With the wisdom of hearing, reflecting, and meditating,
realize the meaning of wisdom as means!
In this way bring everything to its wealth!

The samaya called "The Nondual Mind of Awakening":
When means and wisdom are united,
when the nondual mind of awakening radiates,
it is the source and the maker of all;
there is nothing at all that it has not made.
It is not any color, shape, or kind;
extremely hard to examine, no one knows it.
If even I myself do not see myself,
how could another realize it?

The samaya called "Uniting All":
From the very beginning they are gods and goddesses:
the true union of the maṇḍala,
and the joining of the faculties with their objects.
The five aggregates themselves are the tathāgatas;
the five elements themselves are joined as the mothers,
joined as the very goddesses of the four times;
eternalism and nihilism, the four alternatives, are the wrathful goddesses.

All things without exception, all the elements,
are joined with the expanse of equality and with awareness.
Or else, with the wisdom consort, the woman of the expanse,
arrange the entire maṇḍala of the Sugata,
meditate on yourself as the deity of awareness,
and unite in nonduality.
When vajra and bell are joined,
the lotus of awakening is greatly delighted.
The maṇḍalas of the directions and times are pleased,
and many beings attain bliss;
then dissolve once more into the nondual expanse.
Having dissolved, blaze forth from the expanse as the mudrā.
The skillful means and wisdom of the Sugata are perfected;
the six mudrās, too, are fully perfected;
the two great accumulations of merit are also perfected.
Since all is fulfilled in the expanse,
one does not fall into the lower realms, and true accomplishment is gained.
This is the great liberation.
Liberating itself is union;
union itself liberates all without exception.

The samaya called "Liberating All Without Exception":
All sentient beings without exception
who dwell in however many outer and inner vessels and contents
should be liberated into the expanse
through realization of the great self.
Just as the supremely great Wrathful One
liberated the Great God through skillful means,
so, through the samādhi that realizes the nature of reality,
liberate them nondually through skillful means.

Through the blessing of great compassion,
summon all the beings of the five paths
and liberate them all without exception.
All beings without exception
who dwell in the four continents of great Mount Meru,
blessing them with great compassion,
when you meditate on the great fire of wisdom,
should all be burned without exception.
Dissolve them again into the expanse,
bless them as tathāgatas,
and empower them as heirs of the Victors.
Although all this liberation is performed,
there is no thing at all that is liberated.
When the five aggregates are destroyed,
once destroyed, the elements become latent;
even when they are not destroyed, they are elements.
If one kills, consciousness being without existence,
even as it abides, it has no substance.
As for that nature of mind,
even if the buddhas of the three times rose up as enemies,
no one could seize it, and there is no slaying it.
Then what is it that compassion liberates?
All conceptual signs
are turned back from distortion,
and through samādhi, mantra, and mudrā,
and through thorough habituation, they are empowered
and established in the field of awakening.
Just that is designated "liberation."
Liberation itself is union.
Having cut affliction and suffering at the root,
since one liberates into the abode of awakening,
it is union in the nondual expanse.
Skillful means itself is wisdom, and wisdom itself is skillful means;
nonduality itself is the mind of awakening.

Union is the maṇḍala of union as gods and goddesses; the joining of the faculties, objects, and times; the joining of the five great ones as the five

tathāgatas; the joining as the mothers of what exists merely as the illusory display of each; the joining of the faculties, objects, and times as gods and goddesses; the joining of eternalism, nihilism, and the four alternatives as wrathful gods and wrathful goddesses; and joining in direct perception.

Liberation is liberating through skillful means; liberating through transference; liberating into the equality of the four times; liberating all without exception into the expanse at a single moment; and liberating all nondually through great compassion.

These two are performed at the same time; they should not be allowed to become separate. "The supreme accomplishment, too, is attained there": so the Tathāgata himself explained to the Tathāgata himself.

The samaya called "Taking What Is Not Given":
All phenomena without exception,
whether transmundane or mundane,
are nothing other than self and mine,
yet by their own nature they are selfless.
Although one enjoys everything without obstruction,
the enjoyed and the enjoying both do not exist.
Since all is empty from the very beginning,
who is it that takes, and what is enjoyed?
Although one enjoys without obstruction
all of appearance and existence without exception,
one is not bound: it is an accumulation of merit,
it is great wisdom free of attachment.
All without exception is the expanse of phenomena;
thus it is declared to be self-awareness.
When it is realized as nondual,
the very taking is Samantabhadra.

The samaya called "Speaking Falsehood":
All phenomena without exception
have never existed as things from the very beginning.
By nature they are naturally luminous,
and although they are indicated by mere names and words,
names and words have no substance.
Through the deluded concepts of ignorance,
where there is no "I" and no self,

separate signs are grasped as things;
yet there is no grasping thing at all.
All phenomena are mere names and words.
However much is said,
there is no speaker and nothing spoken.
All phenomena appear as false;
in falsehood itself one engages in falsehood.
What is called "false" is a mere designation;
all are words of falsehood.

The samaya called "Vajra Destroyer":
From beginningless time, in a distorted way,
where there is no self and no mine,
conceptual signs are grasped as separate,
yet the thing that is grasped does not exist.
In order to destroy discordant signs,
with vajra-like samādhi
destroy all the habitual tendencies of self-conception,
and dissolve into the vajra expanse.

The samaya called "The Wheel of Dharma":
Through the blessing of great compassion:
the afflicted beings who circle in the three realms
do not circle because another has bound them;
they circle through their own grasping, concepts, and attachment.
You who are richly endowed with great intelligence,
listen to the supreme meaning of the Dharma:
saṃsāra, without being abandoned, is the buddhafield.
Realize all without exception as the nature of reality.

The samaya called "Source of Jewels":
The supreme wealth is the seven treasures;
they are not found by seeking them with desire.
When, beyond body, speech, and mind, unobjectifying,
in a manner free of attachment,
one is endowed with them nondually,
the seven great treasures will arise,
endowed with the various major and minor marks.

The samaya called "Unattached Lotus":
In all phenomena without exception,
whether transmundane or mundane,
there is no staining and nothing to be stained,
like a lotus born from the mud.
Of all the limitless appearances, however they appear,
not a single one exists apart from oneself.
Since oneself is utterly unobservable,
even the afflictions themselves are the field of awakening.

The samaya called "Accomplishing All Aims":
The vajra family vanquishes all;
the jewel family brings forth qualities;
the lotus family becomes free of attachment.
Body, speech, mind, and the five wisdoms
fulfill all aims.
Abandoning apprehended and apprehender,
the mind gazes at the expanse of equality.
Free of birth and death, spontaneously present,
the body, speech, mind, qualities,
and wondrous activity renowned to all
do not exist anywhere else:
they are self-arisen wisdom without location.
In the manner of seeing, the appearances of form
and the appearance as the body of unsurpassed awakening,
just as in a mirror,
appear as various colors and shapes.
The speech of the tathāgatas
transcends all sounds, names, and words;
its inexpressible nature is understood everywhere.
Free of affliction, the unsurpassed sound,
unuttered, resounds through the three-thousandfold world;
the speech it utters is inconceivable.
In the very uttering, there is no three-thousandfold world;
that itself utters the various.
Endowed with the omniscient mind,
examined thoroughly through true realization:
the expanse without ground or root, momentary,

whose edge and center cannot be found by examination,
that itself is the cause from which the various arise,
unfabricated and unmade by anyone.
Even I myself do not observe myself;
insubstantial, it has mastery over all.
When one is truly endowed with body and speech,
the qualities are equal to the limits of space,
gathered into the unchanging buddhafield.
In all fields of experience without exception,
things arise just as they are intended.
The great inexhaustible treasure is accomplished:
the precious wealth of awakening
that no one else can steal.
Through the blessing of great compassion,
the four kinds of activity are performed without act or agent;
there is no doing and nothing to be done.
The qualities of the buddhas, spontaneously present from the very beginning,
engage with everything in the manner of an illusion.
In the maṇḍala of the state free of engagement,
they play in a manner free of attachment.
Though acts and agents are of various kinds,
in their very doing they are like the moon in water.
The wisdom free of apprehended and apprehender
is spoken of as "the five roots,"
yet in the very speaking it does not exist at all;
without characteristics, the various appear.
That itself is omniscience itself.
Pervading all and abiding nowhere,
it is awareness become sovereign,
inconceivable and all-pervading.

The samaya called "Illuminating Space":
All phenomena without exception
are pervaded throughout by suchness.
All vessels and contents without exception
are pervaded by great light.
Just as space cannot be grasped,

all appearance and existence is like that.
All phenomena are mind,
and mind is of the nature of space.

The samaya called "The Great Earth, the Support":
Just as on the great earth
all births without exception arise,
both those held by mind and those not held by mind,
and it is the abode and support of all,
so in the unsurpassed Great Vehicle
all the awakened buddhas abide;
all the vehicles, high and low, arise from it,
and all are gathered into the expanse of the Great Vehicle.

The samaya called "The Burning Fire of Wisdom":
Through selfless wisdom, self-awareness,
the habitual tendencies of things and non-things are burned.
When particular and general phenomena
and all the jealousies of the mind
are realized to be without substance,
saṃsāra is completely pure without being abandoned.
One does not pass into nirvāṇa; one abides there from the very beginning.
There is no going and no abiding to be done.
All concepts are burned up from the very beginning.

The samaya called "Washing All":
All sentient beings without exception
circle in saṃsāra because of the two obscurations.
When, through the wisdom of hearing, reflecting, and meditating,
the two kinds of selflessness are realized,
the perfections are completed and the ten grounds accomplished;
having perfectly completed the three grounds,
one establishes all in the field of equality.
This is the supreme ablution.

The samaya called "The Great Scatterer":
Sentient beings, pure from the very beginning,
become covered by self-grasping like countless motes of dust.
By realizing that mind and the dust do not exist,

the wind of wisdom scatters the habitual tendencies.
Phenomena are from the very beginning like the wind;
just as it cannot be grasped,
in that way bring everything to fulfillment.
Unfabricated, it abides thus from the very beginning.

The samaya called "Mastery over All":
Through undistorted self-awareness
that realizes the nonduality of apprehended and apprehender,
when all becomes the state of equality,
since all without exception is oneself,
one has mastery over all,
and whatever one intends is accomplished.
However one acts, it is an accumulation of merit;
it is the great wisdom of equal awareness.

The samaya called "Knowing All Phenomena as Reflections":
It is the source from which all arises;
in their very appearing, like a rainbow,
all things appear without intrinsic nature.
That itself is declared to be the dharmakāya,
stained by nothing at all and abandoning nothing.

Forms that appear separately and in accord,
not imputed as "I" or as self,
appear within such a state.

The samaya called "Knowing Phenomena to Be Like Sound":
However many sounds are uttered,
from what is no thing comes the sound of things;
utterance and sound are not things.
Know phenomena to be like sound!
All the meanings that arise without exception
do not exist apart from what words indicate.
Sound itself is not the thing that is meant,
yet meaning itself does not exist apart from sound.

The samaya called "Knowing Phenomena to Have the Character of Scent":
All phenomena, without substance,
arise in various ways and spread forth.

Likewise, the thing that is scent
does not exist, yet it is smelled everywhere.
With wisdom free of doubt,
know all phenomena in this way!
Although one is fully satisfied by scent,
scent and thing are not two.
All accomplishments are like that.

The samaya called "Knowing All Phenomena to Be Like Taste":
All phenomena without exception
arise from what has neither ground nor root.
Likewise, when the insubstantial faculty,
the substance that has no entity,
and consciousness, faculty, and object come together,
the faculty of taste is fully accomplished.
Taste, and the realizing of it as taste,
are momentary and without intrinsic nature.

The samaya called "Knowing All Phenomena to Be Like Touch":
Forms are like masses of foam;
feelings are like bubbles on water;
grasping at signs is like a mirage.
When consciousness is governed by illusion,
various signs are certain to arise.
One experiences every supreme taste of bliss as well.
That itself is a great accumulation of merit;
bliss is wisdom free of attachment.
The accomplishment of touch is like that.

The samaya called "Conditioned Things Completely Pure":
When one takes up residence in the true itself,
the outer and inner, vessel and contents, are completely pure.
What appears as coarse is the tathāgatas;
what holds it as an illusion is the expanse of the Mother.
Form is a sign without substance.
When each is broken down into its fives,
all abide in the state of space,
and space, likewise, is the expanse of phenomena.
This is the accomplishment of the conditioned itself.

The samaya called "Conditioned Things Arising Everywhere":
The bodies of the sugatas appearing as illusion,
and wrong understanding appearing as illusion:
both are without ground or root, empty of intrinsic nature,
and cannot be analyzed into families or lineages.
Because they have no family, color, or shape,
the outer and inner, vessel and contents, appear.
In their very appearing they are the dharmakāya;
they become anything at all and accomplish everything.
The accomplishment of arising everywhere is like that.

The samaya called "Overpowering the Majesty of the Elephant":
All sentient beings without exception
are distracted by many concepts and formations.
Like a child whose strength has not unfolded,
they remain distracted by many acts and agents.
Since the many acts and agents are selfless,
when one masters them through samādhi,
signs abide in the expanse of equality,
and the various formations are unmoving and stable.

The samaya called "Perfecting the Five Powers":
Since all phenomena are unborn,
one attains the power of utter stability.
Since self-aware wisdom is luminous,
one also attains the power of omniscience.
Since all phenomena are indivisible,
one attains the power to enjoy everything,
the way of enjoying without attachment.
All, too, are by nature complete from the very beginning.

The samaya called "Sealing All":
The four directions, the four intermediate directions, above and below, all ten,
are pervaded throughout by the great nature.
That self-arisen itself, being without substance,
is the illusory seal of all.
That profound dharmadhātu itself
abides in oneself and is hard to examine.
All are gathered into the expanse of equality,

into the field that abides in bliss from the very beginning.

The samaya called "Phenomena Indivisible":
Since all are of one taste in the expanse from the very beginning,
"I" and self are not found there.
In what is by nature completely pure,
there is not even the thought of clean and unclean.
Since all is the essence of the Sugata,
how could the dust of conditions stain it?
Realize it thus with supreme wisdom;
know the expanse in which all without exception is gathered!

The samaya called "Terrifier of All":
One endowed with wisdom and acuity of mind,
having demolished all the signs of analysis and conception,
truly realizes that all are gathered
in the seal of signlessness.
Concept itself is without substance,
and that itself appears as the various;
in its very appearing there is nothing to be purified.
That itself is the seal of destruction.

The samaya called "Eternal Increase of Life":
Since all phenomena are oneself,
where would one go, and where would one be born?
There is no thing that perishes or is born;
in what has no substance, who is there to kill?
Whoever grasps dualistically,
for him there are birth and death.
When it is examined by one who possesses wisdom,
in birth and destruction themselves there is no substance.

The samaya called "Obstructing Nothing":
From the perfection of the three supreme ones downward
to the abodes of the lower realms upward,
all are truly indivisible;
nothing whatsoever is to be abandoned.
Of the inconceivable vehicles, high and low,
none at all was taught to be without purpose.

All the abodes of the lower realms without exception
possess the cause of unsurpassed awakening.

The samaya called "Enjoying Everything":
All is Samantabhadra;
the five qualities of sense pleasure
are to be enjoyed without hindrance
and regarded as a great accumulation of merit.
Regard them also as the five Tathāgatas.
Furthermore, all the thousandfold world-systems,
the expanse of wisdom, and the sense pleasures,
the best, the middling and the least, are all to be enjoyed.

The samaya called "Not Handing It to All":
In the maṇḍala where directions and times are equal,
one who has not realized the supreme vajra family,
one of the lesser vehicle and lesser view,
will not realize the supreme vehicle.
Though the meaning of the unequalled pervades everything,
they are obscured by affliction and suffering,
and so they do not see the truth itself.
To those who do not see, it is not to be handed over.

The samaya called "Nothing to Guard":
For all the buddhas without exception
there is nothing to accomplish and nothing to guard.
There is neither virtue nor nonvirtue,
no abandoning of afflictions and no accomplishing of purity.
When one has become the expanse of suchness,
pleasure and displeasure are indivisible,
abiding as primordially pure equality.
In that there is not even an atom to guard.

The samaya called "Guarding Nothing":
Sentient beings of the three realms of saṃsāra,
circling since beginningless time,
act in confusion amid the inverted views,
and cling intensely to the objects of apprehended and apprehender;
therefore they wander forever in saṃsāra.

So, realizing your own mind,
abandon all this completely, without laziness,
and guard equality, without "I" and without self.

The samaya called "Terrifying All":
If all the roots of the vows
decreed by Vajrasattva
are not guarded as their meaning requires,
the wrathful yakṣas, blazing like fire,
will tear out the heart and drink the blood,
and one will be born in the three lower realms.
Its suffering is beyond bearing.
This samaya is the great vajra.

The samaya called "Enjoying the Sacred Substances Individually":
In the division into the five families, each in turn:
for Vajrasattva, the flesh of an elephant;
for the Jewel, the flesh of a horse;
for the Lotus family, the flesh of the arika;
for Amogha, the flesh of a garuḍa;
for the Sugata family, the great flesh.
Whether divided or undivided,
they are certainly to be accepted.
Or else gather them all into one;
or else regard them as without characteristics.

The samaya of the mudrā of samādhi:
All the maṇḍalas of the Sugata without exception,
luminous by nature from the very beginning,
are said to be present in everything.
The maṇḍala of the wisdom being itself
is the unsurpassed and supreme;
by all of the supreme vajra family
it is to be practised constantly, without interruption.
One will be born at the foot of the bodhi tree,
and unsurpassed, supreme awakening will be accomplished.
The lotus beyond birth and death is accomplished,
and mastery over mind will also be attained.
Whatever sphere of activity one aspires to, one will know.

This is the seventy-sixth chapter, on the elaboration of the samayas, from the King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion.

Whoever abandons this maṇḍala
is born, through affliction, in the abodes of the lower realms.
He will not attain the fruit of awakening;
the cause of the unsurpassed destiny is cut off,
and he will be born as one whose lineage is severed.
One who wishes to accomplish Vajrasattva,
constantly realizing the meaning of equality,
should meditate on the body as like a rainbow,
appearing, yet without intrinsic nature.
Knowing the retinue to be like the moon in water,
meditate on them as clear, yet without intrinsic nature.
If one meditates clearly on the bodies of the deities,
one will gain a great accumulation of merit.
If one knows them to be like reflections,
one will gain a great accumulation of wisdom.
The yogin should meditate always.
If one abandons that yidam deity,
one will always experience the misery of the lower realms.

The meaning of not interrupting the continuity of mantra and mudrā:
Mantra and mudrā are not to be interrupted.
This is the path by which yoga is accomplished;
it is not letting go, it is restraint, and it is guidance;
it is the abode where the supreme goal is perfected.
Constant meditative equipoise is the mudrā;
the mantra is what uproots the three poisons.
One who longs for the great river of the true meaning
should, at all times without break, with mudrā and mantra,
recite intensely with a steady mind.
Its qualities are equal to the bounds of space:
the moving of the mudrā and the syllable oṃ.

The characteristics of the vajra master are taught:
The teacher of the unsurpassed maṇḍala
is the giver of inexhaustible qualities,
the guide on the great path of awakening,

who places beings in the realm free of attachment.
He cuts affliction and suffering at the root
and empties the paths of saṃsāra.
He is the lamp that dispels the darkness of ignorance,
the guide of the blind.
If one constantly makes offerings to him,
the awakening of a buddha is not far off.

The characteristics of vajra brothers and sisters are taught:
They are siblings of the vajra family:
through karma held in common since beginningless time,
through a common view and conduct, they are born here.
Each is to the other like one's own eyes;
cherish them deeply and love them.
If, with ill will against the samaya, one finds fault with them,
one will fall into the great hell.
Therefore do not transgress the samaya.

The secret samaya is taught:
The maṇḍala of the Tathāgatas
pervades all of the three realms of existence without exception;
but being thoroughly obscured by inverted views,
it is like the pauper's treasure and the wrestler's jewel.
Therefore this supreme vajra secret,
through the compassion of the Omniscient One,
not because there is any fault in the Dharma,
is kept utterly secret for the sake of beings.
If the secret meaning is shown
to those of the lesser vehicle and those of inverted views,
not knowing the secret meaning of the true nature,
they take those immediate spheres of conduct
to be the absolutely definitive meaning,
and lead that very secret meaning astray.
Not realizing it, they circle in hell.
Therefore keep it utterly secret.
Endowed with great compassion,
be skilled in all the paths to liberation.
Since you are endowed with supreme wisdom,

according to the grades of beings as vessels,
the meaning of the higher and lower vehicles
must be taught to each as befits them.

Accepting and not abandoning
the yogin should always practise.
Becoming free of attachment,
and the great and marvellous accomplishments,
are found within the summary teaching on samaya.
If one practises without realization,
one is born among pretas and rākṣasas.
Or else, with samaya such as this,
however one acts, one does not transgress the vow,
and deeds and conduct become the two great accumulations.
Whether going, lying down or sitting,
abide in the expanse of that equality.
Act always with supreme wisdom.
Toward all phenomena without exception
act as a bird cuts across the path of the sky.
All grasping and clinging without exception
are like a great wind streaming through space;
all the mind's conceptual attachments without exception
are like a great fish darting through water.
Look with the yogic view in that way.
With wisdom that realizes in this way,
not mere words, deepen your understanding.

Those who boast of the supreme Vajra Vehicle
without knowing the meaning of equality,
saying, "The samaya of secret mantra is equality,"
and act just as they please,
will pass on through the hell realms.

What is the meaning of equality?
There is neither equality nor realization at all.
Abiding in nothing, one engages objects;
there is no one who acts and no action.
The supreme of the family who realizes thus,
when born as a vajra vidyādhara,

is fearlessly joined with Samantabhadra
and abides in inexhaustible qualities.

Not knowing the meaning of equality,
yet with the relative and the ultimate not two,
and with phenomena and persons both without self:
this is the stage of the bodhisattva.
Not knowing all karma and affliction
as the meaning of equality,
and holding dependent origination, cause and effect, to exist:
this is the pratyekabuddha.
To view, in all phenomena without exception,
the things of the four truths as existent,
and so to come to abandon and not abandon:
this is the stage of the śrāvaka.
Taking the ten virtues as chief,
and virtue and nonvirtue as unequal,
leads to birth as gods and humans:
the stage of circling in the desire realm.
Not realizing the meaning of equality,
grasping in sequence at self, each in turn,
in the four immeasurables and the four meditative concentrations,
and conceiving the aggregate of form as self:
this is birth, in sequence, in the abodes of Brahmā.
Not realizing equality and formlessness,
not knowing the four name aggregates to be nonexistent,
and so coming to abide in the four sense sources,
one is born on the level of the Peak of Existence.
If one does not know all to be equal,
hates all without exception,
and comes to lack true compassion,
this is dwelling in the sixteen hell realms
of the great unbearable torments.
Not knowing the nature free of attachment,
desiring everything whatsoever,
obscured by the body and obscured by food,
one is born in the realm of the great pretas.

Not knowing that there is no "I" and no self,
being deluded about all phenomena,
with wisdom unclear and to no purpose,
not realizing the meaning of virtue and evil:
this is birth in the realm of animals.
Giving rise to very great pride,
taking everything as one's own,
and engaging in strife with all,
one is born in the realm of the asuras.

All the vehicles, supreme, high and low,
and all the views of the world without exception,
when thoroughly examined by great wisdom,
are without intrinsic nature, yet anything at all is accomplished.
There is no falling from the expanse of the true nature.
One endowed with the eye of great wisdom
sees the high and low states and the six paths,
without intrinsic nature, yet anything at all accomplished,
each likewise as saṃsāra.

Through the unsurpassed supreme mantra,
without examining any signs at all,
all signs and everything are absent.
Since it is equality with everything,
the separate views of the transmundane and the mundane
are not to be spoken of.
In general, the inconceivable wrong conceptions
do not exist from the very beginning;
through the habitual tendencies of individual conceptions
one is obscured by the net of apprehended and apprehender.
Nothing at all, it appears as anything at all;
in its very appearing there is no intrinsic nature.
To realize it thus is the abode of the happy destinies.
The Vajra Holder realizes it thus.

The view and conduct of great yoga:
however one acts, there is no intrinsic nature.
Like a great bird soaring in the sky,
like a great fish darting through water,

like a great wind moving through space,
look with the yogic view in that way.
The great conduct of yoga
is to act toward everything without distinction.
One comes to taste the supreme flavour of bliss.
Who is there to cling to it?
Acting yet unattached, that is wisdom;
the very supreme of bliss is the accumulation of merit.
Act within such a state:
this is the vast conduct.
Without letting view and conduct part from each other,
mantra holders should always practise.
Some, though their view abides in equality,
are not at all in harmony with conduct.
Some, though they perfect conduct,
do not know the view of equality at all.
Some have neither view nor conduct.
The truly supreme and holy being,
since ultimate and relative are indivisible,
realizes them thoroughly just as they are.

Abiding in the state of the unsurpassed Great Vehicle,
ultimate and relative are indivisible,
yet toward all things, merely on the relative level,
one holds both pure and impure.
In the great vehicle of means,
purification and suffering
are indivisible even on the relative level:
such is the whole difference of higher and lower views.
The great view and conduct of means
surpasses the unsurpassed vehicle:
ultimately it is the seven riches;
relatively it is the perfection of equality.

While not moving from equality,
one displays the great mudrā of means.
Means and wisdom are completely pure.
What is called "all is pure"

does not mean that things are plainly pure;
in appearance and conduct themselves they are completely pure.

In the sūtras of the great samaya,
the teaching of the five families is this:
all phenomena without exception
are entirely gathered into the great families.
All phenomena without exception are not perceived as separate;
unshakeable by anything, it is vajra;
because it subdues the base families, it is vajra.
All arising from the unperceivable expanse,
it is the abode of great qualities
and the abode of the overwhelming buddha-fields as well:
this is declared to be the Jewel family.
Because all phenomena are indivisible,
there is no attachment and nothing to be attached to;
they are one in suchness,
untainted by faults, like a lotus.
Because all without exception is gathered into the expanse,
here there is not the slightest thing to be done.
Without acting, aims are accomplished,
and faults and qualities are joined as awakening itself:
this is the accomplishment of actions.
All phenomena without exception
are free of extremes and centre, free of multiplicity.
Not being anything at all, they are suchness;
realizing the mode of indivisibility,
this is the family of the Tathāgata.

For all of appearance and existence without exception
it makes a place of clarity and warmth,
and burns up signs and habitual tendencies:
this is called the family of fire.
All phenomena without exception
appear as things, yet there is nothing to grasp;
when it stirs, all things speak:
this is called the great wind.
In the sūtras of the great samaya,

the five elements are explained as
the source from which all without exception arises,
the treasury that makes all things grow.
For all phenomena without exception,
since there is a ground that is solid and stable,
yet one realizes the mode of no things,
this is called the great earth.
For all phenomena without exception,
likewise the great space
opens room for outer and inner;
it is the very state in which all is clear.
And all four elements, every one,
dissolve into the state of space.
All phenomena without exception
are gathered into the expanse of suchness.

The samaya called "The Five Afflictions":
Ignorance becomes awareness;
the inverted is the true;
the five afflictions are the Tathāgatas.
If their insubstantiality is realized, they are the path of awakening;
if not realized, one goes to the three lower realms.
Therefore, by hearing, reflecting and meditating,
realize the true meaning itself,
and join everything as buddhahood.
Since desire has no intrinsic nature,
be attached to the true meaning,
abiding in the manner of non-attachment.
Attachment to non-attachment
is the great, supreme, utter attachment.
The realms of the Victors will arise:
these are the pure fields of Amitābha,
where all are miraculously born from lotuses,
and one is born on the level of Vajradhara.
The characteristic of great aversion:
it is aversion to the inverted.
If one knows aversion to be without substance,

one knows hating and not hating as equal:
unshakeable by anything, it is vajra.
The state of great equality
is indivisible in all things;
not realizing it so, it appears to everyone as different.
Likewise ordinary people do not know equality,
and so they see it as mere aversion.
When thoroughly examined with true realization,
aversion is great compassion.
As for what is called delusion and bewilderment:
all phenomena without exception
are indivisible on the ultimate level,
and on the relative level are like an illusion or a mirage.
Since in their very appearing they have no substance,
who would grasp at them as a self?
Not perceiving anything, all being indivisible:
that is the delusion of the wise.
Whoever realizes it is a Tathāgata.
The characteristic of pride is stated thus:
having settled in equality,
toward the inverted and the lesser vehicle
it appears as very great pride.
Pride and peace are not separate;
being without intrinsic nature, they are gathered into the expanse.
This is the source of qualities.
Know it likewise to be pure.
The characteristic of jealousy is stated thus:
it is grasping at "I" and self,
yet the grasping itself has no substance.
Jealous toward those who do not know equality,
it gathers all into equality,
and is strictly restrained toward what is unequal:
therefore it is the great jealousy.
Bound as a self through the inverted,
one is made utterly narrow by apprehended and apprehender.
The wisdom free of apprehended and apprehender
has neither narrow nor wide; all is equal.

By knowing that, actions are fully accomplished.

The samaya called "The Five Aggregates":
Though appearing as the five aggregates,
they perform the various activities of the relative,
and experience objects of pleasure and objects of displeasure,
each with its own flavours.
When the characteristics of the five are taken apart,
their individual characteristics have no substance.
Whoever grasps them as substantial
will be born in the three lower realms.
Here, the characteristic of form:
its very appearing is without intrinsic nature;
non-appearance itself displays variety;
appearance and non-appearance are not two.
To realize this is the abode of liberation;
form itself is the body of perfect enjoyment.
The characteristic of feeling is stated thus:
though three kinds arise in everyone,
pleasure and displeasure have no substance,
and what is neither is the indeterminate.
Though various feelings arise,
both feeling and arising are empty;
emptiness is not a substance.
To realize this is to don the armour of the Dharma.
The characteristic of perception is explained thus:
it grasps the meeting of the three as signs.
When its individual characteristics are taken apart,
there is no substance; it is suchness.
That substance is manifold,
and without any agent it engages everywhere.
In all of the three realms without exception,
signs great and small are beyond conception;
pervasive and without substance, they do not exist as things.
If one realizes this, these are the marks of a buddha.
The characteristic of formations stands thus:
their number grows from eight roots

and moves through all as fifty-one.
Realized there, no root exists;
though they do not exist, false movements arise.
Whoever grasps them as substantial,
forever distracted by afflictions,
circles all through the prison of the three realms.
For the sake of the true meaning, through awareness,
the ground and root of their spreading is suchness itself.
Then, the arising of consciousness
is without substance and momentary;
it plays in the expanse of wisdom,
and is said to be the great host of emanations.
Consciousness is the source of all.
The nature of its substance
is not colour, shape or a stream of knowing;
it is not anything at all, itself unperceivable.
This holds sway over all:
going to the higher realms or going to the lower realms
is the difference between realizing and not realizing.

If one knows the four within the state of equality,
this is great wisdom.

The samaya of the five colours:
Though all sentient beings without exception
are pervaded by the five wisdoms,
they are obscured by their own conceptions
and do not see the meaning of the five wisdoms.
For all who do not see and are deluded,
in order to show the characteristics of wisdom,
white and red and yellow,
green and the rest, and black, are shown.
Having realized the selflessness of phenomena,
because the mind of awakening itself is pure,
the colour shown is utterly white:
it is the colour of purity, so that this may be realized.
All phenomena without exception
are called padmarāga, the ruby;

there is no attachment and nothing to be attached to,
and, because it is free of attachment, it is red.
A great treasure of qualities that knows no exhaustion,
it is the source from which all arises;
in the whole expanse of suchness
it becomes an inexhaustible treasure of jewels:
its colour is shown as the colour of gold.
For phenomena that are inverted,
through the blessing of great compassion,
they must be truly gathered into the expanse,
and so all actions without exception are brought to completion:
all-encompassing action is the colour green.
From the very expanse of suchness,
unshakeable by anything and unfabricated,
the substance of the colour black
cannot be altered by other dyes.
Know all things likewise.

The samaya called "The Five Directions":
Though likewise there is no edge and no centre,
for one abiding in the state of indivisibility,
for the sake of realizing wisdom,
one should abide in the directions and the centre.
For sentient beings blinded by ignorance,
in order to clear away affliction and ignorance,
the lamp of wisdom, blazing with light,
dispels the darkness of ignorance;
therefore it is called the east, where light rises.
For all sentient beings without exception,
affliction and suffering do not remain,
and the darkness of ignorance sets;
therefore it is called the direction of the west, where light sets.
All the afflictions of all sentient beings,
through great wisdom, which is selflessness,
are thoroughly purified of suffering;
therefore it is called the direction of the north, the pure.
Thus for all without exception,

compassion rises and obscurations set.
When the characteristics of conception have come forth in this way,
their great qualities are complete.
Thus all phenomena without exception
are gathered into the expanse of the nature itself.
All the directions without exception
are round, in the manner of suchness.
Look upon all the directions in that way.
If, through ignorance and the inverted views,
the directions are grasped as separate,
one will forever circle in afflicted saṃsāra.

The samaya called "The Five Faculties":
Exercising power over the five objects,
the inverted grasp them as things;
by grasping them as things, they circle in the three realms.
All forms without exception
appear yet are without substance,
and are imagined as substantial gods and goddesses;
self and deity are then two.
Though sounds resound in all their variety,
know sound itself to be without substance;
all sounds and speech without exception
are the various great sounds of the Dharma.
Though appearing as the substance of smell,
smell itself has no nature whatsoever;
smelling is the scent of the Dharma:
great wisdom realizes it so.
Though appearing as the substance of taste,
taste has no intrinsic nature;
tasting is the taste of suchness,
and that bliss brings satisfaction.
Though various tangibles appear,
there is no existing substance of the tangible;
what appears as tangible is enjoyment;
great bliss is the Dharma body.
If those who do not know, the inverted,

become attached to the objects of the faculties,
they are never parted from desire,
and in the three lower realms and the eight unfree states,
like fire in roots and straw,
they will circle through the three realms.
Therefore realize wisdom free of attachment.
Make merit without hoarding what has been done.
Acting in all things and remaining unstained,
always meditate on great wisdom.

The samaya called "The Five Equalities": equality as unborn on the ultimate level; equality as illusion on the relative level; equality as the indivisibility of the ultimate and the relative; equality of the five great elements as the five Tathāgatas; and equality of the eight consciousnesses as the five wisdoms.

Of these, equality as unborn on the ultimate level:
All phenomena without exception
are suchness, the limit of emptiness,
the true, and the dharmadhātu.
They are without characteristics and unperceivable,
ungraspable, and with nothing to be cured;
they are in nirvāṇa from the very beginning.
All have the characteristic of space,
and space too has no characteristic.

Equality as illusion on the relative level:
The various conditioned things
all appear in the manner of an illusion;
they perform all the activities of the moment,
and the signs of every realization appear.
All of these are reflections:
agent and action appear, yet have no substance.
All abide like the moon in water;
all appear, yet are without intrinsic nature.

The indivisibility of the ultimate and the relative:
All phenomena without exception
arise from what has no ground or root;
they are neither existent nor nonexistent.

The ultimate and the relative are indivisible:
the unconditioned itself appears as the conditioned;
in its very appearing there is no substance,
and that very absence of substance is manifold,
like an illusion or a mirage.

Equality of the five great elements as the five Tathāgatas:
From earth, water, fire, wind and space
various marvels come to arise;
they have no ground or root,
but arise thus by way of the nature itself.
The appearance of the individual families
is always equal as great means;
their individual characteristics
are equal in the state of the expanse of wisdom.

Equality of the eight consciousnesses as the five wisdoms:
The all-ground that is not conceptual,
without intrinsic nature, the ground of meaning:
this is called the dharmadhātu,
the wisdom of suchness.

All phenomena without exception
are not grasped as "I" or as self,
and since all of them are indivisible,
all is in the manner of a mirror.
In all things there is fleeting thought,
yet nothing to conceive or examine;
unperceived throughout the three times:
this is the wisdom of equality.
Having abandoned wrong conceptions, the sphere of the faculties,
the objects of the faculties being without substance,
all indivisible, suchness:
this is the discriminating wisdom.
The five equalities are examined thus.
Regarding all phenomena without exception
as without intrinsic nature from the very beginning,
and as great means, spontaneously accomplished:
this is true realization.

The samaya called "The Maṇḍala of the Gathering":
The accumulations of merit and wisdom being complete,
the centre is self-awareness, without edge or centre,
and the four wisdoms radiate in the manner of a wheel.
Or else Vajrasattva himself,
the gods and goddesses of the four families,
and the wrathful gods and goddesses of the retinue.
Or else the centre is the transcendent itself,
and the various worlds are its retinue.

The samaya called "The Feast Offering":
When one is endowed with means and wisdom,
and the mind of awakening and non-attachment
have dissolved into nonduality,
one is endowed with the completion of the two great accumulations as well.
All the five sense pleasures,
and all the various appearances without exception,
are regarded as the maṇḍala of the Tathāgatas,
as gods and goddesses of beautiful form.
All sounds without exception
are the great sound of the Dharma;
they purify the lower realms and show the path to liberation.
They are the great sound that resounds through the three-thousandfold universe,
and the sound that encompasses all.
The merit that satisfies with bliss
is inexpressible, non-abiding wisdom:
this is the speech of the unattached Lotus.
To the nature of reality, which is without substance,
to give supreme satisfaction with fragrance
is said to be a great accumulation of merit;
it is the way of unattached wisdom.
Likewise, if one pleases and makes offering with fragrance,
the levels of the vidyādharas are spurred on.
In the three lower realms, the fragrance of the Dharma
brings attainment of the state of perfect bliss.
All the maṇḍalas of the Sugata without exception
come to be offered the taste of bliss.

Satisfying them becomes a great accumulation of merit;
not grasping it as a thing is the accumulation of merit.
By such a supreme taste
all without exception come to be satisfied;
in the realms of the pretas there is enjoyment.
It is an offering to all the maṇḍalas without exception;
it is the completion of great bliss.
When yogins who are fit for the work
adorn themselves in many ways
and enjoy through the offerings of union,
inconceivable maṇḍalas become spontaneously present.
The maṇḍala of great bliss blazes forth
and dispels the black darkness of evil,
and great powers that no host of armies can withstand
are accomplished as well.

The samaya called "The Activity of the Feast":
In the manner of non-action,
act toward all without hindrance.
All without exception is tamed,
the hostile side is brought under control,
great qualities are increased,
and even the fierce wrathful ones are pacified.
Acting toward all at ease,
one abides in the manner of non-attachment.
It is the maṇḍala gathered into the expanse,
encircled by a retinue of many emanations and reabsorptions.
The state of great equality itself
abides in such a manner.

The samaya called "Satisfying the Phramen of the Retinue":
Oneself as the lord who tames,
always in equipoise in wrathful form,
and the wrathful ones of the retinue likewise,
with all their colours and mudrās,
recite all the supreme and holy mantras without exception.
Then, gathering the retinue of phramen,
and acting in accordance with their individual activities,

place each in its own position.
The methods of bringing under control and of meditation
should be done as is fitting.
Commanding all without exception, "Act!",
give them the remainders and confer empowerment upon them too.
Moreover, to all beings
give the gift of the five sense pleasures.
Then, having completed the activities,
and relying on the abode of Maheśvara,
the five families, the five wisdoms and the rest,
all the maṇḍalas of the retinue without exception,
should all be gathered into oneself.
One who holds the state of practice in this way,
having perfected wisdom and the two accumulations,
abides on the level of the vidyādhara's awareness.
One will not come to the conduct of the lesser vehicle,
will not be born in the unfree states,
and attains the eternal state beyond birth and death.
One purifies the buddha fields as well,
empties the abodes of the lower realms,
and accomplishes the essence of the true and supreme.

All that appears as objects of the faculties:
the objects do not exist;
the all-base consciousness itself
appears as various things.
When appearing things are taken apart,
having taken apart their individual characteristics,
once taken apart, they subside into the state of space.
When that very space is taken apart by way of the five,
it dissolves into the expanse without characteristics,
the source of all.

The instant without ground or root,
not blocking appearance, is skillful means;
the absence of intrinsic nature is wisdom itself.
The afflicted consciousness,
toward the all-base itself appearing as its field of experience,

conceives of that as a self,
and grasps separately at the signs of pleasure and pain.
In the all-base, which has no entity,
there is no place where habitual tendencies accumulate;
since appearing things have no entity,
there is nothing for the afflicted mind to take up.
There is no imprinting and nothing to be imprinted;
thus there is no entity that imprints.
Though nothing is there, the mind falsely imagines,
and so circles forever in the prison of the three realms.
The mental consciousness,
toward both what appears and what does not appear,
is conceptual thought lasting an instant, a moment.
If thought itself is not established,
how could the entities that are its objects be established?
Likewise the very continuum of the mind:
the former moment has passed and is not observed,
the later has not arisen and cannot be examined;
thus its intrinsic nature cannot be observed.
Like wind drifting over the plants and trees,
the continuum is never broken at all;
this is what arises everywhere.
Thus objects have no entity.
Like water, wind, and waves,
those three are neither one nor separate;
likewise the all-base, the afflicted mind, and the mental consciousness
are not one and are not separate.
The expanse of phenomena and the expanse of equality
are all indivisible from wisdom,
and cannot even be spoken of as one.
Not realizing this is to be a sentient being;
when it is realized, buddha is nowhere else.
The suchness of the mind of awakening
is utterly unobservable, hard to examine,
spacious, vast, and profound;
it is realized through profound wisdom.
It has come from nowhere and goes nowhere;

coming and going have no part in it.
Utterly hard to examine, unobservable,
neither its edge nor its center can be found.
Its very self, free from apprehended and apprehender,
appears thus in the manner of the unobservable.
The expanse and the wisdom of the expanse
come down to self-awareness alone.
All sentient beings without exception,
understand it in this way!
You will be free of affliction and suffering
and will attain the unsurpassed fruit.
Toward all sentient beings without exception,
with the cord of compassion, free of attachment,
free them from the path of affliction
and delight them with loving-kindness.
Likewise, into the prison of saṃsāra
cast far the lasso of compassion
and draw them out of the mire of affliction.
Great compassion is not made to arise.
Likewise, among ordinary people,
one is not stained by the obscurations of karma;
seeing all as manifestly awakened,
in joy there is no regret.
Since sentient beings have no "I" and no self,
compassion makes no dualistic distinctions:
set your mind on them as on an only child,
and make them all free of stain.
Since all phenomena are empty,
there is no entity and no concept in them.
Abiding in the state of space,
there is nothing in it to alter or change.
All phenomena are without characteristics;
since all appearances have no entity,
all existence and nonexistence whatever,
being without characteristics, are not observed.
Transcendent and mundane
phenomena, though they appear in many forms,

are not other than oneself;
so there is nothing anywhere to long for or cling to.
All minds of awakening,
being utterly hard to examine and profound,
are not the domain of logicians:
unobserved, not observing, nothing to be observed.
What is the very nature of mind like?
Awakening itself is mind.
Since mind and awakening are indivisible,
all sentient beings without exception
and all phenomena of the three times are this.
All phenomena whatsoever, without exception,
are gathered into mind and awakening itself.
So the great Bodhi has declared.
A person endowed with supreme skill of mind
acts without obstruction toward anything;
in acting itself there is no attachment,
and he abides undiminished for endless time.
All these appearances,
though always seen by valid direct perception,
have no entity in their very appearing;
realize them likewise as the genuine itself.
Whoever says, "A state of emptiness exists,"
and so realizes a nature of nonexistence:
a rabbit's horn and a barren woman's son
may well be designated as mere words,
but all are mere names; there is no emptiness as a thing.
It is said that all without exception are empty,
yet since this is not uttered without awareness,
it is nonconceptual and by nature luminous;
all these appearances
are not phenomena of mere expression;
they are cognition alone.
When all is realized as nondual,
that itself is the ultimate expanse;
it is not to be sought or posited elsewhere.
If it is sought in existence, it becomes superimposition;

if it is sought in nonexistence, it becomes denial;
if it is sought in both existence and nonexistence,
it becomes the undeclared.
He has no conceptual thought,
yet there is nothing he does not know.
Such is the view of yoga.
Though in words there is a before and an after,
in meaning meditate on it as complete all at once.
Once such a meaning is realized,
then even while walking, lying down, sitting, staying, and enjoying things,
one never falls away from the meditation of the Great Vehicle.
Those of poor intellect who have not realized the meaning given above,
having cited equality as their authority,
without realization, lazy and idle,
go to the lower realms without accomplishing the aim.
If the mind has not realized equality,
one does not awaken through an equality of words.
Therefore join meaning and words together!
Then it will be accomplished without doubt.
The yogin who has realized the great meaning
meditates thus for endless time.
His qualities are equal to the limits of space,
his domain is one with the buddhas themselves;
ever endowed with a great accumulation of merit,
through diligence that involves no doing,
he reaches the seat of awakening.

Thus it is in secret words.

This is the seventy-seventh chapter of the King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion, teaching the gathering into faculties and objects.

Then the Tathāgata, in order to make the mantra holders' practice meaningful, gathered everything of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality into the mudrā, examined in this way the whole of the outer and inner, the vessel and its contents, and taught the keeping of the commitment of the mudrā: the commitment is the ground. Condensing and elaborating by means of the mudrā are also this. He then spoke this inspired utterance:

From that very secret alone
this supreme awakening is taught.

The maṇḍala of great equality:
all that has passed and not passed
in the ten directions and four times without exception
is primordially indivisible suchness.
It is not something to be made equal or unequal;
it is gathered into the state of suchness.
All expressions without exception,
transcendent and mundane,
are not realized apart from the state of the nature of reality;
there is not an atom of wrong realization or affliction.
Though the various mudrās blaze with light,
they have not moved from suchness,
because the self is not other than the expanse.
Meditating in the threefold way
of abiding equally in equality,
generating the mudrās and taming the perverse,
in a manner with neither act nor agent
one completes all activities without exception.
Realizing thus, the supreme of the family,
oneself the self of all the mudrās,
being primordially luminous by nature,
is also the cause from which awakening is born,
and is the result, as the genuine itself.
Cause and result indivisible, the vajra ground,
the thirteenth, where the aim is accomplished: abiding there,
it is the ultimate, abiding nowhere at all.
The natural great mudrā:
all the outer and inner, the vessel and its contents,
all abide in the state of wisdom.
As the Sugatas of the five families in union, father and mother,
uncontrived, they abide thus from the beginning,
and play in skillful means and wisdom themselves:
the great assembly, beyond bliss and unattached,
perfectly complete in the genuine itself.
The surpassing great mudrā:

the inner sign has emerged outward.
In brief, the great mudrā
and also the various other mudrās,
the inconceivable gathering and radiating of the hands,
the great postures of the limbs, all their moving and swaying,
though they do not move from their own expanse,
abide thus by their very nature.
Conquering, unstoppable by anything,
the great self-arisen one, god of gods,
pierces through everything;
he is also to be designated "the Hero."
Unstained by karma and by action,
realizing the meaning of the nondual expanse,
attached to non-attachment,
in the utterly pure
maṇḍala of the expanse of suchness,
endowed with body, speech, and mind, never exhausted,
he becomes an inexhaustible treasure of qualities.
The ground is endowed with inexhaustibility;
he brings to completion the activities of body and speech.
In a nonconceptual manner
he plays without attachment in all things.
His ways of benefiting those to be tamed are inconceivable:
conquering, unattached, the source of all,
bringing all under power, and accomplishing aims;
all gathered without exception, completely pure,
round on every side and radiating rays of light.
The four families, all without exception,
are all gathered into the expanse of equal perfection.
The families are one without being one,
in the very state of the spontaneously present maṇḍala.
The defining mark of the commitment of the mudrā
is taught as the sign of the mind.
For example, when a king sets his seal,
no sentient being whatsoever transgresses it;
likewise equality is the seal:
it pervades all, and all appears.

When sealed with body, speech, and mind,
the māras and the many non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), all the adverse side,
cannot gain power over one.
One who is certain in the family of Vajrasattva
always abides in such a way;
one without such understanding
is never said to belong to the vajra family.

This is the seventy-eighth chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, on the commitment of the mudrā.

Then the Blessed One, Great Delight, spoke this firmly held king of secret mantras as an inspired utterance to the tathāgatas themselves:

Kye kye! This nature of the ten directions and four times
is the very essence of the tathāgatas.
Clinging to the elaborations of apprehended and apprehender,
beings are each caught by the noose of concepts.
The grounds too, set out in their distinctions,
are the path that leads to the secret essence.
The ocean of wondrous wisdom
has never spoken anything that would not become meaningful.
Whoever speaks this secret great mudrā,
this essence, having realized it through all the tathāgatas,
that very one is I, and his empowerment too is complete.
All the tathāgatas
have no secret other than this.
The secret essence, reality,
which pacifies superimposition and denial,
was drawn out of the expanse that ascertains reality.
This is certainly prophesied:
the son is born from the heart,
and abides on the ground of the supreme awareness holder.

When this had been said, all the tathāgatas, indivisibly delighted, remained as the very ornament arrayed as the dense spontaneous presence of body, speech, and mind, the expanse of the equality of the four times.

This is the seventy-ninth chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, on the entrustment.

From the Noble King, the Net of Illusion in One Hundred Thousand, the general scripture of all the characteristics and all the tantras, the secret of all the tathāgatas: from the chapters of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, everything has been elaborated without exception, and this is the supreme fruit of those wheels that were turned.

Since this great secret exists,
even across a pit dug full of burning embers
and packed with razor edges,
climb over it, my children, and go!
In the innermost of the inner
an iron casket is sealed shut.
Though, like a mirror, it is looked at by all,
no reflection appears.
With the magic key of wisdom
open the vajra-bolted casket,
draw out the treasure of wish-fulfilling jewels,
and you, the supremely fortunate, please enjoy it!
It does not appear in letters for all;
abiding in the heart of the master,
it is the domain of the supremely fortunate
and is not shared with everyone.
For example, the milk of a lioness
can be held in a golden cup,
but if it is poured into other vessels,
the vessel cracks and the milk leaks away.
In the very nature of gold,
whatever distinctions of shape may appear,
there is not an atom that has changed from gold.
Likewise the defining character of phenomena:
whatever various signs appear,
there is not an atom that has changed from itself.

This completes the eightieth chapter of The Secret Essence, Ascertaining Reality, teaching that the nature of reality never changes.

Translator's Notes

• The title is given only in Tibetan here; it corresponds to the Guhyagarbha Tattvaviniścaya. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "expanse of reality". "The secret assembly"

(□□□□□□□□□) may allude to the Guhyasamāja, but the phrase is taken in its plain sense. The paired epithets for Samantabhadra and Samantabhadrī contrast the agent (□□□□□□□□□□) with the feminine "she who is the action" (□□□□□□□□).

• □□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□, "covered with rust", which the image of the mirror requires; □□□□□□□□□□ in the closing verses is read as □□□□□□□□□□, "world". The chapter colophon of chapter five names the work the King of Tantras, the Net of Illusion (Māyājāla), the cycle to which the Secret Essence belongs.

• In the verses on the parts of a letter, □□□ is read as □□□, the dot that separates syllables, since it stands between the head of the letter and the dividing stroke (□□).

• "All of them, through the female bodhisattvas, are gathered into the secret vajra faculty" follows the text as written (byang chub sems ma yi); some witnesses read byang chub sems kyi, which would give "all are gathered into the secret vajra faculty of bodhicitta." "Universal Light and Lotus Eye" names the eleventh and twelfth grounds of the Nyingma scheme; the usual reading is "Lotus-Possessor" (padma can), and here the text has padma spyan, rendered as written; the Wheel of the Garland of Letters is the thirteenth ground. In "the inner and the outer," the text's nad ("disease") is taken as a slip for nang ("inner"), which the context plainly requires.

• The list of thrones names both khyung and nam mkha' lding, ordinarily two words for the garuḍa; five thrones are needed for the five families, so the second is given as "the sky-soaring bird" (in other versions this place is held by the peacock and the civacivaka bird). "The doer and the lord of deeds" renders bya ba and bya bdag literally; commentaries identify the pair stationed in front and behind as Samantabhadra and Samantabhadrī. "Golden yellow" renders ser le brgan, whose last element is uncertain.

• "The male Vajra Agent and the female Vajra Action" renders byed pa po rdo rje and bya ba mo rdo rje, the masculine and feminine principles of the maṇḍala, identified in the commentaries with Samantabhadra and Samantabhadrī.

• "Like the clearing of a sneeze" renders sbrid sangs bzhin as it stands; the image is obscure and may reflect a corrupt reading. "Nothing to destroy" renders gsad, literally "to kill"; it may stand for bsal, "to remove".

• In the mudrā verses, "syllables" (literally "grains") and "letters" designate the fingers, and the sun and moon the right and left hands. "The ringing staff" renders gseg par, which is uncertain; the six emblems of the six sages are traditionally the lute, armor, staff and bowl, book, jewel casket, and fire and water. In "without departing from his own body," the text's ma dgod ("without laughing") is taken as a slip for a verb of departing, which the simile requires.

• Here □□□□□□ is "taming" (subjugation of hostile forces), not the monastic Vinaya. In the karma section □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("with the karma mind") is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("as the Karma Being"), following the parallel lines of the other families, and □□□□□□ as □□□□□□ ("unmoved"). The "-dhara" names (Cakradhara, Padmadhara, Ratnadhara, Khaḍgadhara: wheel-, lotus-, jewel- and sword-holder) follow the pattern of Vajradhara in the preceding piece.

• The ringing-rite lines are terse, and the sense of not passing beyond and just passing beyond oṃ and haṃ, apparently levels or stages of the gesture, is uncertain. □□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□ ("what the mind is set on"). □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is uncertain; the consorts, bestowing goddesses and attendant (offering) goddesses are a tentative rendering. The white tent, square, red crescent and black blazing correspond to the four activities of pacifying, enriching, magnetizing and wrathful action. In the rite of taming, □□□□□□ is "taming", not the monastic Vinaya.

• □□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□ ("very mind"). In the verses on the vajra and bell, many lines are highly condensed ritual instructions and the syntax of several is uncertain. "Within sixteen lifetimes at most" interprets the bare "within sixteen" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) in line with the usual Mahāyoga promise of awakening within sixteen lives. □□□□□□□ in the closing sentence

is rendered as "special teaching from"; it may instead qualify the image ("the superior image").
• The four rites here are the standard four activities: black for wrathful destruction, red (Hayagrīva) for magnetizing, gold for enriching, white for pacifying. The "wheels" of hearing, clarity, the hands, speech and great movement appear to be the sense and action faculties (ear, eye, hands, tongue, and feet or movement) visualized as palaces; "wheel of clarity" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) for the eye is an interpretation. The line about not abiding in equality (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is terse and its rendering tentative.
• □□□ ("from the mother") might instead be the syllables a and ma; it is read as the ordinary word "mother," following the bhaga imagery. The line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is obscure; the rendering is tentative. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as "will not be parted from the arising of the sugatas," taking □□□□ as "apart."
• The four realizations at the start (the single cause, the mode of the syllables, blessing, and direct perception) are the standard Guhyagarbha set of four realizations. "Those who have become fields" renders zhing 'gyur, the beings who are fit objects for the rite of liberation. "Uṣṇīṣavijaya" renders gtsug tor rnam par rgyal ba; it may instead be read as "the victorious crown" visualized on the purified being.
• "The elements are the consorts of the wisdom family" reads □□□□□□ for the written □□□□□□, an evident copyist's slip. The four kinds of secret meaning listed early in the chapter are rendered as the tradition explains them (secret for discipline, in intent, concealed, by nature); the Tibetan is terse here. The line "We do not awaken by searching elsewhere" keeps the first-person plural of the Tibetan. The verses at the end of this piece are elliptical and the rendering follows the most natural syntax.
• The first line of "How wonderful! All beings..." reads literally "all beings are not in the sugatas"; it is rendered as "not apart from the sugatas," which fits the doctrine of the passage, but the Tibetan is terse. "The uninterrupted hell of Extreme Heat" renders mtshams med pa'i rab tu tsha ba; it may refer to Avīci and Pratāpana together. "The casket" renders za ma tog (Skt. karaṇḍa). In the final sentence the one who knows is unstated in the Tibetan and is rendered with a passive.
• Several goddess names are given in Sanskrit where the Tibetan is a recognized rendering (Brahmāṇī, Raudrī, Indrāṇī, Vaiṣṇavī, Kaumārī, Amṛtā, Śāntī, Daṇḍī, Rākṣasī, Bhakṣasī, Ratī, Rudhiramadī, Ekacāriṇī, Manohārikā, Siddhikarī, Vāyudevī, Agnāyī, Vārāhī, Cāmuṇḍī, Varuṇānī, Mahākālī, Kumbhakarṇī). Those I could not identify with confidence are translated literally: the Red One (dmar mo), the Slayer (gsod byed mo), the Noseless One (sna chad mo), the Goat-Headed One (ra mgo), and the Belly-Holder (gsus 'dzin, perhaps Lambodarā). In the second list mi srun mo is taken as a variant of mi'i srin mo (Manurākṣasī), gru mo as grub mo (Siddhikarī), and the great Red-Yellow, Blue-Black, and Yellow-Black Ones as the last three goddesses of the first list. The interjection thong thong is rendered "Hey, hey."
• The eight goddess classes are given by their usual Sanskrit names (Gaurī, Caurī, Pramohā, Vetālī, Pukkasī, Caṇḍālī, Ghasmarī), taking thal byed ma as Vetālī and sme sha can as Ghasmarī; these identifications follow the usual peaceful-wrathful lists but are not certain. The four classes at the gates (rdo rje bsrings 'gro ma, rdo rje gdong mo, rdo rje 'jig rten ma, rdo rje ro langs ma) are translated literally. The phrase rendered "each in an instant took up her own place" (rang rang gi gnas ga la bar) is obscure. Ucchuṣma Krodha is given as a name.
• The line on the limbs and heart with five, nine and eleven prongs is terse; it appears to describe visualizing the body's limbs and heart as multi-pronged vajras, but the construction is uncertain. "Stira" in the eastern and western implements is left as a loanword; it is an unidentified Indic term for a staff or weapon. In the west, "the great oceans cut through at the waist" may refer to the nāgas of the ocean rather than the waters themselves. "The Guardian of Words" translates an epithet for the northwestern protector that I cannot identify with confidence (the northwest is normally Vāyu's direction). The "great boar" held for the nadir

may allude to Varāha, but this is not certain.
• "Red" in the drinking passages renders the Tibetan "red," a standard tantric term for blood (rakta). "Stira" is an unidentified Indic loanword for a staff or weapon, kept as in the previous piece. "The great transcendent sūtra" may be the title of a specific scripture on the mātṛkās, which I cannot identify with confidence. The vajra secret words of chapter thirty-one are deliberately cryptic; the rendering follows the Tibetan closely, and several lines (notably the one on rebirth-linkings and the line on the husk) are uncertain in their construction. "Handmaidens and serving women" renders two terms for classes of female attendants at the gates whose exact identity is uncertain.
• In "not giving to others," the text's me gtong is read as mi gtong, an evident copyist's slip; likewise zig gnon is read as zil gnon, "overpower," and cing yang as ci yang, "anything." The line on "the great delusion that does not spread" is obscure in its construction. The "two clusters" of great deities is rendered literally; it likely refers to two groupings of the wrathful maṇḍala. This chapter is a dense tantric hymn associating the five poisons with the five wrathful bodies, and several lines are compressed to the point of uncertainty.
• In chapter thirty-three the stanza for the jewel family appears twice in identical form where one might expect a further family (such as the lotus); it is translated as it stands. "In one hundred thousand" in the thirty-second chapter colophon reflects the Tibetan's reference to a version of the text in a hundred thousand sections or verses. Several ritual phrases in chapter thirty-four are uncertain: "the mother for knowing and entering," "the colors of ignorance," "the one who has passed beyond" (which may denote either the transcendent deity or a deceased person), and "the supreme and the lesser transformed fields" (possibly a term for corpses or charnel substances) are rendered literally. "Never" reads the text's nams kyang as nam yang.
• The king first called "King of the Vast Earth" and then "the great Māra, king of the Earth-Holders" is rendered literally; I cannot identify a Sanskrit name with confidence. The line describing some beings "with their whole bodies" appears to lack a word after "utterly," and "pinned" renders an obscure term; both are uncertain. "Hey, hey" renders an exclamation (thong thong) of uncertain sense. The phrase "the sacred teaching" is written twice in the Tibetan.
• The "animal-headed goddesses" render □□□□□□, the therianthropic phramen goddesses of the Nyingma maṇḍalas. Several lines of the chapter thirty seven verse are terse and their sense is uncertain, notably "lay the lines with the soles of the feet", "like a cast image" (□□□□□□), and "lending" (□□□□, read as a lending or pledging transaction). In "one who wishes to become habituated will attain this", □□□□□ ("skull") is read as □□□□□ ("attain"), which the following list of powers requires. "Great corpses" (□□□□□□□) are human corpses used as seats. In the final verse, the last stanza has □□□□ ("host") where the others have □□□ ("colors"); it is translated as written.
• "Locanā" renders □□□□□□, taken as the name of the buddha consort Locanā; it could also be the Sanskrit word for "eye." The line rendered "those who destroy the body of merit come under control" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is obscure, and the syllable □□□□ in "deep dark blue" is left untranslated as unclear. "The Lord of Desire" (□□□□□□□□□) is not confidently identified; it may mean Kāmadeva or the lord of the desire realm. "Poison sent by sorcery" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□, taken as poison deliberately administered or sent by malign rite. The verse beginning "oṃ, by nature great delusion" has only three lines in the Tibetan.
• Amṛtakuṇḍalin renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the wrathful deity Nectar Coil. On the eastern and southern spokes the Tibetan names only "Vajra" and "Jewel" (Ratna), presumably standing for the vajra and jewel family buddhas. In the fourth sequence, "Filling those and the body" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, which differs from the parallel lines (□□□□□ "path of speech"). "Drive him with iron" (□□□□□□□□□□) is likely an iron hook. The passage ends in mid-sentence; the next piece continues it.

• canaka is a Sanskrit word in Tibetan letters whose meaning here is unclear; it is left untranslated. Several apparent copyists' slips are translated by their evident readings: "means of entry" for □□□□ ("smile") where the parallel stanza has □□□□; "non-apprehension" for □□□□□□□□, parallel to □□□□□□□□; "mudrā" for □□□□□□; "number" for □□□□, parallel to □□□□; and "state" for □□, parallel to □□. "The image into which the deity is to be brought down" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) refers to a rite of causing a deity to descend into an effigy or a tree sapling.
• The opening line "Those are the deities above" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is obscure; parallel stanzas name a seed syllable here. Several evident copyists' slips are translated by the reading the parallels require: □□□□□□□ for □□□□□□□ (Amoghasiddhi), "vajra deities" for □□□□□□□□□□□, "four gatekeeper goddesses" for □□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□, "secret" for □□□, "names" for □□, "abode" for □□□□□□□, and "forty second" for □□□□□□□□□□□□. "Cutting short life" renders □□□□□□□□, and "snatching away" renders □□□□□; both are uncertain. canaka is left as written.
• The Tibetan □□□□□ is taken as Sanskrit caṇaka, "chickpea," a common size measure, hence "buddhas the size of chickpeas." Several evident scribal slips are read for sense: □□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□ "essence," □□□□□□ as □□□□□□ "state," and □□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□. In the Karma section the syllable □ parallels the seed syllable of the lotus section and is treated as a seed syllable; it could alternatively be read as "mother." The line beginning "mark the mouth and heart of the one toward whom it is done" is overlong and appears conflated in the source; it is translated as it stands. The first part of this piece repeats the lines that close the previous piece, as the source text does.
• □□□□□ in "whoever strives in this" is read as □□□□□ "strive," as in the parallel line later. The opening prose listing classes of nāgas and "the second direction" is obscure, and "the Fifth" appears to be the name of this obstacle-removing rite; both are translated literally. □□□□□□□□□ "upon the field" may refer to a cremation ground or a corpse seat; the sense is uncertain. The verb in "if one wishes them to leap up" (□□□□□) contrasts with "if one wishes them to live" (□□□) in the parallel line and may be a scribal variant of it.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□ "becomes a hundred" is read as □□□□□□□□□□□ "they will faint," as in the parallel lines. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is obscure; it is rendered "drink from skull cups and eat without limit." □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "the lord of the gandharvas and the lord of fire," matching the list of direction guardians that follows (Īśāna, the wind, yakṣas, rākṣasas, the lord of the waters, Yama). The figures for the retinues are given as the Tibetan states them.
• The opening lines in long meter are terse and partly obscure; "beyond the scattering and gathering of seeds, so hard to approach" renders □□ literally. In the list of goddesses, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ "intoxicated by drinking blood" is taken as Rudhiramadī; □□□□□□□ "River Goddess" may be a slip for □□□□□□□, the wind goddess (Vāyudevī); □□□□□ "Human Woman" may be a slip for □□□□□, the fire goddess (Agnāyī); and □□□□□□□□□ "belly-holder" is taken as Lambodarā, the pot-bellied goddess. These are translated as written, with the identifications offered tentatively.
• □□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□, the continent Godānīya, in the list of the four continents. □□□□□□ in "burning and torment" is obscure; it is rendered by sense. The line "set down in five and six times" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is cryptic and translated literally. In the wrathful context, "liberate" (□□□□□) has its ritual sense of slaying while freeing the consciousness.
• The line rendered "what they do amasses no karma but becomes the accumulations" reads literally "in what is done, not amassing, it becomes accumulation"; the sense is that action by those certain in the unsurpassed vehicle does not accrue karmic bondage but becomes the

accumulations of merit and wisdom. The counts of subdivisions ("two and three tens" for each of the five roots, i.e. thirty-two, and "two tens" for each of the ten branches) total 160 plus 200, the three hundred and sixty samayas named in the chapter colophon. Several names in the final list could not be identified with a Sanskrit form and are translated or given phonetically: Dripping Blood, Black Killer, Black Liberation (Tharpa Nakpo, the rudra of Nyingma tradition), Mujé Tsenpa (a king of the mu spirits), Fierce Youth, Lichin, Hand Roamer, Vajra Beauty, and Yamshü Marpo.

• "Sthira" renders the Tibetan sti ra, whose sense here is uncertain; it may be a transcribed Indic word for the charnel feast or for corpses. "Transference" renders spo, read as the ritual transfer of the consciousness of the one liberated; it might instead be a seed syllable. "Dispatch offering" renders sbod gtong, whose exact sense is uncertain. The chapter numbering in the colophons runs from fifty-two in the previous piece to fifty-four here, as the text stands.

• The king of the wrathful ones "Radiating" and the "King Who Increases" are translated from the Tibetan, as no Sanskrit form could be identified with confidence. "The five paths" are taken as the five destinies of beings.

• e, vaṃ, ma and ya are the four syllables of evaṃ māyā, each governing one of the four rites of wrath, subjugation, increase and pacification. The goddess names "Treasure Holder", "Swollen One", "Lion-Faced One" and "Laughing-Faced One" are translated from the Tibetan, as their Sanskrit forms are not certain. "Kali" is left as written; it may stand for the kīla rite or a related ritual act, and its sense here is uncertain.

• "Three dawning, five blazing, ten in abundance" renders a cryptic line, probably counting the three bodies, five wisdoms and ten grounds or perfections; it is left literal. The verb rendered "enclosed" (ubs) is uncertain in this context.

• The nṛ ("man") is the ritual term for the person or effigy on whose behalf the life rite is performed. In the line rendered "conceal it once more within the expanse," the text reads spa ba, taken as sba ba, "to hide." Here the deity's name tshe dbang mo is read as "the goddess of life empowerment," which fits the following lines about granting the life empowerment, and not as Indrāṇī. The name of the Tathāgata rdo rje sdud pa po is translated by meaning ("Vajra Gatherer") because no certain Sanskrit form can be identified.

• The line rendered "the excellent lines of nṛ, ash, and manta" is obscure; it seems to describe the materials used to draw the maṇḍala lines. The pra rite is a divination: a deity or spirit is made to "descend" into a support, such as a child medium or a mirror, and speak. "Five paths" probably means the five classes of beings. Here the Tibetan word dbang mo, which was given as Indrāṇī earlier, heads a list of worldly powers, so it is read as a class, "sovereign goddesses."

• "Endowed with a hundred sacrifices" (mchod sbyin brgya) probably alludes to Indra's epithet Śatakratu, "he of a hundred sacrifices." This fits the Indra mantra that follows, although the passage is about Dhṛtarāṣṭra. Vaiśravaṇa's emblem dbyig to is uncertain; it is rendered "jeweled staff." Here the text assigns the deep-red color, the nāgas of the west, and a mantra naming Virūḍhaka to Virūpākṣa, and the translation keeps this as written.

• The opening sentence breaks off in the Tibetan with no verb, and the translation keeps it as it stands. In "free from conceptualization itself," rtogs ("realization") is read as rtog ("conceptual thought"). The palm-tree simile and the line "the objects and the times are the great ones" are obscure, and their renderings are tentative. "Those of awakening" who are shown "the way of the self-arisen" probably means the pratyekabuddhas.

• The "five great inner ones" are probably the five afflictions, which are presented here as the five poisons transformed. The phrase phyag rgya chen po ("great seal") is a technical term here, so it is rendered as "great seal" (mahāmudrā) of mind and of speech, and the dharmakāya is likewise called "the great seal."

• The verses on killing beings who have committed the deeds of immediate retribution

(ānantarya) express the tantric doctrine of compassionate "liberation" by one held by skillful means; they are rendered as the text states them. In the jealousy section, "in all its forms" renders □□□□□□□, which may be a slip for □□□□□ ("specific"), matching the pattern of the other sections. "Those who conform to permanence" (□□□□□□□□) is a literal rendering of an uncertain term, probably a class of non-Buddhist ascetics. "The thought of means" reads □□□□□□□ as □□□□□□, as the context of jealous thought suggests. "The very limit of nirvāṇa" renders □□□ in the sense of culmination rather than "extreme."

• □□□□□ here is taken as "continuum" (the mind-stream), not "tantra," as the line requires. In the list of purified substances, "the bones" renders □□□□□ as written. In "conceiving of things and non-things," □□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□, as the context of signs requires; likewise □□□ in "unlike the ordinary" is read as □□. □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is the holy life (brahmacarya), not the god Brahmā.

• The lines describing the dwelling place ("great skillful means, the all-accomplishing, luminous love; the all-delighting, fierce lady of the expanse") may name the principal deity and consort by epithets; they are rendered descriptively since no names can be identified with confidence. "Supremely adorned" reads □□□□ as □□□□. "Ah" renders the exclamation □□□□.

• □□□, literally "field," is the tantric code word for a corpse in this rite and is translated "corpse." □□□ (nṛ, Sanskrit for "human") is a code term left as written; it appears to denote human substance or the human corpse. Several details are uncertain: the description "long, yellow, and glossy" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), the duration units for "nine, twelve, thirteen, or up to sixteen" (the text gives none; probably days), "the corpse of the five roads" (□□□□□□□□□□□□), "mottled" for □□□□□□□□, and the terms de byi pu tra and a nṛ bri du, which are kept as written. "Great conch without seams" may be a code for a skull without sutures. "Gods, mātṛkās, and rākṣasas" takes □□□□□□□□□ as the triad lha, mamo, and srinpo. "The Unshakable" renders □□□□□□□□□□□, possibly Akṣobhya. The chapter-title term □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered literally as dance and song, play.

• The text reads "the faculty of the nose" (□□) for the second maṇḍala, but the verses that follow concern hearing and sound; this is translated as the evident reading □□, "ear." "The direction of qualities" is the south, the direction of the jewel family; the west is described with a play on □□□, "set" or "decline." □□□□□□□□ here is "supreme bliss," not the deity Cakrasaṃvara. "The Unattached" (□□□□□) may be an epithet of a female deity.

• "They will not miss the appearance of the buddhas" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, where □□□ is read as standing for □□□ or a word meaning "parted from"; the sense of not being cut off from the advent of buddhas seems clear. "The strength of great might" reads □□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□. "A mountain utterly firm" reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□, which the following line about the winds of non-Buddhists supports. The eṇaya is the black antelope, alluding to the Buddha's manifestation among animals as a deer.

• "The All-Victorious One" renders □□□□□□□□□□□, apparently an epithet of the speaking buddha; it is translated rather than identified. In the seventy-third chapter title, □□□□□□□□□ is read as "the lineage that is to be kept"; the phrase is compressed and the reading is tentative. "The eye of nṛ" keeps the seed syllable as written; it likely evokes a human eye, that is, visualizing so vividly that it seems visible to ordinary sight.

• The line "never has it been said that they fail to become the aim" renders a terse phrase (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) whose exact sense is uncertain. Here □□□□□□□□ is rendered "supreme bliss" rather than as the deity name Cakrasaṃvara, since in this tantra it describes the realized maṇḍala, not that deity. The list of hearth shapes (triangle, skull cup, crescent, lotus, "the one free of attachment") is given as written; how the shapes match the four rites is not stated in this passage. The verses on jealousy play on the word "narrow" contained in the Tibetan for jealousy.

• "The eight and eight, sixteen" are the eight hot and eight cold hells, as the following lines make clear. "Those without memory or speech" refers to animals, whose abodes this samaya empties. As in the previous chapter, □□□□□□□□ in "Pride, Supreme Bliss" is taken as "supreme bliss," not the deity Cakrasaṃvara. "The way of outcasts" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, taken as conduct of a debased kind; its exact point here is not certain.
• "One's age is that of sixteen, and one remains, prolonging it for hundreds upon hundreds of years" interprets two terse lines (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□

directions" passage puns on the Tibetan direction names: shar, east, is "rising"; nub, west, is "setting"; and byang, north, is "purified." The south is not named in this text. "Self and deity are then two" renders bdag dang lha nyid gnyis pa'o literally; its intended force is unclear. "With nothing to be cured" renders sman pa med tentatively. "The four" in the opening line is presumably the four aggregates of the preceding verses.

• The phramen, here and in the samaya's title, are the animal-headed goddesses of the wrathful retinue. No Sanskrit name for them could be identified with confidence, so the Tibetan term is kept. "By way of the five" in the final verse renders lngas; what the five are is left unstated in the text. "Fleeting thought" renders yud rtog.

• The three likened to water, wind, and waves are given in the Tibetan simply as the all-base, the afflicted, and mind; following the preceding verses, these are taken as the all-base consciousness, the afflicted mind, and the mental consciousness. "Great compassion is not made to arise" renders □□□□□□□□□□□ literally; it may mean that great compassion is not contrived, or the negative may be a scribal slip for "generate great compassion." □□□□ in "when all is realized as nondual" is read as □□□□□, and the obscure □□□□□□ is taken as "then." "The great Bodhi" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is a transliterated Sanskrit word; whether it names a speaker or awakening personified is unclear. In the closing prose, □□□□□□□ is here the ordinary word "meaningful," not the name Amogha.

• "Beyond bliss and unattached" renders the obscure □□□□□□□□□□□□□; it may be a slip for □□□□□□□, "great bliss." "Where the aim is accomplished" takes □□□□□□□□ in its ordinary sense; it may also allude to Amoghasiddhi. The five epithets "conquering, unattached, the source of all, bringing all under power, and accomplishing aims" appear to correspond to the activities of the five families. "The Noble King, the Net of Illusion in One Hundred Thousand" refers to the larger Māyājāla cycle from which this tantra is said to be drawn.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.